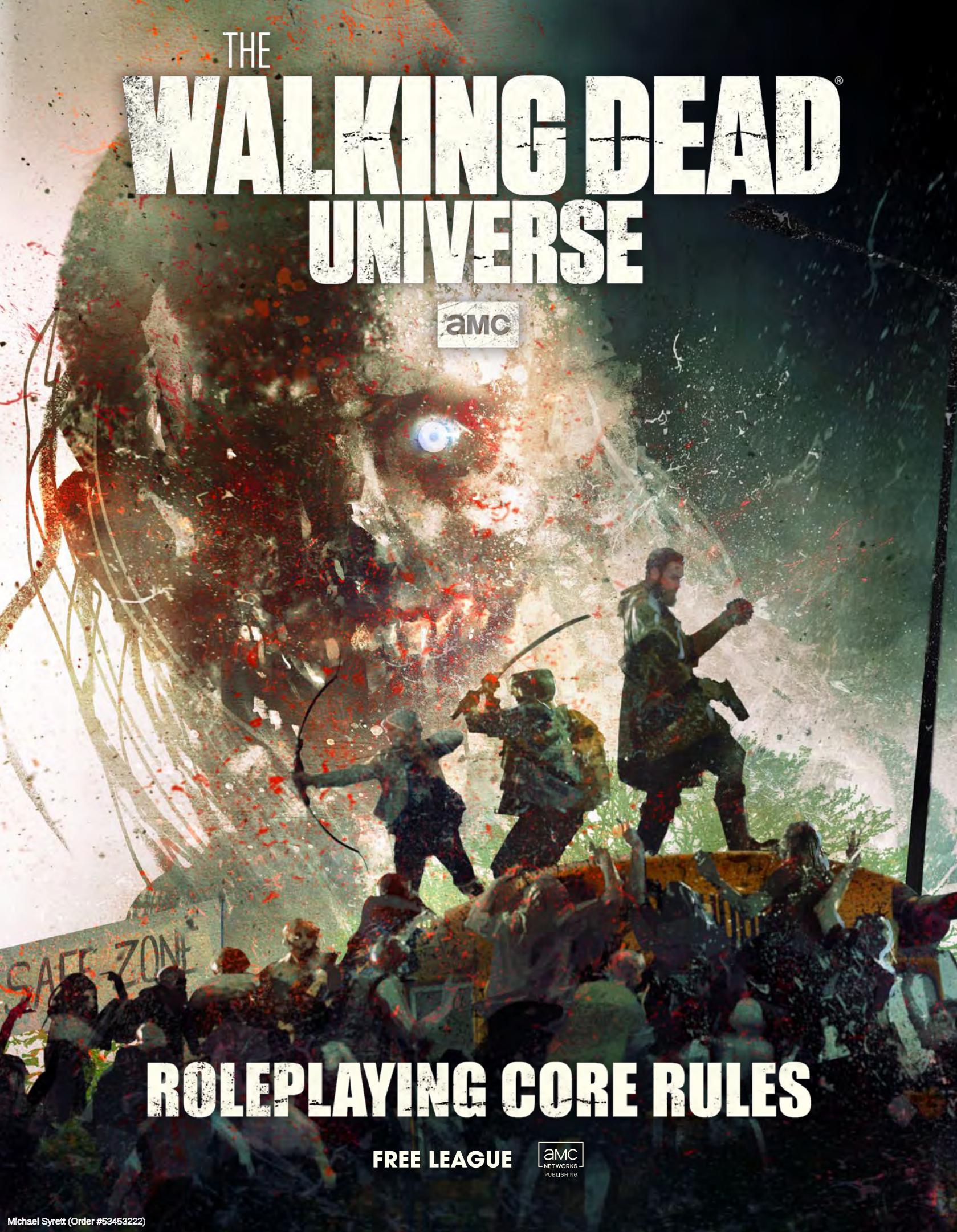

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SPECIAL THANKS TO
The Walking Dead Universe's CCO Scott M. Gimple, TWDU producer Brian Bockrath, and all the wonderful people from AMC Networks who helped us along the way over the years: Simon Ferrari, Clayton Neuman, Kevin Dreyfuss, Kim Kelleher, Madhu Goel Southworth, Mike Zagari, Kristen Chung, and Dario Di Zanni.

PRINT
Standart Impressa UAB, 2023

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CHAPTER 1

INTRODUCTION

There were birds everywhere in the trees the morning Sam died. I saw goldfinches, sparrows, and nuthatches and they were singing, though it was in the middle of October. At least, that's how I remember it. We all gathered around his bed. He looked like a bird, a slender and small one, with his head and hands sticking out from under the blanket. Sam had been sick for quite a while; there wasn't one among us who hadn't secretly been cursing him, for slowing us down and eating without contributing. I think it was cancer, and he'd had it since long before the outbreak. As he fell asleep for the last time, with us holding his hands, crying around him as a family, it was a thing of beauty. He was not shot in the head. He was not bitten or torn apart by living corpses. He did not get a knife in his belly. He was our Sam, and we buried him in the backyard.

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The deceitful stranger is trying to get away with a backpack full of canned dog food, stolen from the camp where the player characters Hannah and Miguel live with their group. They catch up to the thief in a walker-infested, small-town area and chase him up a fire escape onto the roof of an apartment building. For a moment, he seems to be cornered, but then...

Gamemaster: *With one gigantic leap, the stranger jumps over to the roof of the adjacent building. For a fraction of a second, you think he might not make it. Then he hits the roof on the other side, skids in the snow, and rolls around to come up on his feet. Very athletic.*

Hannah (player 1): *I just stand there and watch him, knowing that I would never be able to make that jump. Then I reach into my left coat pocket and grab the small revolver I took from the dead kid.*

Gamemaster: *He turns around with a mocking smile. "Well, well, looks like I'm eatin' good tonight." White vapor hisses from his mouth as he exhales heavily.*

Hannah: *I raise the revolver and aim between his eyes.*

Gamemaster: *The thief seems to think this is hilarious. "Sweetie, if you pull that trigger the dead will pack these streets in minutes. Are you ready to get caught up here, without any food or shelter? I don't think so."*

Hannah: *"You thought wrong." I cock the hammer.*

Miguel (player 2): *Whoa! Is there anything I can do to stop her before she shoots?*

Gamemaster: *You can always try. What do you do?*

Miguel: *I tackle her, so she falls down on the roof, before the shot goes off.*

Gamemaster: *Okay. Roll Close Combat.*

Miguel: [Rolls four six-sided dice] *I failed, no successes in there!*

Gamemaster: *Alright, Hannah, you see Miguel throwing himself at you, but at the last moment you are able to take a step backwards and he tumbles past you.*

Hannah: *I shoot.*

"We won't get weak. That's not in us anymore. We'll make it work."

Rick Grimes

Welcome to *The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game*. In this book you will find everything you need to start roleplaying in *The Walking Dead Universe*.

The text above is an example of how the dialogue between those participating in the game may flow during an intense scene, and as you probably noticed there are both players and a Gamemaster in this game.

You and your friends will have to decide beforehand which one of you will be the Gamemaster, or GM. The rest of you, preferably two to five people, are the players who will each create a Player Character (PC). All other people in the world, such as the thief in the example above, are called Non-Player Characters (NPCs) and they are controlled by the GM.

NPCs who are in the same group as the PCs, or who could be recruited to join the group, are often referred to as NPC survivors. If, or when, your PC dies, you may choose one of the NPC survivors to become your new PC.

The first six chapters of this book are addressed to you as a player, while the last are for the GM. The Gamemaster is the only one who needs to read the entire book; not to know the content by heart, but to be able to use it as a reference while playing. It is good if the players also flip through some of the first chapters to get a feel for the game.

In addition to this book, you will need pens, paper, and ten to twenty six-sided dice. About five of the six-sided dice should all be the same color. These are called *stress dice*, and their purpose is explained in this chapter. Custom dice specially made for the game can be used to enhance the experience, but they are not required to play.

THE CONTENTS OF THIS BOOK

This opening chapter provides an overview of how the game works, while the one that follows gives an introduction to the game's setting – the world of the dead.

Then come chapters that describe different aspects of the game mechanics. In Chapter 3 you will find instructions on how to create a PC, while Chapter 4 presents the skills and talents that signify what type of activities your PC is especially well-equipped to handle.

Chapter 5 deals with different forms of combat, damage, walkers, gear, and vehicles. This is followed by a chapter about establishing your haven and scavenging the world of the dead for supplies.

Chapter 7 is mainly written for the GM, and includes extensive guidelines on how to prepare and run a game. The final chapters present a detailed campaign set-up and a short survival mode scenario for you and your friends to play. Last, you will find an appendix and guidelines for solo play.

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WHAT IS ROLEPLAYING?

If you have never played a roleplaying game before, you can think of it as a TV series but without any visual support – you simply state what things look like. Another difference is that you do not have a script, and none of you knows beforehand what will happen.

You have an assigned role, and you play your PC as you think they should be played. When they say something, you say it as if you were them – you can even change your voice a little if that helps you to better embody the character. It is your job to describe what they do, and how they do it. At times you can even describe what they think about or hope for.

Generally speaking, your PC will try to survive in the hostile world of the dead, doing whatever it takes to achieve that goal. However, your job as a player is not to win the game by surviving as long as possible, but rather to play your PC in the "best" way you can to fit your expressive goals and the dynamic of your playgroup. If your PC, for example, hates someone, they may at times do stupid and dangerous things in order to get revenge or hurt them in some way. This makes for a dramatic and entertaining game.

Miguel (player 2): *While the others try to catch some sleep, I make a fire and tend to it through the night.*

GM: *Well, you are up on a rooftop, in the middle of the winter, on a building surrounded by walkers on all sides, so it wouldn't be likely that there is firewood around. But okay, there are... some rags and a broken backpack someone must have left here ages ago. It burns well enough, for a while. But it is still extremely cold.*

Hannah (player 1): *While David and Imani are sleeping, I walk over to Miguel and sit down beside him. "You don't need to keep watch, they can't come up here. You'd be better off getting some shuteye."*

Miguel: *I say nothing, I don't even look at you.*

Hannah: *"I get it, it's unnerving to hear them moving around down there. You'd think we'd all be used to it by now."*

Miguel: *"You're a fool."*

Hannah: *I look at you, surprised. "What?"*

Miguel: *"It isn't them. It's you, with all your self-righteous speeches about doing anything to survive. And then you let your pride put us in this situation. You didn't need to shoot the thief. But you did it anyway because you couldn't stand that he won."*

THE STARTER SET

In addition to this book, there is a *The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game* Starter Set, which offers you an easy way to start playing. It contains a condensed version of the rules and a survival mode scenario with pre-generated PCs.

THE GAMEMASTER

The Gamemaster is like a director for a play, or a leader of the group. They most often get the game going and call an end when it is over for the night.

The GM describes what things look like, what is happening around the PCs, and makes decisions for all other people in the world, beside the PCs. But they do not have to do it alone. This book is full of tips and instructions that will help them do their part, and if they think some things are hard, they may always ask the players for help.

It is not the GM's job to entertain the players. You all entertain each other. Help other players have fun, and they will see to it that you have a good time. Put their PCs in difficult and interesting situations, start conflicts, and have emotional make-up scenes where your PCs find trust in each other again – or whatever signifies a fun time for you and your friends.

SAFETY TOOLS

The Walking Dead television series takes place in a dark world with many situations that raise issues relating to personal morality. This game is no different.

That said, this is still a game, and players should not be forced to deal with topics they find distressing in real life, or that make them feel unsafe at the table. To make sure everyone is having fun and feeling safe, we recommend that you use safety tools before, during, and after the game. Examples of such safety tools are pre-game discussions about lines and veils for subjects that players want to avoid or keep off-screen; safety cards to be shown during play by a player to indicate that they feel uncomfortable with what is happening in the game; and post-game debriefings.

Always respect a player's wish to raise a concern at any time during the game or even to leave the table if they want to. And don't forget to take breaks. More information about safety tools in tabletop roleplaying can be found online.

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THE WORLD OF THE DEAD

This game takes place in *The Walking Dead Universe*, the same setting explored throughout the various television series from AMC Networks. Some time has passed since those who died started to come back as flesh-eating walkers – exactly how much time is for you to decide. Before that, your PCs all led ordinary lives. They made it through the first wave of death and destruction, bearing witness as society collapsed and the army made a futile attempt to defend the cities from the walkers.

They are now a close-knit group of allies and maybe even rivals who stick together to survive. They have a haven: a base where they are relatively safe. But they are constantly on the lookout for food, medicine, and all the other resources needed to get by. And, besides the walkers, there are other survivors out there. Some of them may want to join your group of PCs, but others will try to steal what you have or even kill you.

In the long run, this game could be about rebuilding society and creating something new from the ashes. But as the world of the dead is lethal, and your PCs will be forced to do things that may drive them mad or fundamentally change who they are, it could just as well turn into a story about going from bad to worse.

THE OUTBREAK

All of this started with the outbreak, the moment when the dead started to come back. Everyone remembers it. Everyone lost somebody.

Sometime before the outbreak, a virus spread around the globe. Everyone carries it, and it is this virus that makes you come back after you die. It doesn't matter how – walker bite, bullet wound, starvation, sickness, or natural causes – everyone comes back as a walker. That said, being bitten or scratched by a walker will always kill you, as the wound becomes infected. Your only hope if bitten is to amputate the limb – and quickly.

THE WALKERS

Walkers are everywhere – there are no safe places. They are like the wind or water, seeping in wherever there is a crack. You can kill individual walkers, but you can never take out so many that it makes a real difference. It is a simple matter of fact that if you mess up and attract their attention, the swarm will come.

Walkers are driven only by their compulsion to devour living flesh. When a gathering of walkers come together, they form a swarm and move as one. A huge walker swarm can destroy most anything in its path.

THE LIVING

In a world where food is scarce, there is little electricity, and no industrial production of medicine or other equipment, the struggle to survive often means taking from other people. The few remaining survivors have all done inhuman things to stay alive. The living are often a bigger threat to the PCs than the walkers. But there are all kinds. In a world with cannibals, robbers, and murderers, there are also those who want to trade, to join ranks, and to build a new society.

THE HAVEN

Most survivors have a haven where they rest and gather their supplies. It could be anything from some tents on a rooftop, to a well-functioning military base with running hot water and electricity.

The PCs will start the game with a simple haven and a handful of NPC survivors. During the game you will find new ways to improve your haven, and at times be forced to abandon it.

WHEN & WHERE?

The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game is designed to be set at any point in time after the outbreak – anywhere on the timeline, before, during,

CAN I PLAY AS RICK?

Most often, you will play a PC that is not one of the characters from the television series, even though you may stumble upon places, people, or events once featured on screen during the course of the game. Though there is nothing stopping you from creating your own version of one of the main characters, it's your job as players to create rich and relatable PCs that inspire you to imagine yourself in their shoes. Real people with feelings, ideals, flaws, dreams, and destinies. Many of these things have already been decided for the characters we know and love from TV, so while it may be fun to cross paths with these characters, it's also fun to challenge yourselves to create new characters that become the protagonists of your own story. After all, this game is about you. Your decisions, your destiny. We know what Rick said and did in this world. How about *you*?

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or after any season of the various television series set within AMC's fictional universe. The geographical focus of the game is the U.S., and Chapter 8 includes a game setting in suburban Atlanta, but you can adapt your game to be set anywhere in the world.

Survival mode scenarios are typically set at a certain point in the story of the television franchise, letting you encounter characters and locations from the show. One such scenario can be found on page 136, and another is included in the Starter Set for this game.

THE PLAYER CHARACTERS

Before the outbreak, you and your fellow survivors were ordinary people, whatever that means. Perhaps you worked as a mechanic, or you were a high school student, or a drug addict. You had no special powers or high-tech equipment.

DRIVE

Now, after the outbreak, you are still the same. But there is one difference between you and those who didn't make it – something that made you grit your teeth and push through everything you had to endure. That thing is called your Drive.

BEING A GROUP

This is not a game about individual heroes going on suicide missions, but about a collective. You survive together. But the group must navigate the complexities of the human condition: envy, hate, secrets, love, and everything in between. There will be conflicts among both the PC and NPC survivors in the haven. Sometimes those conflicts are more dangerous than what lurks beyond your fences and fortifications.

ISSUES

That which you and everyone else wrestles with inside – your fear, your shame, your lust – is called your Issue. Everyone has an Issue that complicates their lives. NPCs, havens and even items can also have Issues – this is further explored in Chapter 7.

During the game you may change your Issue and even have more than one Issue at a time. If your Issue gets the better of you, or you fail to handle your fear, you may start acting irrationally. In the game, this is referred to as becoming Shattered – maybe you start talking to the dead, or blaming others for the group's misfortunes.

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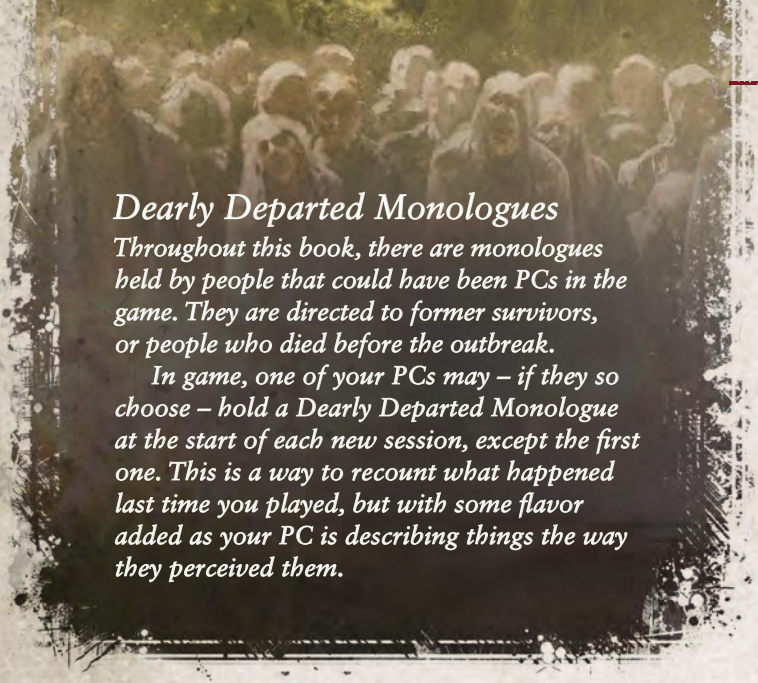


Dearly Departed Monologues

Throughout this book, there are monologues held by people that could have been PCs in the game. They are directed to former survivors, or people who died before the outbreak.

In game, one of your PCs may – if they so choose – hold a Dearly Departed Monologue at the start of each new session, except the first one. This is a way to recount what happened last time you played, but with some flavor added as your PC is describing things the way they perceived them.

ANCHORS

Luckily you have Anchors that help you keep your fear in check. Anchors are people in the group – PCs or NPCs – that you trust and love, and who help you find some kind of internal balance. And you'd better protect them, because if they die or disappear, you may fall apart.

Imani (player 3): *I walk up to Hannah when no one else is around. "You can't send Rebecca out there, not again. She's just started talking to me again."*

Hannah (player 1): *"We need to find David. And she's the best scout we have. She's coming with us." If anyone is wondering, Hannah is pressing her Issue that she still loves Imani and will do crazy stuff to get her back. I want Rebecca out of the picture.*

Imani: *Yeah, and I am trying to protect Rebecca, as I love her. But she is also my Anchor. So, I guess Imani disagrees with you.*

GM: *So what does your character say and do?*

Imani: *I go up to Hannah, really close, and whisper: "Back off."*

GM: *I think we have a conflict here. You are trying to make her back down. Time to roll the dice.*

WHAT DO YOU DO?

The game is about dealing with and preparing for the threats of the post-outbreak world, in any way you can. This could, for example, mean improving your haven, finding more NPC survivors to join the group, scavenging for food and supplies, attacking hostile havens, and clearing out walkers from important areas.

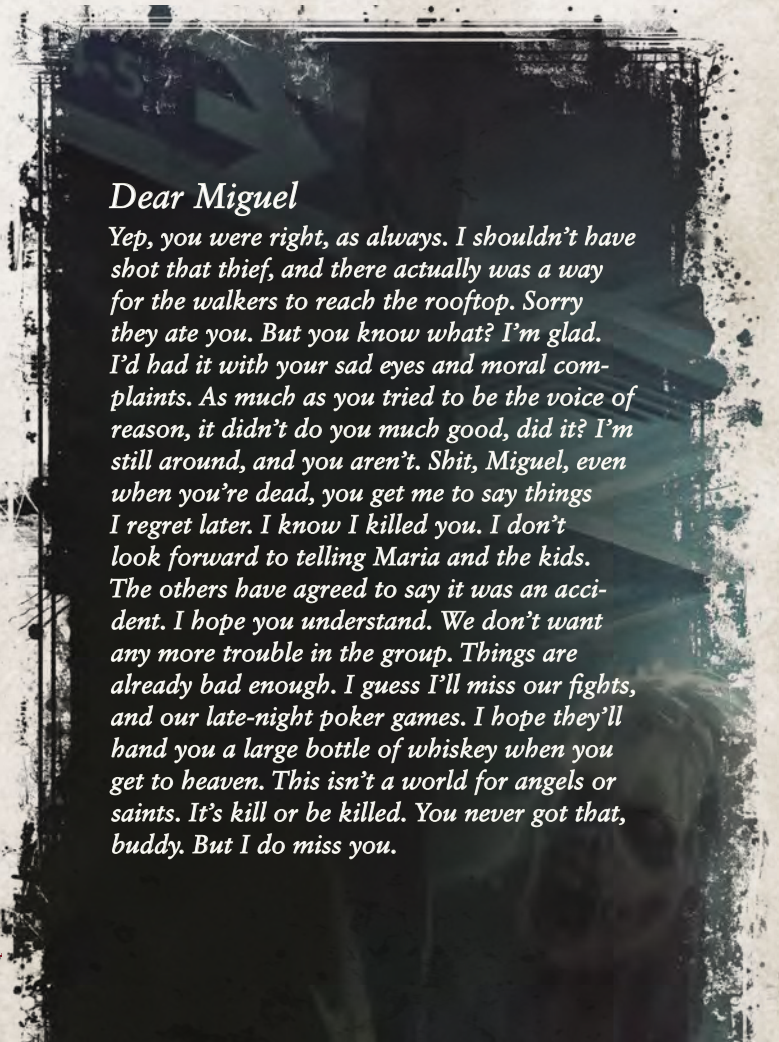
CHALLENGES

While you struggle to reach your goals, things will inevitably get in the way. These things are called Challenges. They can result from NPC actions – like an attack against your haven – or they can come about due to a lack of food, gasoline, or other resources.

A Challenge may arise from your own Issue, or the Issues of your haven. Perhaps there is a way inside that nobody has noticed, and now a walker has found its way to the kids' playroom?

Challenges escalate if you do not overcome them. This means that, a lot of the time, you will try to put out fires and struggle to prevent the haven and the group from falling apart. Often, several Challenges need to be handled at once, forcing you to prioritize.

But there will also be downtime – weeks that you can spend repairing the haven, healing from wounds, and training the NPC survivors so that they become more competent and better able to help you.



Dear Miguel

Yep, you were right, as always. I shouldn't have shot that thief, and there actually was a way for the walkers to reach the rooftop. Sorry they ate you. But you know what? I'm glad. I'd had it with your sad eyes and moral complaints. As much as you tried to be the voice of reason, it didn't do you much good, did it? I'm still around, and you aren't. Shit, Miguel, even when you're dead, you get me to say things I regret later. I know I killed you. I don't look forward to telling Maria and the kids. The others have agreed to say it was an accident. I hope you understand. We don't want any more trouble in the group. Things are already bad enough. I guess I'll miss our fights, and our late-night poker games. I hope they'll hand you a large bottle of whiskey when you get to heaven. This isn't a world for angels or saints. It's kill or be killed. You never got that, buddy. But I do miss you.

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PLAYING THE GAME

GAME MODES

There are two ways to play the game, *Campaign Mode* or *Survival Mode*. Whichever way you play, you always meet up – physically or online – and play for a few hours. This is called a session and could be compared to an episode in the television series.

CAMPAIGN MODE: When you play a campaign, you play several sessions that together form a longer story. The story you create is not predetermined; your choices and the result of your efforts create the storyline. There are two types of campaigns: *free play* and *season play*. In free play, you simply keep playing session after session until you find a suitable ending. In season play, you decide beforehand how many sessions (or episodes) of which your campaign will consist.

SURVIVAL MODE: Survival mode scenarios are often finished in one or two sessions. They give you a prewritten situation, and often pre-generated PCs and NPCs. They put you right into a dramatic and dangerous situation that needs to be handled right then and there. Also, survival mode scenarios most often contain places and people from the television franchise. Maybe you run into Dwight and Sherry, or you stay in the remnants of what was once Woodbury, the Governor's town.

SETTING SCENES

You don't have to play everything that happens. Even in the world of the dead, that would be dull. Just as in the television series, you play only specific scenes. It is the GM's job to start and end scenes. Most often, you skip in time and space to the next interesting moment and disregard the rest. The GM usually starts each scene with a short description of when and where the scene is set, and what the situation looks like.

> *"I don't know why I do the things I do. Never did. I'm a damn mystery to me."*
>
> Merle Dixon

Imani (Player 3): *I hang around until they get back.*

GM: *They do not get back until late at night, several hours after they said they would be there. You are standing on the hill when you hear movement in the nearby bushes. At first you think it is walkers, but then you hear someone cracking a joke and Rebecca giggling. It is completely dark, as clouds block out the stars and the moon. Everything is covered in a thick layer of snow. You are freezing, and, as you have not eaten all day, your stomach is hurting. They have not yet noticed that you are standing there, waiting for them. What do you do?*

THREAT LEVEL

The walkers are a constant threat in the world of the dead. You might be temporarily safe, but they are always out there, hungry for your flesh. This is measured by a Threat Level, on a scale from 0 to 6 indicating how active the dead are in the area around you.

The Threat Level can be increased by loud noises, such as shooting your gun or losing your nerve in an argument and screaming at someone. You can also increase the Threat Level by setting off a car alarm or dropping a heavy item. Be careful out there.

The Threat Level rules are explained fully in Chapter 5.

DICE AND CONFLICTS

Mostly, the game is a conversation, where you describe what your PC does and say what they say. But there will come a time when you attempt something dangerous or difficult, like trying to block a door to stop walkers from getting in, or shooting at someone. At these times, you use the roll of the dice to decide how things turn out.

Your PC has *skills* that tell you their strengths and weaknesses. If you shoot, you use Ranged Combat, if you try to save someone from bleeding out, you use Medicine, and so on. Each skill has a *skill level* from 0 to 5, and each skill has a corresponding attribute on a scale from 1 to 5.

When rolling for a skill, add your attribute score and skill level together, and roll that many six-sided dice. Each six you roll is called a *success*. Most times, you only need one success to achieve what you want to do. The skill mechanics are explained fully in Chapter 4.

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THE PRINCIPLES OF THE GAME

This entire game is permeated by a few simple principles. They are both instructions on how to play, and sources of inspiration. Go through them with any new players before you start playing.

1 **DO WHATEVER IT TAKES TO SURVIVE.** There is no preset path to salvation for your PC, and no way to win the game. There are no boss endings or hidden treasures. All there is, is your will to survive, and your freedom to do whatever it takes to keep going another day.

2 **DEATH IS INESCAPABLE.** Death is everywhere, and even though you can kill individual walkers, there will always be more coming. Your only hope is to build barricades. But they will only last so long.

3 **YOU ARE NEVER SAFE.** Everything changes; there is no permanently safe place. Those who were your allies yesterday may sneak into your camp tonight to take your supplies, or your life. The old gas station which was cleared an hour ago is now filled with walkers after a car alarm went off. Even your own mind may betray you through fear, weakness, even delusion.

4 **YOU ARE NOT ALONE.** This is a game about a group of people, not individual heroes. Your PC may die, but you will get a new one. The same holds for the other players and the GM: Everyone is equally responsible for what happens at the table. You all bring the fun, and you should respect each other's preferences and wishes.

5 **YOU ARE TELLING A STORY.** The game is played in scenes. Not everything that happens must be played out. Set scenes and play whatever feels interesting. Skip the rest.

6 **FICTION COMES FIRST.** In this game, the story is more important than the rules. Never say anything about rule mechanics without first describing and talking about how it impacts the story. This game is not about attacking walkers and rolling for damage. It's about what these experiences bring out in your PCs and how it changes you and your perspective on the world. So if a dice roll does not align with the story that you want to tell or where a player wants to take a PC – talk about it first before allowing the dice to dictate where your story goes.

PUSHING & STRESS

If you fail your roll, you get the option to try again. This is called *pushing* the roll and must be done immediately after the initial roll is failed.

STRESS POINTS: Every time you push the roll, you take one point of stress. Stress is represented by *stress dice*. For each point of stress you have, you add a stress die to all skill rolls. Stress makes you more focused, which can be helpful, but also dangerous.

Custom stress dice are included in the Starter Set for this game, and more can be purchased separately. If you don't have access to the custom stress dice, just use any six-sided dice but with a separate color.

MESSING UP: If you roll one or more *ones* on your stress dice in a skill roll, the stress of the situation has caused you to make a mistake – you've *messed up*. The custom stress dice have a special walker symbol on the 1 side, to indicate this.

Messing up generally means that you raise the Threat Level one step. You have, for example, been loud enough to alarm a walker swarm, or failed to notice a walker until it attacks you. But messing up could also mean other things. The GM decides in what way your PC messes up, but you get to describe how it happens.

David (player 4): *If they do not come to help me, I try to find my way home on my own. I wait until it's dark and sneak out of a window.*

GM: *There are walkers all around the house, but they are spread out enough that you might be able to sneak past them. Roll for Stealth.*

David: *I open the window slowly, and climb down. There is a dumpster that I can hide behind, and then I try to sneak away. I roll four dice plus three stress dice. I get a six, which means I succeed, but I also roll a walker. I succeed but I also mess up.*

GM: *You sneak past them alright, all the way between the houses to the edge of the small community. You cannot hear their grunting anymore, and you think that you are safe. That is, until you notice that one of them has been following you. Somehow you missed it and now it is right behind you, and it throws itself at you. What do you do?*

OTHER DICE ROLLS

This game uses only six-sided dice, and they are used for more than just the skill rolls mentioned above. Here is a listing of the other kinds of dice rolls employed in various game situations.

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DICE ROLLS

DICE ROLL	WHAT YOU ROLL
Skill roll	Add up your skill and attribute, sixes mean successes
D6	Regular die roll
D66	Roll two dice – the first represents the tens, the other the ones
D666	Roll three dice – the first represents the hundreds, second the tens and the third the ones
Double high	Roll two dice, choose the highest
Double low	Roll two dice, choose the lowest
Random die	Everyone rolls a die, the lowest result loses
Lucky die	The GM rolls a die to decide something

DOUBLE HIGH, DOUBLE LOW: What happens in the game is sometimes decided by the Gamemaster rolling dice, as for instance if the player characters encounter a swarm of walkers and needs to randomly determine its size (see page 77). If this happens in a situation where the Gamemaster thinks it should be more likely to get either a high or a low result, they may choose to instead roll a double high or a double low. That means rolling two dice and going with the highest or the lowest outcome.

D66 AND D666: Another type of roll is the D66, which is typically rolled when consulting a table to decide what happens (see the Critical Injuries table on page 69). This means that you roll two six-sided dice. Before you roll, you decide which of them will represent the tens and which will be the ones. For instance, if you roll a 3 and a 6, the result is 36. If you have access to the custom base dice and stress dice for *The Walking Dead Universe RPG*, always use a base die for the tens and a stress die for the ones.

In rare cases, you even roll a D666. This means rolling three dice. The first is the hundreds, the second is the tens, and the third is the ones.

RANDOM DIE: In some situations – for example when you fight a swarm and the rules state that someone in the group has been bitten – you and the other players may be asked to roll a random die. This means that everyone rolls a die. High is good. The one with the lowest result is the one that gets bitten.

LUCKY DIE: The last type of dice roll is the Lucky die. This is used for situations where chance plays a big part and there are no rules or skills that apply. It could, for instance, be a situation where a PC is searching nearby houses for one with an unlocked door. They need to be lucky. The Gamemaster states the odds for finding an unlocked door, for example two in six. Then they roll a die in front of the players. If a 1 or 2 comes up, the PC has found an unlocked door.

ABSTRACT RULES

Many of the rules in this book are abstract – they will not always give you an exact outcome. What happens must be interpreted by the GM and the players together, to decide what course the story will take.

If, for example, you are hiding behind a stone pillar to avoid getting shot, and the shooter still hits you, it does not mean that the bullet has gone through the stone pillar. Probably, the attacker has moved around the pillar to get a clear shot.

Another example is if you try to stab a walker in the head, but fail. This does not necessarily mean that you did not hit it at all. Maybe you stabbed it in the chest, or you hacked it in the head but not hard enough to kill it.

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CHAPTER 2

THE WORLD OF THE DEAD

In the beginning, right after people understood that the world would never go back to the way it was, there were a lot of rumors about the dead. I heard people claim they had seen vampires, ghosts, all kinds of fairy tale creatures. A politician told us he'd been chased by the killer from a famous '80s slasher movie. But after we'd lived with walkers for a while, and they just kept coming, day after day, their novelty wore off. Nowadays, campfire stories are about the living. A loner we met outside Anderson swore he was being chased by a group of former students from Clemson University, now turned into naked cannibals. I guess we'll find out how true that one was – we're heading that way tomorrow.

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What is presented in this chapter should not be regarded as universal truths. That the world changed dramatically during a few fateful months at the outset of the apocalypse is for certain, but how the events affected societies and individuals around the globe is a matter too complex to cover in a book like this. For those who survived the initial destruction, including your PC, trustworthy information is scarce – often limited to what they have experienced first-hand, and whatever rumors they hear along their journey.

When you read the text below, keep in mind that not everyone living in the world of the dead has access to the same insights; not everyone has the same understanding of past events and the current state of the world.

This chapter covers three main topics: the outbreak and the days that followed; present-day circumstances, including walkers; and finally, the people that have managed to survive long enough for your PC to potentially encounter them.

PAST AND PRESENT

A multitude of disparate rumors are spreading amongst those living in the post-apocalyptic world. Some tell of paradisiacal safe havens with plenty of food and impenetrable fortifications – often said to be located near what were once major population centers. Others speak of a cure that can stop those who die from turning into walkers, that can prevent walker bites from being lethal, or even bring the dead back to life. Then there are the stories of what actually happened – reminders of all that has been lost.

WHAT HAPPENED?

Asking a common outbreak survivor how civilization could come to an end would probably yield little result. Who has time to ponder such things when there isn't enough food on the children's plates? When walkers are clawing at the front door? Still, for your PC and all who still draw breath, that question is always there, at the back of the mind, gnawing, aching for an answer...

Even if all the details don't align, a majority of survivors would agree that it all began with a virus. Opinions differ as to the origin of the disease, but that it started spreading at the turn of the decade around the early 2010s is accepted by most. During the months leading up to the authorities' public acknowledgment of the aptly named "Wildfire Virus," the warning signs had started to show. Cases of people with flu-like symptoms having violently attacked others were reported from all over the globe, and at an accelerating rate. By the time a pandemic was declared, the new reality was already common knowledge: Dead people were coming back to life, their minds blank except for a burning desire to devour the living.

Widespread chaos and panic ensued – hospitals quickly became overwhelmed; people abandoned their jobs to lock themselves in bunkers, or seek refuge outside the cities, leading to a swift breakdown in public services; there was mass hoarding and looting of survival essentials, soon followed by escalating violence and rioting. Most city areas saw massive gridlocks form as a result of people fleeing from danger, gridlocks that became permanent as vehicles were abandoned.

Governments, law enforcement, and the military tried to bring order to chaos in various ways; in some places they managed to establish safe zones – barricaded camps for civilians. But it did not last. Within a couple of weeks, saving civilians was no longer a priority. The U.S. military enacted a sunset protocol devised by the Department of Defense called Operation: Cobalt – a widespread bombing of major infected areas and city centers in a futile effort to contain the growing undead menace. In the end, the Wildfire virus could not be contained, nor could the proliferation of its victims who would become its perpetrators, swarming the world in the single-minded pursuit of living flesh.

WHEN IS NOW?

The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game can be set anywhere in the timeline after the outbreak, before, during, or after any season of the various television series. In a campaign, the exact date on which your game begins is up to you.

Exactly how the choice of starting date will impact the world that emerges around your gaming table is similarly up to the players to decide. The television franchise can give you inspiration and guidance, especially if and when you encounter heroes like Rick and Michonne from the various series. But in the end, unless you play a pre-made survival scenario (page 122), the world of *The Walking Dead* is yours to bring to life.

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THE WORLD THAT IS

Society as we recognized it before the outbreak is no more. The globalized world, where information could reach anyone in seconds, where vast distances could be covered in a matter of hours, where access to electricity, sanitation, and food was taken by many for granted, is gone. This is a world where information spreads person-to-person, where traveling means plodding through hostile terrain on foot or in rundown vehicles with little gas, where food needs to be grown or scavenged from walker-infested buildings, and where electricity is a luxury.

Survivors' perception of the world at large is limited to their nearby surroundings. They can meet travelers who tell tales from faraway places, but can such tales be trusted? And in a world where circumstances change drastically day-by-day, can you be sure that anything you're told still holds true? For most people clinging to life in the world of the dead, the universe is indeed quite small.

"My mom once told me, that the only thing more dangerous than the dead is the living, but without the living, we might as well be dead."

Judith Grimes

THE STRUGGLE

Life has always been a struggle, albeit to varying degrees and in different ways. But it is fair to say that the challenges and obstacles most survivors face after the outbreak are wholly unique, while the means to do so are incredibly limited and novel. A majority of the post-apocalyptic survivors live their lives in small communities, some settled in isolated locations, others always on the move. They rarely have security in food and other essentials, and they must always stay vigilant.

Over the years, pockets of civilization have emerged, and managed to recreate living conditions somewhat similar to pre-apocalyptic society. Sturdy walls have been erected, crops have been grown and animals bred; laws have been established and enforced. Hope has started to blossom – hope for the future.

But most communities are not so lucky. Most will eventually fall into ruin, overrun by massive walker swarms, destroyed by infighting or armed rebellions, emptied due to starvation, disease, or even the cold of winter. And should anyone survive, they must venture into the wilderness again, always searching for shelter and security, wondering whom they can trust, and what they should fear.

THE VALUE OF A LIFE

One aspect of living in the post-apocalyptic world is that the value of a human life is constantly in question. Before, the balance between the needs of the individual and the needs of the collective was regulated by laws established and upheld by a central authority. In the world of the dead, it is up to the group to agree on such matters, against a backdrop where everyone's life is constantly at risk.

Do we leave one behind to save many? Who gets to eat when food is scarce? How do we deal with a suspected, or even confessed, killer who is otherwise essential to the group's collective survival?

Those and similar questions arise all the time, and they cannot be neglected or deferred – decisions need to be made immediately, or people die. When morality and personal relationships hang in the balance, such debates can quickly become heated and emotional.

ADVANCED COMMUNITIES

Bigger and more advanced communities do exist, but most survivors never even hear of them as they are often quite secretive, and selective about whom they bring into their inner sanctum. Despite originating from a supposedly "civilized" society, their patrols can often be malevolent and represent danger to the unwitting survivor that crosses their path.

An example of such a community is the Civic Republic, based in what was once Philadelphia, Pennsylvania. Initially, the Republic collaborated with a few other secure cities in the advancement of civilization and science, but when resources became scarce, they turned on their allies, intent on wiping them out. This sequence of events may very well have similarly transpired in other places around the world, at the same or on a lesser scale.

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WALKERS

At the start of the outbreak, and during the months that followed, walkers were indeed seen as real-life monsters – horrifying and unnatural, causing dread and panic in everyone. Over time, this has changed. With the passing months and years, most survivors accept them as part of the post-apocalyptic world – certainly scary and dangerous, but more as a destructive force of nature comparable to the weather.

What follows are descriptions of a few key characteristics of the dead:

NEEDS: All walkers are single-mindedly focused on one thing: feeding. They are not intentionally cruel; they do not use excessive force – they just do whatever is necessary to satisfy that drive. They do not need food, water, or sleep, nor do they need to breathe.

FINAL DEATH: Walkers can get hurt, maimed, and even decapitated and still represent a threat. The only way to end them once and for all is to destroy their brains, be it with blunt force, a crossbow bolt, a bullet, a cleaving blade, or an all-consuming fire.

TRANSMISSION: At the time of the outbreak, all humans were already infected by a dormant strand of the pathogen that will make them turn into walkers upon death, provided that their brain is intact. Being bitten or even scratched by a walker will also lead to a lethal infection, that ends with the victim dying and, shortly thereafter, reanimating as one of the walking dead. The only possible escape from this is to immediately amputate the wounded limb, before the infection can spread.

It should be noted that no other species seem affected. Animals do not turn into walkers.

AWAKENING: How long it takes for a dead person to turn varies greatly. Some people turn in a matter of minutes, while others appear dead for hours before stirring.

ACTIVITY: In general, encountered walkers behave in two different ways: either as wandering roamers or as lethargic lurkers. Experience suggests that, at least in some cases, roamers start behaving like lurkers when they have gone without feeding for a period of time and no food source is nearby.

SENSES: Walkers typically have poor eyesight, which they make up for with heightened hearing and smell. Darkness doesn't seem to hinder them at close range. What can alert a walker is bright light, foreign scents, and loud noises.

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CHANGE OVER TIME: In essence, walkers do not evolve or naturally heal, they deteriorate. Ever so slowly, the bodies of the dead decompose. Hence, shortly after the outbreak, all walkers looked very much like the living, at least compared to the withered, damaged, maimed figures you will encounter in later years – possibly mixed with a few recently turned individuals.

NATURE

Nature is reclaiming the world from the living. After the outbreak, it did not take long before cities were overtaken with wildlife and vegetation. The air and waters slowly became cleaner, farm and zoo animals roamed free, and animal habitats emerged in areas previously populated by society. In short, nature and wildlife are thriving in the post-apocalyptic world. For your PC, this means more game, fish, and edible plants, but also more threats in the form of predators returned to their apexes in the absence of civilization.

WHERE IS HERE?

You will come to notice that most examples in this book describe situations that take place in the United States, just like the various television series. But as with the date, you are welcome to decide on a different location for your game. Why not launch a campaign set in and around your hometown? Or your favorite vacation spot? You will need an area map covering the location, as described in later sections of this book (page 97), but other than that, you can place your game just about anywhere in the world.

Dear Julia

They told me you and the others had already left before we ran into the herd. Mom says we'll "catch up" with you in Knoxville. I know she's lying. She acts like we're still in the old world – like those ways of parenting and living still apply. Her only job now is to keep us alive, but she's too soft. So I have to do it myself. The truth is, I saw you and your parents behind us as we were trying to fight our way through the herd. You screamed my name just as they grabbed you, and I turned around and saw you get bitten. I saw your skin tear, and the blood. I replay those images over and over again in my head. I can't help it. You were my best friend, my only friend. But I know that every time I see the image of you falling into the masses of dead, I get stronger.

If you go for a location that differs from the television series, in the U.S. or elsewhere, you should not be afraid to let your imagination run wild. You can have the circumstances be drastically different from what Rick, Michonne, and the others must deal with. As this is a roleplaying game, what you make of it is up to you.

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PEOPLE

Despite the drastically changed world that people find themselves in, people are still people. The competition over power and influence, the want for more and better, the fight for an easier life – all elements of the human condition that remain in the post-apocalypse. Even if the things people desire are less extravagant, and the monsters more real, humankind is what it has always been, driven by desire, fear, ambition, and love.

FRIENDS AND FOES

The people in your group may have their quirks, mood swings, and even damaging flaws; you may disagree on even the most basic values and view the world from completely different perspectives. Still, for one reason or another, you have ended up together, and now you must try to get along, for the safety of all. In a word, with all that is at stake, you are a family.

Strangers, on the other hand, are always a threat. They may look innocent or come off as both reasonable and kind. But appearances are deceiving, and deception can lead to all sorts of problems. Countless survivors have met their demise because they trusted the wrong people.

In spite of this, survivors seem compelled to seek each other out, and take a chance. Humans need to feel they belong, to build bonds, and there is also safety in numbers. And so there is a flicker of hope that remains upon meeting a stranger – a hope that they will prove honest and loyal; that they will provide the group with skills, resources, or at least another set of hands for labor and defense. In the effort to rebuild some form of civilization, having a critical mass of people by your side remains paramount.

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THOSE WHO SURVIVE

During the days following the outbreak, who lived and who perished was to a large extent decided by chance: where you happened to live, whether you could escape in time. Later, luck ceded ground to fitness – whether you possessed the qualities, skills, and resources that increase your chances of surviving a harsh new landscape.

In the post-apocalypse, phrases like "only the strong survive" barely begin to address what is necessary to persevere. Strength is surely a factor, but is simply not enough without a combination of other traits related to abilities, community, mindset, and resources.

As for the mindset, most survivors can be described as having an astonishing will to live, coupled with an almost superhuman capacity for optimism. This is not to say that they never despair or have their dark days. But despite the world being as it is, they are able to pick themselves up and find the strength to carry on, for one reason or another.

One such reason may be their companions – even if they are not biologically related, members of their group become people they learn to love and trust. And the bigger and more diverse a group is, the better. Sure, diversity can lead to differing opinions and arguments, but it can also provide the group with a wide array of skills necessary for survival that no individual could hope to achieve alone – hunting, construction, cooking, medicine, leadership, fighting, and more.

Finally, a few words on resources. Later in this book you will find lists of equipment, weapons, vehicles, and items that can be scavenged from places your PC comes across. You cannot bring along everything you find, but together with your companions you will likely be able to carry everything you truly need, even if traveling on foot. Aside from basic camping gear, every member of your party will need some kind of weapon against the dead; you need items to manage your hygiene, to keep warm and avoid getting sick; and of course, you need enough provisions to keep you fed for several days. And don't forget spare socks! Keeping your feet dry in the apocalypse is an absolute imperative.

Dear Alona

When you and Rebecca joined us, I assumed you were a couple since you were always together. Then you started hangin' out with Rodriguez of all people, and told me you and Rebecca were just "friends." She didn't see it that way. Typical me, my relationship with Rebecca started with me trying to patch up her broken heart. We talked so much shit about you in those early days. I didn't mean any of it, even back then. Now, I'm thankful that you treated her the way you did – it gave me a chance at happiness. I'm not holding back, not anymore. I got Rebecca, and that's all I ever wanted. We don't care that you were unreliable and selfish, that you took one of our cars and stole half the supplies. I was still sad when we found you hanging from that tree, gnashing at the air, looking at us with those dead eyes.

WHAT TO LIVE FOR

Everyone loses hope at one time or another, and those who cannot find it again will not survive. The others will manage to pull out of their despair for a variety of reasons. For your PC, this is called their *Drive* (see page 25).

Protecting loved ones – be it children, parents, a spouse, or very dear friends – is at the top of the list. Then it is not uncommon for some to feel a strong sense of duty, not only to their closest group of friends, but also to society or humankind at large. Hatred, too, can be a powerful motivator – a thirst for revenge against those who have wronged you, giving your life purpose and direction.

For some, the idea of rebuilding civilization seems like a tangible aim. What kind of society they envision varies greatly – from electoral democracies and military dictatorships, to religious or royal autocracies. Some start from a position of power, as mayor of a rural community, leaders of a big parish or congregation, or officers commanding a military squad; others start with nothing but a tight-knit group that can imagine a better tomorrow.

Lastly, the hope for a cure lingers in the backs of many minds. There are those who believe that they are capable of finding some kind of treatment for what has befallen the world – a vaccine, an antidote, or some other remedy. Noble as their intentions are, these academics can prove more ruthless than most in their quest. After all, what considerations can be more important than what they are trying to achieve?

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CHAPTER 3

THE PLAYER CHARACTERS

Money don't mean anything anymore, but everything has a price. Free Town offered security and resources in their majestic six story building, but anyone wanting to join them had to pay for the privilege. They'd created a community by taking from others and spreading fear wherever they went. Supposedly, they even had electricity, hot water, and a functional movie theater on the top floor! We never found out if it was true. Once we got back the stuff they'd stolen from us, Hannah had us build a big bonfire that blocked their exit. We watched the building light up the night sky like a flaming hand reaching from hell, desperately trying to touch heaven.

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This chapter is about creating and playing your PC. You should create it together with the other players, so that the PCs can develop complicated and interesting relationships with each other right from the start.

You begin by selecting an archetype, giving your PC a name, and determining its Issue and Drive. With that done, you can shift focus to the PC's characteristics, by deciding how proficient they are in terms of attributes, skills, and talents.

Before moving on to sections describing archetypes and available equipment, aspects such as stress and anchors, relationships, gear, and how to evolve your PC with experience are discussed.

SURVIVAL MODE: If you're playing a survival mode game, such as the one starting on page 136 or the one included in the Starter Set for this game, you will use pre-generated characters instead of creating your own.

CREATING YOUR CHARACTER

1. Choose an archetype.
2. Choose a name.
3. Choose an Issue.
4. Choose your Drive.
5. Distribute 13 points amongst your attributes.
6. Distribute 12 points amongst your skills.
7. Choose a talent.
8. Choose your gear.
9. Define relationships to the other PCs.
10. Choose two Anchors.
11. Describe your starting haven.

"In this life now, you kill or you die. Or you die and you kill."

The Governor

CORE ASPECTS

You build your PC based on decisions about their background and personality. These become the foundation of your PC. As the story progresses, you will find out more about yourself and your relationships to the other PCs.

ARCHETYPE

Your *archetype* says something about who you were before the outbreak. Since then you have changed... just like the walkers have changed from what they were before they died. There are twelve archetypes to choose from, described on page 34 and forward.

Note that your archetype is just a starting point and inspiration to create your own unique PC. After play has started, your archetype no longer has any mechanical effect.

NO ARCHETYPE?

If you already have a clear idea of what your PC should be like, you can create it freely without using an archetype. In this case, you need to choose your key attribute, key skills, starting talent, and gear with the GM's approval. You will also need to come up with your own Issue, Drive, and Relationships.

NAME

Make up a name for your PC, preferably a name which is easily remembered and that somehow stands out.

ISSUE

Everyone who is alive in the world of the dead has an Issue – something that is problematic or challenging about their person. An Issue could be almost anything: being an alcoholic, trusting people too easily, being lonely and longing for company, and so on. Each archetype has suggestions on Issues. Choose one of them, or come up with something on your own.

Issues have two functions. The most important is to help you understand and roleplay your PC. The other is to give the GM inspiration for creating Challenges in the story. If you, for example, are protective of children and cannot stand to see them get hurt, there will probably come a time when you will hear babies crying inside a building that is surrounded by walkers. It is up to you to decide how your PC handles it. You might risk it all to save those babies – or you find out that children are not that important to your PC after all.

It is possible to change your Issue at any time, but it works best to do it between sessions. You always have at least one Issue.

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Dear Roger

You didn't speak much, and what you said made no sense at all. Still, we all loved your smile, and you knew your place in the group. I know I probably underestimated you. At the end it was your strength that saved the rest of us. If you hadn't been able to remove the beam that blocked our escape, we would've all been swarmed and eaten. You gave your life for the group. The only way I can repay you is to protect your ma and keep all her new "children" on the straight and narrow. We'll all take care of her.

DRIVE

Your Drive is the thing that makes you grit your teeth and push through the fear and pain. Your Drive could be that you are looking for your daughter, or that you are afraid of dying. It is whatever keeps you going.

Once every session you may use your Drive to get a +2 modifier on a skill roll (page 48). Describe how it motivates you and makes you able to push on, then roll two extra base dice for the skill roll. You must declare that you use your Drive before the roll.

You may change your Drive at any time, or, as a consequence of not being able to handle your fear, you might lose your Drive. This process is described on page 26.

SCARS

If you want to, you can roll a die to determine a random scar or a trauma you begin the game with. Say something about when and where you got it, and how it affects you now:

1. **Dead eyes.** Something happened that put out your inner light, even when you're smiling on the surface.
2. **Ugly scar.** Someone or something hurt you badly, and you barely survived.
3. **Prematurely aged.** Something about you makes people believe you are way older than your actual age. It could, for example, be that your hair has turned gray, that your face has wrinkles, or that your body is thin and broken.
4. **Bullet hole.** You were shot and survived.
5. **Something is missing.** You lost an ear, an eye, a finger, a toe, or something else.
6. **Traumatized.** Something that happened left traces in your behavior and appearance. It could be textbook PTSD symptoms such as nightmares and flashbacks, or a stutter that won't go away, a tendency to never look anyone in the eyes, or a fear of having someone standing behind you.

CHARACTERISTICS

Attributes, talents, and skills indicate what your character is good at. Together, they are referred to as characteristics.

ATTRIBUTES

You have four attributes, which indicate your core strengths and weaknesses. They are Strength, Agility, Wits, and Empathy. You have 13 points to distribute between these attributes. The minimum value is 2 and the maximum is 4, except for the key attribute of your chosen archetype, which has a maximum value of 5.

STRENGTH is a measure of how tough you are. It is the ability to take and deliver a beating. It determines things like how long you can go without food or rest, and how easily you pry open a blocked door.

AGILITY is a measure of your coordination and motor skills. It is used, for example, when you sneak away from something dangerous, when you try to balance on an icy rooftop, and when you shoot a gun.

WITS is your intellectual capacity, which you use to solve problems. It also reflects your prior education, and your general level of world-weariness.

EMPATHY represents your ability to understand other people, and to persuade, charm, or trick them.

SKILLS

Skills represent acquired knowledge, training, and experience. There are twelve skills, three connected to each base attribute. Each skill has a level between 0 and 5. You get to distribute 12 points between your skills. At the start of the game, you cannot have more than 2 in any skill, except for the main skill of your chosen archetype, which you may spend 3 points on. The skills are described in detail in chapter 4.

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SKILLS	
Close Combat	(Strength)
Endure	(Strength)
Force	(Strength)
Mobility	(Agility)
Ranged Combat	(Agility)
Stealth	(Agility)
Scout	(Wits)
Survival	(Wits)
Tech	(Wits)
Leadership	(Empathy)
Manipulation	(Empathy)
Medicine	(Empathy)

TALENTS

Talents are tricks, traits, and abilities that can benefit you in various situations. They affect your dice rolls, or they let you do things you would not otherwise be able to do. Talents are described in chapter 4.

Your archetype restricts your choice to one of three starting talents. As you play and gain experience points, you can buy more talents by choosing freely among them (including starting talents from other archetypes).

Each talent comes with a prerequisite, something that must have happened in your life for you to gain it. If, for instance, you want to have the talent Ice in the Veins, you must have survived an attack from a walker. For your starting talent, the prerequisite is a part of your background.

When you buy a new talent, the prerequisite could be something that happened in game or as part of your backstory that we haven't heard about before. Describe this event to the others when you get the talent.

HEALTH POINTS

All PCs and NPCs each have three Health points. Each point of damage removes one point of Health. If you lose all of them, you are Broken and suffer a critical injury. Damage and healing are described in chapter 5.

HEALTH	
3	Unharmed
2	Bruised
1	Battered
0	Broken

STRESS AND ANCHORS

When scary or distressing things happen, your PC takes Stress. You can also suffer stress by pushing skill rolls. Having stress lets you add *stress dice* to any skill roll, but you also risk messing up and attracting walkers. Stress and stress dice are described in chapter 5. You start the game without stress.

ANCHORS

You have two people in the group who are important to you. In game, you can interact with them to relieve stress. An Anchor can be someone like a friend, a lover, your parent, or your child.

One of the Anchors is always an NPC in your group, and the other is always another PC. You can never have more than two Anchors, but you can lose them if, for instance, they get killed or if they become mad at you and tell you to stay away from them.

Under Relationships on page 29, you can learn about how to define the NPCs in your group of survivors. Choose one of them as your Anchor and one of your fellow PCs as your other Anchor.

GAINING A NEW ANCHOR

You can lose your Anchor in many ways. They may get killed, kidnapped, or end up on different sides in a conflict within the haven. To get a new Anchor you must create a situation where you clearly rely on, trust, live for, or put your faith in another person. When this is established in the game, you may state that the person becomes your new Anchor. You can still only have one NPC Anchor and one PC Anchor at a time.

HANDLE YOUR FEAR

When you play, bad things will happen, and your PC risks being pushed beyond their limits. At the end of each session, the GM will go through the list of Breaking Points on the next page. If any of these things

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BREAKING POINTS

If any of these things happen during a session, you need to handle your fear.

- An Anchor gets killed or disappears.
- An Anchor turns against you or leaves you.
- You kill or brutally beat someone who can't defend themselves.
- You are Broken by damage.
- You have, at some point during the session, accumulated 5 Stress.
- Something you built or struggled hard to achieve, such as your haven, gets destroyed.

OVERWHELMED

D6	EFFECT
1–2	You lose your Drive.
3–5	You become Shattered.
6	Your Issue changes, or you gain another one.

happened to you during the session, you need to roll to handle your fear.

When you try to handle your fear, you roll as many dice as either your Wits or your Empathy allow (your choice). Add +2 for each Anchor who is still alive and on your side. You do not add stress dice. Rolls to handle your fear cannot be pushed.

If you get at least one 6 the roll is successful, and you have managed to handle your fear. But if you fail the roll, you are overwhelmed by fear. Roll on the Overwhelmed table to see what happens.

LOSING DRIVE

Whatever motivated you to stay alive in the past, does not motivate you any longer. It could still be a part of your personality, but you cannot use it to get a +2 bonus on a skill roll.

To regain your Drive, or get a new Drive, your PC must show that they still have things to fight for. And they must keep doing it over time. When you and the Gamemaster agree that this is the case, you regain your Drive. It often takes at least a session to regain your Drive, sometimes an entire campaign.

SHATTERED

When you become Shattered, you start suffering from delusions, bad habits, or beliefs accumulated as a result of losing your mind. You couldn't handle your fear, and now you are changed. The table Shattered gives some ideas, but you can come up with anything that suits your PC and their current Issue.

SHATTERED

Talks to dead people
Sees dead people
Thinks the walkers are alive
Protects one special walker
Wants to die
Emotionally shut off
Involuntary rage
Paranoid
Obsessive-compulsive behavior

It is not easy to get back from being Shattered. You must roleplay, in sessions and scenes, how you find a way to move forward and leave the fear behind. Most often the whole group will decide together when it seems like the PC has healed enough to stop being Shattered.

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GEAR

The things you carry should be written on your character sheet – if it isn't, you do not have it with you. Your capability to carry things is measured in *encumbrance slots*. You have a number of slots equal to your Strength plus two. If you have Strength 2, then you have four slots.

Most items take up one slot, for example a rifle with ammunition or a toolbox. Some items only take up half a slot, such as a knife or a ration of food and water. Big and heavy items, such as a heavy machine gun, take up several slots. Small items, such as a lighter or a comb do not take up slots at all, but you still need to write them on your sheet to have them with you.

You are assumed to have things to put stuff in, such as bags or backpacks. You can describe these or be emotionally attached to them, but such items do not give you more slots. But if you have a car or similar, you can put as much as you want in it – up to a practical limit, of course. You still need to write down what you carry on your person, in case you need to leave the car.

STARTING GEAR: When you start the game, you roll three times on the Gear table for your archetype; reroll if you get the same result again, until you have three different items. You also get to roll one time on the Scavenging table in the appendix (page 151).

RATIONS: When the game starts, you are in your haven. In the haven, there is enough food and water for all of you, at least if you keep hunting and finding stuff in the surrounding area.

If you leave the haven, or if your supplies run out, you need to keep track of rations. A ration is an abstract measure of food and water. You must consume one ration each day, or you will starve (page 72).

EXPERIENCE

At the end of each session, you get Experience points (XP). They can be used to buy new talents or points in skills (to a maximum of 5). Buying a skill point or a new talent costs 10 XP. You may save your XP for later or use them immediately, but you can only buy skill points and talents after or before a session, not in game.

Though there are other ways to earn XP, the primary way is to answer the questions for XP after each session (see the boxed text Questions for XP). For each "yes," you get one XP.

QUESTIONS FOR XP

1. Did you participate in the session? (you always get at least one XP)
2. Did you achieve something important? What?
3. Did you learn something? What?
4. Did you explore at least one new sector on the travel map (page 92)?
5. Did your Drive, your Issue, or any of your relationships make an impact on the session?
6. Did you hold a Dearly Departed Monologue? (Roll a double low to see how many XP you get)

DEARLY DEPARTED MONOLOGUES

One way to earn XP is to hold a Dearly Departed Monologue. All sessions except the first one start with a Dearly Departed Monologue. This means that one of the PCs holds a monologue directed to a dead PC or an NPC (or to someone the PC thinks is dead). The monologue should contain something that happened last session.

Only one player gets to hold a Dearly Departed Monologue per session. The monologue should be short and say something about what is going on inside the PC's mind. You do not have to direct it to someone who died last session; it could be to a person from the PC's past. There are examples of Dearly Departed Monologues in every chapter of this book.

When you have held your monologue, you get to roll a double low. The result is the number of XP you get. Recollecting the past and pondering the current situation is a way to learn things.

Dearly Departed Monologues are not a hard rule. You do not have to use them if you do not want to. Should that be the case, you may skip it altogether. Or, for example, if only one player wants to hold them, they may do it every session, and then you split the XP for their monologues between all PCs.

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RELATIONSHIPS

You should define your relationship to all the other PCs. Choose one of the relationships for your archetype or come up with something on your own. Check with each other player to ensure that the chosen relationship seems alright. If they are not okay with your choice, you must change it.

NPCS IN THE GROUP

When you start the game, you have five NPC survivors in your group. They live with you in your haven. The GM may give you five pre-generated starting NPC survivors, or you can determine them randomly by rolling on the NPC Survivors table.

Go through these NPCs together and add some details that make them come alive. The GM may add a secret Issue to one of them – some kind of problem you do not know about yet.

When you have determined who the NPCs are, you should decide something about your relationship to each of them.

NPC STATS

NPCs don't have attributes, skills, or talents. When they use a skill, the GM rolls four dice. Some NPCs are considered either trained or expert in a skill. A trained NPC gets +1 to the skill (rolls five dice). An expert gets +4 to the skill (rolls eight dice). Some extremely capable NPCs are considered to be master at a skill, and they add +6 dice to the skill (rolls ten dice).

An NPC cannot push skill rolls. They don't take stress, and they do not have Anchors or a Drive. All NPCs have 3 Health Points.

However, NPCs have Issues, things about them that may cause problems. For the starting NPCs, you get to know these Issues. But for all other NPCs you meet in the game, the GM will not tell you about their Issues. It is up to you to find out who they are by interacting with them.

CHARACTER DEATH

When your PC dies, you should start over with a new PC. You could either take over one of the NPC survivors in the group or create a new PC from scratch. If you create a new PC, they get introduced in the campaign during the next session.

If you choose to take over an NPC Survivor, you get some bonuses when you convert them to a PC. You begin by distributing skill points as you normally do when creating a new PC. Then you get to add one skill point in each skill the NPC was trained in, and two skill points in each skill they were expert in. As a result of this, you may exceed the starting limitations for skill points for new PCs.

NPC survivors may have several Issues, but you still only have one when taking them as a PC. It may be one of their Issues – even a secret Issue – but you could also come up with something new that better describes that character's current situation. If you want to, you can wait one or two sessions to define Anchors and relationships.

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NPC SURVIVORS

Roll a D6 to determine which group of NPC Survivors you begin the game with.

D6	NAME	BACKGROUND	EXPERT	TRAINED	ISSUES	GEAR
1	Anthony Brooks	Teacher	—	Survival, Tech	Stubborn, sleeps with Abigail	Car, revolver, map with a safe house marked out
	Melissa Anderson	Screenplay writer	—	Manipulation	Easily scared, looks to others for protection	Kitchen knife, big flashlight, taser
	Robert Young	Kid	—	Stealth, Mobility	Thinks he can take care of himself, asthmatic	—
	Bobby Miller	Boxer and thief	Close Combat	Mobility	Wants to be top dog, secretly in love with Melissa	Hammer, Vespa
	Abigail Miller	Farmer	—	Tech, Endure	Will protect her son Bobby at any cost, sleeps with Anthony, broken foot that healed badly	Shotgun, pitchfork, seeds that can be planted
2	George Lee	Plumber	—	Scout, Tech	Only one eye	Axe, tent, survival gear, canned food
	Kayla Clark	Dancer	—	Close Combat, Mobility	Easily insulted, wants to know what is happening	Spear, bicycle, American football helmet
	Doris Young	Elderly	Tech	Leadership	Sick and frail, keeps to the old morals and laws	Wheelchair, bottle of schnapps
	Elijah Flores	Politician	—	Manipulation	Has a way with words, visionary, dislikes Doris Young	Dog named Rosa, small revolver
	Amber King	Soldier	—	Ranged Combat, Close Combat	Protects Elijah Flores and believes every word he says	Assault rifle, three hand grenades, bayonet, camouflage gear, survival equipment, good maps, compass, wind up radio
3	Betty "Anvil" Hall	Teen punk rocker	—	Survival, Stealth	Won't talk about what happened to her	Knife
	Daniel Perez	Stockbroker	—	Leadership, Manipulation	Exaggerates his own ability, wants to keep the group together	Pistol
	Nicole Perez	Immigrant/ domestic worker	—	Medicine, Scout	Trusts no one	Pistol, basic medical supplies
	Samuel Carter	Construction worker	Close Combat	Endure	Looks out for his daughter Denise, will follow the strongest leader	Hammer, rifle
	Denise Carter	Kid	—	Stealth	Traumatized, emotionally sensitive and empathetic	Hidden revolver

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D6	NAME	BACKGROUND	EXPERT	TRAINED	ISSUES	GEAR
4	Raymond Green	Doctor	Medicine	Manipulation	Depressed, mourns his family	Advanced medical gear
	Emma Wilson	Athlete	—	Endure, Mobility	Injured, God-fearing	Bow and arrows, tent
	Ryan Smith	Senior citizen	—	Tech, Survival	Taciturn, plans for the worst	Mobile home, toolkit, rifle
	Sharon Smith	Senior citizen	—	Ranged Combat	Careless, wants everyone to feel good, loud	Revolver, 3 liquor bottles
	Anna Jones	Spiritualistic medium	—	Medicine, Manipulation	Believes she will save mankind, dissociates	Bludgeon, holy symbols, dream catchers, incense, magic mushrooms
5	Nicolas White	Criminal	—	Close Combat, Ranged Combat	Only respects strength, loves to tease and harass others	Machete, revolver
	Amy Hall	Soldier	Ranged Combat	Force	Rules with an iron fist, macho	Assault rifle, explosive paste, pistol, knife, night-googles
	Ronald Green	Engineer	—	Tech, Scout	Tries to not get in anyone's way, dependent on others for protection, a poet	Toolkit, hand wired radio
	Ki Wilson	Nurse	—	Medicine, Manipulation	Will do whatever it takes	Basic medical gear
	Demián Vergara	Drifter	—	Survival	Searches for something to believe in, does not take shit from anyone	Revolver, screwdriver,
6	Gael Barraza	Psychotherapist	Leadership	Manipulation	Eager to make hard decisions, empathically exhausted	Rifle, a pair of sharp scissors, several packs of cigarettes
	Angela Flores	Medical student	—	Medicine, Tech, Manipulation	Does not share her pains and concerns, takes care of her baby	Basic medical gear
	Jacob Flores	Baby	—	—	Unwanted baby to a young mother, screams when scared, hungry, tired, or sick	—
	Jason Lee	Farmer	—	Survival, Endure	Thinks he is responsible for the others, wants to keep everyone happy	Sniper rifle, big knife, guitar, hidden stash of marshmallows
	Barbara Ferrara	Runaway teen	—	Close Combat, Stealth	Secretly in love with Angela Flores, wants to protect the others from the harsh realities in the world, likes to take risks	Big axe, stiletto, revolver, motorbike

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YOUR HAVEN

During the game, you will stay at different places that are temporarily safe. Your current home base is called the haven. A haven could be anything from a tent on a roof to a bunker filled with supplies, or a whole town with people and walls keeping the walkers out.

A haven is described mechanically by two ratings: Capacity and Defense. Capacity is an abstract value that represents how many people it can sustain, while Defense measures how well-protected you are inside it.

Capacity and Defense range from 0 to 6. Your starting haven has 2 in Capacity or Defense, and 1 in the other. It is possible to increase Capacity and Defense by working on projects – this is described in more detail in chapter 6.

Havens have Issues, just like you. These are potential problems, weak spots, or things that may break or cause inconveniences. The Gamemaster may add secret Issues; weak spots you do not know about yet.

The GM may decide the details of the haven and simply present it to you, or you may get a say in creating some parts of the haven, or even create the whole thing from scratch yourselves.

In chapter 6, there are questions that the GM may ask you about the haven, as well as example Issues.

On the next page, you will find three examples of starting havens. You may choose one of them if you like and flesh it out with descriptions and details.

"I hereby declare we have spaghetti Tuesdays every Wednesday. First we have to find some spaghetti."

Hershel Greene

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STARTING HAVENS

THE BUS ON A HILL

You have placed some tents in a circle around an abandoned (and broken) bus on a hillside. It is a good spot to see intruders before they manage to run up the high slopes, and it takes time for walkers to get to you. But you do not have any real defenses, except the person currently on watch duty on top of the bus. One good thing is that the camp is nestled far away from major roads and potential plunderers. Whoever was here before you left a big stash of canned food in the bus. It is possible to hunt for food in the forest surrounding the hill.

CAPACITY	**2**
DEFENSE	**1**

ISSUES:

- Reliance on a food source that will become depleted.
- Fresh water in a creek deep in the forest.
- Someone left that food here, and they might come back for it.
- Easy to spot the bus from afar.

THE FACTORY

You have managed to close all the gates leading into an old factory. It is huge inside with great halls, strange machines, and winding corridors. It is easy to shoot at intruders from the second floor, and, if walkers break in, you can find shelter on the balconies. But there is hardly any food left, and you need to go on constant food raids in the dangerous residential areas nearby. Also, the inside of the factory is too big to keep track of. People or walkers who break in may move around without you noticing it.

CAPACITY	**1**
DEFENSE	**2**

ISSUES:

- Relies on food runs.
- Possible undiscovered holes in the outer walls.
- No fresh water.
- Easy to hide inside.

THE VILLA

You have gotten your hands on what must have been a rich family's home. This three-story wooden house painted in white and pink somehow still smells fresh, and there are clean towels and enough clothes for all of you. There is a piano on the ground floor and a lot of whiskey bottles. Unfortunately, this is also the type of house that attracts plunderers. You fixed the fence around the house and built a warning system with ropes and old cans, and you have covered the windows with blankets. But it would still be easy for a large walker swarm to smash through, if they knew you were here. You have a lot of stored food in the basement and a well just outside the house. But soon, you must start looking for more food.

CAPACITY	**2**
DEFENSE	**1**

ISSUES:

- Reliance on a food source that will become depleted.
- Target for plunderers.
- Several entry points.

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THE CRIMINAL

I used to hate moaners and crybabies. In high school we'd target classmates we thought were weak. Pretending to invite them to join our crew, we stuffed them into my old Chevrolet, drove them up to the old water tower, and made them suffer for whatever petty thing was bugging us about them. Later, there were drugs; along with them came more serious beatings and fights. They called me Killer, even though I never murdered anyone. Strange as it may sound, this new world has somehow made me softer. Now I want to protect the kind of people I used to torment. They're family, some of them. But when something threatens us, I become the Killer again.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Strength
KEY SKILL: Close Combat
TALENTS: Threatening Posture, Fixer, Fights Dirty

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- I never obey authority
- Drug addict
- Ashamed of my past

DRIVE

- Nobody takes a swing at me and gets away with it
- Hate
- I will find my sisters

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Big revolver
2. Axe
3. Lockpick
4. Motorbike
5. Shotgun
6. Stash of drugs and medicine

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- Sibling
- Annoying but useful
- I'm on to you

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THE DOCTOR

New diseases always hit the medical staff the hardest. I was right in the middle of it, in the ER at Atlanta's busiest hospital, when people started to turn. I lost so many. Jane, my wife Julia, Harry, and Tom. I don't know a single person who got out of there, except me. Before I ran, I examined one of them, a girl who was strapped to a bed before she died. This is no ordinary sickness. Maybe it really is the end of days, in a biblical sense? My theory is as good as anyone's.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Empathy
KEY SKILL: Medicine
TALENTS: Emergency Medicine, Doctor/Patient Hierarchy, Seen it All

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Bitter
- Sworn to help
- Unanswered love

DRIVE

- Fear of dying
- Higher purpose
- I will find my wife

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Basic medical gear
2. Medications and drugs
3. Spear (Scalpel taped to a stick)
4. Car
5. Diary
6. Pistol

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- I trust you.
- You are not like us.
- I want to get to know you better

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THE FARMER

They say cattle are dumb, but it's people who are really stupid. We all knew something was going to hit us, sooner or later: a terrorist attack, global warming, or whatever. Still, no one prepared enough. I've met people who didn't know how to light a fire or skin a rabbit. None of them are alive anymore. When it all started, me and my wife and our kids went down into the basement, as planned. We had supplies enough for us and twenty more that would last for months. A group of assholes blew up the basement door and managed to break in. I offered them a chance to join us. Instead, they killed my family. But the explosion and the gunshots attracted hundreds of stinkers. The house was overrun; the thieves joined the dead. I had to leave the supplies behind and run for my life.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Strength
KEY SKILL: Force
TALENTS: Tracker, Tough as Nails, Living off the Land

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Rage
- Sick
- Dogmatist

DRIVE

- I do what is right
- Never give up
- Jesus walks with me

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Shotgun
2. Axe
3. Jeep
4. Toolbox
5. Tent
6. Survival equipment

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- You are hiding something
- We are different, but I like you
- You are family

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THE HOMEMAKER

I am a living cliché. Or I was. Brandon wanted me to stay in the house. At first, I thought it was because he couldn't trust anyone to resist me, being the prom queen and everything. But when the kids came and all I'd done for years was cook food, clean, and wash clothes, I realized he thought he owned me. He didn't beat me. Well, he did, but he told himself he didn't. When the world fell apart, he just disappeared. Maybe he's still out there. I wonder if he would recognize me. I've learned to shoot a gun. I know how to kill with a knife or with my hands. Sometimes I even like it. Not that much of a cliché anymore, right?

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Strength
KEY SKILL: Endure
TALENTS: Innocent Face, Back Against the Wall, Rather Die than Break

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Bloodthirsty
- Alcoholic
- Craves attention and love

DRIVE

- Sworn to never be a victim again
- Has endured hell
- Won't give up my dream

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Shovel
2. Bow and arrows
3. Bag with medical herbs
4. Painkillers
5. Tent
6. Car

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- Makes me smile
- We pretend to like each other
- Sister

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THE KID

You would think that people like me, who've lived most of our lives in this hell and hardly remember the days before, would've come out seriously damaged, or at least weird. That is simply not the case, in my experience. I'd trust another wasteland baby ten times over an adult from another group trying to get close to me. Maybe it was the shock when their whole world fell apart that did it to them. I don't really care. We'll be the ones to build something new. I keep the grown-ups I trust close: mum, dad, and my older brother. The others scare me more than the dead.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Agility
KEY SKILL: Mobility
TALENTS: Knife Fighter, Stubborn, A Child of this World

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Afraid of the dark
- People treat me like a child
- Won't let anyone come close

DRIVE

- My father thinks that I am strong
- Kids will grow up to rule this world
- I will protect my friends

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Pistol with homemade silencer
2. Spear
3. American football gear (Armor Value 4)
4. Scooter
5. D6 Molotov cocktails
6. Dog

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- Parent
- I am watching you
- Idol

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THE LAW ENFORCER

There is so much baggage that comes with the job: how people treat you, what they think of you, what everyone supposes you believe in, and think is right, and all those eyes looking at you expectantly whenever there's a crisis. You forget who you really are. At the start of this new world, I kept playing my part, doing right, trying to lead others to safety. After I was ambushed by a group I'd just saved from a herd of biters, I somehow finally realized that this job could get me killed. I still wear the hat and badge; it gives me an edge. But let's just say I've now come to believe in a less equal application of the law.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Wits
KEY SKILL: Scout
TALENTS: Steady Hands, Watchful, Moral Compass

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Does not trust strangers
- Depressed
- I take risks to protect my child

DRIVE

- Does what it takes
- I am the law
- We will build a new world

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Riot gear (Armor Level 6)
2. Revolver
3. Shotgun
4. Axe
5. Assault rifle
6. Badge of office

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- I protect you
- I trust you
- You are a puzzle

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THE NOBODY

The last time I spoke with my mother, she kept mixing me up with my brother, and it's not like she was even senile or anything. She couldn't recall the name of my first girlfriend or who my friends were at school. It hurt at the time, but now I get it – some days, even I don't remember those things. My life had been a haze of average grades, boring weekends, mediocre sports results, and uninspired dreams. It's hard to make others understand how different my situation is now from back then. For me, the biggest change is not the bombed-out landscape and the walking dead, but how it is between me and the people around me. They see me as important. They confide in me. They depend on me to find food for them. I guess that's why I take stupid risks: I have people worth doing it for.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Agility
KEY SKILL: Stealth
TALENTS: Speed Freak, Wallflower, Gatherer

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Afraid to speak my mind
- I do not care if I live
- Kleptomaniac

DRIVE

- I cannot be killed
- This is my chance
- Love

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Pizza delivery car
2. Machete
3. Frying pan
4. Binoculars
5. Sleeping bag
6. Fishing rod

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- I do what you say
- Secretly I love you
- I will show you

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THE OUTCAST

Who could have guessed that living on the streets for ten years would ever be a more marketable experience than a college degree? I know how to become invisible. Where you can hide, sleep, and stay unseen, day or night. What's unsafe to eat and drink – hell, how to make just about anything edible. How to start fires and keep them burning without being seen from a distance. My years of wandering gave me skin like iron and the ability to read a man at twenty paces. These gifts have kept me alive more times than I can count – even if I still haven't forgiven those who put me outside in the first place.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Wits
KEY SKILL: Survival
TALENTS: Knows All the Tricks, Scavenger, Lone Wolf

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Alcoholic
- People do not like me
- Odd behavior

DRIVE

- I am a survivor
- This is my new family
- Craves revenge

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. D6 Molotov cocktails
2. Pistol
3. Spear
4. Handcuffs
5. Armor of cloth and old newspapers (level 4)
6. D6 bottles of moonshine

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- You are the alpha
- I trust you with my life
- Bully

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THE POLITICIAN

The shiny white smile of a politician always made some people suspicious, just as the bright colors of a poisonous insect warn of potential danger. The same gene screaming at you when I extend my hand for an uncannily firm shake made us run away from tigers when we were naked, dirty, and lived in caves. Now that the world has fallen apart, I do not mind admitting that sometimes being a politician is the same as being a mob leader or a warlord. It takes a certain type of person. I am one of the tigers. I do not shoot with my own gun, and it won't be me who hacks your body to pieces and hangs it in the trees to scare off your friends. Others will do that for me.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Empathy
KEY SKILL: Manipulation
TALENTS: Recruiter, Mind Games, Right Word at the Right Time

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- I never apologize
- Terrified of the walking dead
- I promise more than I can deliver

DRIVE

- I will lead them
- My ancestors fought hard
- This is a new beginning

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Assault rifle
2. Bottle of champagne
3. Bulletproof limousine (+2 Armor)
4. Hand crank radio
5. Notes for a book about this new era
6. Two knives

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- My bodyguard
- Rival
- Odd friendship

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THE PREACHER

People will believe in all sorts of silly things: stones, energy fields, or spirits jumping from body to body. We even met a group who worshiped walkers. They had a bunch of them holed up in an old boxing gym. A fellow man of the cloth (though what deity may have anointed him I cannot say) stood in the ring and threw flower petals at the corpses below, their arms stretched out for communion. I guess it should make me humble, as it suggests that any belief is as good as the next. But I am not. There is only one God and one true church. Soon, the day of reckoning will be upon us. I will lead my flock to the gate of Heaven.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Empathy
KEY SKILL: Leadership
TALENTS: Shepherd, Guarded by a Higher Power, Preacher

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Afraid of conflict
- Delusional
- Selfish

DRIVE

- I walk with the Lord
- Make amends
- These are the final days

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Bible
2. Homemade spear
3. Guitar
4. Scooter
5. Iron cross
6. Wine and altar bread

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- I secretly hate you
- Curious
- Infatuated

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

THE SCIENTIST

Of all the things I have studied and all the things I know, people respect me most for my moonshine still – a rudimentary device I could've constructed for a sixth grade science fair. I see their point: Who cares about quantum mechanics when the dead try to eat you and the living want to kill you? But they do need me, not just for the booze. I built these people a water collector, a system for communicating when they're on supply runs, and a sterile room to treat their wounds. I'm always one step ahead of them, not because of the heights I reached in my now-arcane area of research, no! You see, before all that, I took a freshman course in psychology.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Wits
KEY SKILL: Tech
TALENTS: Intuition, Techno Babbler, Handy

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- Hateful
- Understands the world with logic, not emotions
- Morally flexible

DRIVE

- I will save us all
- Fear of dying
- There is always a chance

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Sledgehammer
2. Pistol
3. Flashlight
4. Tent
5. Portable stove with gas and lighter
6. Basic medical gear

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- I see what you really are
- My friend
- I am curious about you

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

THE SOLDIER

We were told that, when it gets bad, nothing matters more than keeping disciplined and sticking together. They said we were the best trained soldiers in the world. Even so, at the start of all this, most of my brothers and sisters in arms either turned tail or turned into monsters. Had to shoot my best friend to keep him away from a little girl, no older than my kid sister!
I have dropped so many bodies, but I am no murderer.
To me, there are three types out there: the walking dead, the living monsters, and human beings. Only one of them deserves to stay on its feet.

KEY ATTRIBUTE: Agility
KEY SKILL: Ranged Combat
TALENTS: Disillusioned, Eye on the Ball, Suppressing Fire

Choose among the suggestions below or make one up yourself.

ISSUE

- I won't kill another human being
- I know what is best
- I protect the weak

DRIVE

- I saw my friend get eaten
- I will find a way to solve this
- Discipline

GEAR

Roll a D6 three times.

1. Assault rifle
2. Bayonet
3. D6 hand grenades
4. Binoculars
5. Basic medical gear
6. Pistol

RELATIONSHIP TO OTHER CHARACTERS

- Lover
- Friend
- Rival

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

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CHAPTER 4

SKILLS AND TALENTS

I was out there alone for months before they found me. Now I'm afraid to leave the base at all. In my dreams I hear them – groaning, shuffling, gnashing. I wake up and it's almost like I can still smell them. I never had nightmares out there. And I don't recall being afraid. The memory of those months is a haze of running and hiding and killing the dead. It's like, everything outside the walls now isn't a real place at all – it's a state of mind, a hallucination, a vision we can't wake up from.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

This chapter describes how skill tests, pushing rolls, and gaining stress all work. The chapter then presents the twelve skills that your PC can master, followed by the available talents.

USING SKILLS

There are twelve skills in the game that allow you to handle or endure difficult situations. Each of them is linked to an attribute.

When using a skill, add the skill level and its associated attribute together. The sum determines how many six-sided base dice you roll. Note that you may use a skill even if you have no skill level in it – in that case, just roll a number of base dice equal to the attribute. If you have stress points (next page), you must also add one stress die to your roll for each point of stress.

Rolling at least one six counts as a success. You rarely need more than one success in order to pass a skill test.

GM: *There is a shadow moving, about a hundred feet outside the wall, just to the left of the tower where you are standing. It is obvious from the movement pattern that it is a living human. But as it is dark, you cannot see more than the shape of the body. What do you do?*

Hannah (player 1): *Well, I've learned not to let strangers come close to the haven. I aim at the person with my rifle and try to shoot him or her.*

GM: *Roll Ranged Combat.*

Hanna: *I have Agility 5, Ranged Combat 3, and +2 for the rifle, which means I roll ten base dice. I get two successes.*

GM: *The shot echoes all around and the person falls to the ground. You smell gun smoke from your rifle. Everything has gone dead quiet.*

ADDING MODIFIERS

A basic rule is that everything affecting the skill roll is added together. If you have a talent or item that adds +2 to the roll and someone else helps you, granting a further +1 bonus, you get to add a total of three extra dice to roll. In rare cases, you may also need to roll fewer base dice.

MEANS AND ENDS

Before you make a skill roll, you must describe what your PC is trying to achieve. The GM may ask you to explain further, or to change your goal. This usually happens when they cannot get a clear picture of what you want to do, or find your goal unrealistic. For example, you cannot use Stealth to sneak past a guard who has already seen you.

GM: *The battle tank closes in on the house where you placed David and the wounded woman you found in the library. It moves slowly, as if it barely functions, but you fear it can still easily roll through the building and smash it down. What do you do?*

Imani (Player 3): *The only weapon I have is my knife, so I open the door and run towards it and start hacking at the tank, trying to find a weak spot. I try to destroy it with Close Combat. I roll 5 dice.*

GM: *Wait. This is a battle tank, and you have a knife. That won't ever work.*

Imani: *I do it anyway, even if I don't get to roll for it. I scream "Get away from them!" as I climb on top of the tank stabbing at it until the knife blade breaks.*

FAILED TESTS

Failing a skill test means that you don't get the result that you want. If you, for instance, are trying to climb over a fence to get away from a swarm of walkers, they grab your feet and pull you back down. If you try to inspire others to take up arms, they feel reluctant to follow you. If you fail building a camp in the wilderness, walkers might be able to attack without warning, or it will start to rain and all of your supplies will get wet.

At times, the GM will let you get some of what you want, even if you fail. This could mean that some of the NPCs agree to fight with you but not all, or that you manage to climb the fence to escape the walkers chasing you, but other walkers appear on the other side, or that you manage to set up camp, but the next day you leave behind a trail that will lead others to you.

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Dear Crazy Wanderer

Just when I thought I'd seen it all – the madness in people's eyes after watching their loved ones get torn apart; the screaming, the retching, the crying at night – along comes someone like you. At first we thought you were an animal, smeared in mud and walking on all fours. Rebecca started laughing. She thought you were a domesticated hog gone missing from some settlement. But then you pulled a gun out and started talking about being a king once: the king of bears. You kept ranting and raving at no one in particular, like we weren't even standing there. I felt sorry for you. But that doesn't matter. If you threaten me or anyone in my group, you will die.

PUSHING THE ROLL

When you fail a test, you can choose to give it one more try. This is called *pushing* the roll. You have found another way to achieve what you want, or you simply muster your last reserves of strength and resolve. If you cannot explain what your PC does that lets them try again, you are not allowed to push the roll. You can only push a specific roll once.

When you push a roll, you reroll all dice that are not successes. You also take one *stress point* and add a *stress die* to the re-roll.

You can push rolls that have already succeeded, since there are situations where multiple successes are needed.

Valeria (player 2, new PC): *I try to break free from the guard by headbutting him in the face and then kicking him. I roll Close Combat. But I fail the roll.*

GM: *He grins at you with his strangely painted face as he punches you right in the nose and slams you down in the dirt. Then he points the crossbow at your face and mutters "It's over." As he speaks, you see that he does not have any teeth.*

Valeria: *I try to kick him in the back of his head and force him off me. I push the roll and take one stress point. I get a success!*

GM: *You manage to get free. Now what do you do?*

STRESS FACTORS

These are examples of situations that will give you a stress point:

- Pushing a roll.
- Not getting enough food and water.
- Being attacked by walkers.
- Being shot at.
- Being framed for murder.
- Being rejected by your lover.
- Killing another human being in cold blood.
- Seeing someone in the group get bitten.
- Seeing someone in the group Broken by damage.
- Being Broken by damage.
- Being bitten.

STRESS DICE

Frightening, dangerous, or tense situations in the game can cause your character to suffer stress, in the form of *stress points*. And as described above, you also take one stress point every time you push a skill roll. You never take more than one stress point at a time, no matter how stressful a situation is. The Stress Factors table indicates typical situations that will lead to you taking stress.

For each stress point you have accumulated, you add one *stress die* to any skill roll you make. This is not optional. Stress makes you more focused and more inclined to succeed with what you are doing. However, it also makes you more likely to make mistakes.

Rolling a 1 on a stress die is called "rolling a walker." It means two things: you cannot push the roll (if you have not done so already), and you mess up. It is possible to succeed with a roll and still mess up – you get what you want but something else goes wrong. The effect of messing up is the same whether you roll one or several walkers on your stress dice.

CUSTOM DICE

Custom stress dice are included in the Starter Set for this game, and more can be purchased separately. If you don't have access to the custom stress dice, just use any six-sided dice but with a separate color from the base dice. The custom stress dice have a special walker symbol on the 1 side, to indicate messing up.

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MESSING UP

When you roll a walker on a stress die, you *mess up*. Typically, this means that you have attracted walkers and are now under attack. When you mess up in this way, the GM either raises the Threat Level (page 79) by 1, or you suffer a single attack (page 80).

When you mess up, the GM most often says something about what happens and then lets you describe it. This way you can portray your PC's reaction in a way that makes sense to you. If you see your PC as a badass warrior, it would not be fun to have them stumble on a banana peel surrounded by enemies. You may instead have your PC fight for their life, beat two opponents to the ground, and then fail to see a third that sneaks up from behind. The PC goes down as a hero.

At times, the GM will decide that the situation you are in is messed up enough as it is. In that situation, your only consequence would be that you can't push the roll.

MESSING UP

When you mess up it could mean that you:

- Alert the swarm by making noise (raise Threat Level one step).
- Fail to notice a couple of walkers who close in on you (single attack).
- Run out of bullets/gas/spare parts/other resources.
- Offend someone.
- Hurt yourself.
- Break something important.
- Get lost.
- Lose your hostage.

MESSING UP IN OTHER WAYS: When you have played a couple of sessions, you could let messing up mean other things besides making noise that attracts walkers. It could be anything from realizing that you are out of bullets to unknowingly offending an important NPC who will now start working against you.

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"When the shit hits, you're standing there with a shovel."

Daryl Dixon

David (player 4): *As soon as everyone is in the car, I drive the hell out of there.*

The Gamemaster: *Shots are fired all around and you see the lights from their motorcycles behind you. They're not going to let you get away. The road ahead of you is gravel that cuts through the middle of the forest. And it is dark.*

David: *"Keep your heads down." The bullets are flying through the back windshield. And I'm actually loving this. It feels like I'm alive again, even though I'm scared as shit. I drive as fast as I can. The car hits a huge pothole and swerves, but I manage to keep it under control and we fly between the trees straight into the darkness. "Woohoo!!!!!"*

Hannah (Player 1): *"Slow down, idiot!"*

David: *I just go faster. And I roll Mobility to drive the car and get away. I succeed but I get a walker.*

The Gamemaster: *You lose the motorcycles, but you still mess up.*

David: *I take a wrong turn onto a small path in the forest and we lose them. Just as we start laughing about it and you all scream at me from the back seat, a deer appears in front of the car. I swerve to the left and careen into a tree.*

The Gamemaster: *A loud crash. Darkness. And then a white haze. You are awakened by an annoying sound. Everyone in the car is hurt. Take 1 damage each. You can smell blood and gasoline. The noise is loud. Daylight filters in through the cracked windows – you all must have passed out. You can hardly move. What do you do?*

Hannah: *I try to get out, but first I look out the windows, if possible.*

The Gamemaster: *You see that you are surrounded by walkers. The sound you are hearing is them scratching at the windows outside of the car.*

EXTRA SUCCESSES

Rolling more successes on a skill roll than required means that you are extra successful. You impress the people around you, or you get a little more than you wanted.

Rodriguez (player 5): *I'm tired of not being treated as a full member of the group. I want to score something big to impress them. Where can I find some food?*

GM: *Roll Survival.*

Rodriguez: *I get three successes.*

GM: *You know that fancy retirement home where your mom stayed before the breakout, The Golden Days? She'd told you that the old man in the room next to hers used to hide all sort of things in the basement: canned food, water bottles, packs of cigarettes. You used to laugh at it, since she said he even had weapons down there, and that he somehow had managed to smuggle in his old motorcycle. But what if it's true?*

HELPING EACH OTHER

When you make a skill roll, others may help you. They need to describe what they do to help, and it has to make sense that they are actually contributing – just being there or saying encouraging words is not enough. When you are helping someone, you cannot do anything else at the same time.

You gain +1 to your skill roll for every person helping you, up to a maximum of +3. PCs can help even if they have a zero in the relevant skill. NPCs can only help you if they are Trained, Expert or Master in the skill.

PARALLEL ACTIONS

When two or more PCs are doing an activity at the same time, they cannot help each other. For example, if you are all trying to sneak out of a house where you have been held hostage, or if you're both swimming to a boat – in such cases each of you must pass your own test without help from the others.

However, some skills allow a PC whose roll results in more than one success to give the extra successes to other PCs or NPCs. A good runner who gets several successes on her Mobility roll, for example, may give one of each of her extra successes to others who failed their tests. In the game, this probably means that the overachieving PC offers to carry supplies for the others, or that she clears the road for them, or tells them which way to run. If a player cannot explain how their PC can help the others, they cannot give them their extra successes.

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CHANCE OF SUCCESS

This table shows the chance of succeeding at a roll, as well as the chance of succeeding if you then choose to push the roll.

NUMBER OF DICE	CHANCE TO SUCCEED	PUSHED ROLL
1	17%	31%
2	31%	52%
3	42%	67%
4	52%	77%
5	60%	84%
6	67%	89%
7	72%	92%
8	77%	95%
9	81%	96%
10	84%	97%

OPPOSED ROLLS

When you and another PC or an NPC are competing, or otherwise working against one another, you make an *opposed roll*.

It could be when you and an enemy race to get to the armory first, when you are hiding and someone is trying to find you, when both of you are trying to convince a crowd that your stance on a subject is correct, or when you try to outsmart each other.

You and your opponent each roll. The person with the most successes wins. A draw means that you and the other character are forced to compromise – you either both get some of what you want but not all, or you hurt each other simultaneously.

EXTRA SUCCESSES: In an opposed roll, extra successes are counted as the sixes rolled beyond what's needed to win the roll. If you get one more success than your opponent, you simply win. Each additional success is counted as an extra success.

Rodriguez (player 5): *I turn to the others and whisper "I'll take care of this; I know a trick or two, just watch." I sidle away when the guard isn't looking, and then I take a screwdriver from the toolbox and try to stab him.*

The Gamemaster: *You know that he is standing here with the sole purpose to guard you and that your hands are tied? It seems a little implausible.*

"Anything is possible until your heart stops beating."

Gabriel Stokes

Rodriguez: *I been held captive numerous times since the outbreak, and I escaped twice! I've done this before. Could I at least make an opposed roll?*

The Gamemaster: *Sure. You roll Stealth against his Scout.*

Rodriguez: *I get two successes.*

The Gamemaster: *So does he. I guess you manage to sneak away and reach the screwdriver. But as you turn to try and stab him, he sees you and readies his gun. What do you do?*

EXTREME DIFFICULTY

Normally, when you get at least one success on a roll, you succeed. But in extreme cases, the Gamemaster may decide that it takes more than one success to achieve your goal. This should only happen in situations when you are trying to do something almost impossible, such as jumping between two cars racing on the highway or trying to calm an angry mob.

OPPOSED ROLLS: If you roll an opposed roll, and one side is doing something that is challenging enough to raise the difficulty level, take away one of that side's successes on the skill roll, before the rolls are compared with each other.

DIFFICULTY

TASK	SUCCESSES REQUIRED
Difficult	1
Highly unlikely	2
Almost impossible	3

BONUSES FROM GEAR

When you use a tool or weapon, or when you drive a vehicle, you get a bonus – a number of extra base dice that get added to your skill roll.

You can find tables for gear on page 73, weapons on page 74, and for vehicles on page 76.

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SKILL LIST

Below are descriptions of the twelve skills that characters can have in the game, along with a brief explanation of what they can be used for.

CLOSE COMBAT (Strength)

When fighting unarmed or with a melee weapon, you use Close Combat. How much damage is inflicted by a successful attack is specified for each weapon (page 74). By rolling more successes than required, you may increase the damage by one for each extra success.

ENDURE (Strength)

Endure is your ability to withstand hunger and cold, as well as being able to march for long periods without rest. It lets you withstand poison and disease. In some situations, you may transfer any extra successes to other PCs or NPCs in the same situation.

FORCE (Strength)

Force is your ability to lift heavy items, smash open blocked doors, or achieve things that require brute strength and determination.

MOBILITY (Agility)

Mobility is the ability to run fast, climb high, and leap out of danger. You make a Mobility test when you flee from or chase after someone. Driving a car in difficult situations is also handled by Mobility. In combat, you can use your Mobility to take cover or flee.

If other PCs or NPCs are climbing, running or in other ways using Mobility along with you, you may give them any extra successes to help them.

COMBAT SKILLS

Close Combat and Ranged Combat are not only about pointing a gun in the right direction, or being able to hit someone over the head with a hammer. It also covers positioning in a fight: Moving around to get a good angle, and knowing how to attack without being hit. When you succeed with a combat skill, you have not only managed to hit your target – you have also done what is necessary to survive in a fight, either because you are trained or because you were lucky.

RANGED COMBAT (Agility)

When attacking with ranged weapons or explosives, use a Ranged Combat skill test. How much damage is inflicted by a successful attack is specified for each weapon (page 74). By rolling more successes than required, you may increase damage by one for each extra success.

If you are in close proximity to an enemy, you roll for Close Combat instead, even if you're using a ranged weapon.

STEALTH (Agility)

When attempting to sneak, hide, pick locks, tail someone, or perform tricks that require sleight of hand, make a Stealth test. You may transfer extra successes to people who are attempting the same as you.

Failing a Stealth roll means that you get noticed or exposed.

SCOUT (Wits)

You mainly use Scout in two types of situations. The first is when you are moving somewhere on the area map (page 92). Scout lets you determine if the sector you are about to enter is safe, and lets you find a good place to stay for the night. You lead the party in a way that minimizes risks. This is explained more in Chapter 6. You can't be helped with extra successes from others when you use the Scout skill this way, because only one person can lead the group.

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The other way to use Scout is to get an overview of your immediate surroundings, or to spot threats or hidden things. For example, a success may let you see that there is a sniper hiding on the rooftop, or spot hidden equipment in a building, or notice someone trying to sneak past you, or discover the best way in or out of a fortress.

Extra successes can, at the GM's discretion, give a +1 bonus per success (maximum +3) on one skill roll where you or someone else uses the information you got. A failed roll most often means that you do not get any information. But it could also mean that you are detected by your enemy or end up in a bad situation.

PASSIVE ROLLS: When a hidden threat closes in, the GM can call for a passive Scout roll. Each PC present may roll to spot the threat. Passive rolls cannot be pushed.

The Gamemaster: *You climb the wall without any trouble. There are some walkers in the courtyard, but they haven't seen you yet. The house looks like before – an impressive three-story stone building with a sign over the door that reads: The Golden Days. All the lights are out and there are bullet-holes in the walls.*

Rodriguez (player 5): *Can I find the best way inside?*

The Gamemaster: *Roll Scout.*

Rodriguez: *I get two successes.*

The Gamemaster: *The front door looks blocked. But there is a window next to it that has been smashed and there are not many walkers close by. You could simply run to it, jump up, and climb in. If you do that, you get +1 on the Mobility roll, since you got an extra success.*

Dear Rodriguez

We should've gone looking for you, but Imani somehow made me believe that you didn't deserve it. I should have gone myself. We found you in an abandoned retirement home. You were shuffling down the second-floor hallway with your guts hanging out all the way to the ground. Why were you here? Were you looking for your mom? I guess we'll never really know, but I hope, before you met your end, you found what you were looking for. David searched the cellar and found a ton of canned food, even a stash of guns and a cherry motorcycle. It's like Christmas morning in the camp. Except that you're dead. I wish I'd stuck up for you. But now it's too late.

SURVIVAL (Wits)

Everything you need to know about surviving outside the haven is handled with Survival. It lets you know how to set up a camp safely, how to find water, and how to know if that water is potable. Survival lets you set up traps to catch animals, fish and hunt, and it represents your knowledge of handling wild animals.

There are three specific ways to use Survival. The first is when you scavenge for food and other resources. If you succeed, you get to roll on the Scavenging table (page 151). Each extra success lets you find one ration. Scavenging is described in more detail in Chapter 6.

The second way to use Survival is to track people or animals. If the person you follow tries to cover their tracks, you roll an opposed roll: Survival against Survival. Otherwise, you only need to succeed with the roll.

A third way to use Survival is to use your recollection and understanding of the world before the outbreak to make an educated guess about where a specific item could be. If the group needs to find food or a radio transmitter, you could roll Survival to get information on where this might be found. If you fail your roll, that item is probably still there, but there are unforeseen complications. Extra successes most often mean that there is more to find than you asked for. Others cannot help you on the skill roll, and once you have rolled for a certain item, none of you are allowed to roll again to locate the same thing.

TECH (Wits)

Tech is used to repair or build gear or weapons. When you engage in projects to enhance your haven, varying levels of Tech will be required to successfully complete them, depending on the project. Tech also gives you knowledge about how various types of mechanical and/or electrical devices work.

LOCATING SPECIFIC ITEMS

Using Survival to guess where a certain item can be found is no magic trick. The GM will tell you what is plausible. If you ask for nuclear warheads, they will probably tell you they can be found in underground bases, and perhaps you can get information on where they are if you go to the Pentagon. That will probably be quite difficult, but there is a chance you might find them. Whether it is successful or not, a Survival roll should always give you a hint or a general direction. When successful, it often states a specific sector where the thing you want can be found.

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MEDICINE (Empathy)

Medicine lets you use your expertise to help someone who is hurt. The skill can also provide knowledge about anatomy, diseases, and injuries. It can be used to determine healing time for a wound, and what medicine or treatment is required. For more details on how Medicine is used to tend to the wounded, see Chapter 5.

MANIPULATION (Empathy)

When you want to make another person do or think something by lying, bribing, threatening, or coercing them, use Manipulation. Play out what you say and do, and state what you want to achieve, then roll the dice. On a success, you get what you want. In difficult situations, you might need more than one success. Failure could mean that the other person disagrees with you, or even starts disliking you. If you talk to a group of people, use Leadership instead of Manipulation.

When you try to make another PC think or do something, roleplay the situation and let the other player decide how their PC reacts. They can ask you to roll for Manipulation anyway, to help them decide what the PC thinks of what you are saying.

NOT MIND CONTROL

When using Manipulation, your goal must be reasonable. You cannot completely alter another person's way of thinking, make someone kill themself, or turn people against their friends without a good reason – at least not on a single roll.

LEADERSHIP (Empathy)

When you want to sway a crowd or inspire another person, roll for Leadership. Swaying a crowd works similarly to Manipulation, but you address a group of people. When you roll for Leadership, you cannot get help from others. There can only be one leader at a time.

When inspiring someone with Leadership, each success rolled gives the subject +1 on a skill roll in one situation within a reasonable amount of time. They can wait to decide which skill roll gets affected until they make use of the inspiration effect. A failed attempt to inspire someone means you take one point of stress.

TALENTS

When you create your PC, you get to choose one talent specific for your archetype. As you play, you will get XP that lets you buy new talents (page 28). Talents are listed below, with a name, a rules effect, and a prerequisite written in italics.

PREREQUISITES: The prerequisite is something that must have happened for you to learn this talent. When you choose your talent as a part of creating your PC, you should describe this event as something that happened in your past life, either after or before the outbreak.

When you acquire a new talent, you must either point to something that happened in the game that fulfills the prerequisite, or come up with an event in your past that does.

"If you have to eat shit, best not to nibble. Bite, chew, swallow, repeat. It goes quicker."

Bud

THE CRIMINAL'S TALENTS

- **THREATENING POSTURE:** You can use Force instead of Manipulation when you threaten someone. *You ruined someone's life.*
- **FIXER:** You gain +2 to Manipulation when you haggle for a deal. *You scored big on a negotiation.*
- **FIGHTS DIRTY:** When you fight unarmed, you do +1 damage. *You killed someone with your bare hands.*

THE DOCTOR'S TALENTS

- **EMERGENCY MEDICINE:** Gain +2 to Medicine when you stabilize a critical injury that needs basic medical gear. *You used to work in an Emergency Room.*
- **DOCTOR/PATIENT HIERARCHY:** When you use Manipulation against someone who is injured, you get a bonus equal to the number of Health Points they have taken in damage. *You somehow used one of your patients for your own benefit.*
- **SEEN IT ALL:** You do not take stress from seeing someone get wounded, tormented, or even Broken. *You tried to save your injured friend.*

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THE FARMER'S TALENTS

- **TRACKER:** Gain +2 on Survival when you either track someone or try to hide your own tracks. *You tracked someone or something.*
- **TOUGH AS NAILS:** Gain +2 to Endure when you starve or work hard. *You had to push yourself beyond your own limits.*
- **LIVING OFF THE LAND:** Gain +2 to Tech when you work on projects that increase Capacity for your haven. *You made a living off the land.*

THE HOMEMAKER'S TALENTS

- **INNOCENT FACE:** You get +2 on Manipulation when you act innocent in front of a stranger. *You made someone believe you were weak.*
- **BACK AGAINST THE WALL:** When you fight against all odds and the enemies seem to be winning, you do +1 damage on all attacks. *You fought back.*
- **RATHER DIE THAN BREAK:** Once per session, after rolling for a skill, you can choose to lose one point of Health to get one (extra) success on that skill roll. You need to be able to explain, in the game, how you are damaged in the situation. *You sacrificed yourself for a higher purpose.*

THE KID'S TALENTS

- **KNIFE FIGHTER:** You inflict +1 damage when you fight with a knife. *You stabbed someone.*
- **STUBBORN:** Your Drive gives you a +3 bonus instead of +2. *You didn't give up.*
- **A CHILD OF THIS WORLD:** You do not take Stress when you see someone get bitten. *Someone you loved was bitten.*

THE LAW ENFORCER'S TALENTS

- **STEADY HANDS:** Once every session you may choose to not roll any stress dice on one skill roll. *You kept it together despite extreme pressure.*
- **WATCHFUL:** You may use Scout to learn the dynamics in a group of people, and the opportunities and risks therein. You need to spend some time with them. In this way, you may learn of both regular Issues and secret Issues. *You foresaw the danger.*
- **MORAL COMPASS:** When you put yourself in danger to stand up for what's right, you relieve one point of stress. *You did what you had to do.*

THE NOBODY'S TALENTS

- **SPEED FREAK:** Gain +2 when you use Mobility to drive a vehicle. *You won a race.*
- **WALLFLOWER:** You do not have to choose a single NPC as your NPC Anchor. Instead, the whole group is your Anchor. You do not have to handle your fear if any of them die, so long as at least one

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of them is left standing. *You were part of a group, without any of them really noticing you.*

- **GATHERER:** You get +2 to Stealth when you are on your own. *You brought back food that kept others alive.*

THE OUTCAST'S TALENTS

- **KNOWS ALL THE TRICKS:** You can use Stealth instead of Manipulation when you lie. *You fooled someone who tried to dominate you.*
- **SCAVENGER:** When you scavenge and roll Survival, you get +2 rations for each extra success instead of +1. *You survived on nothing.*
- **LONE WOLF:** You can have yourself as one of your two Anchors. *You were betrayed by someone you trusted.*

THE POLITICIAN'S TALENTS

- **RECRUITER:** You can use Leadership instead of Manipulation when you speak for your cause. *You won someone over to your side.*
- **MIND GAMES:** You relieve one stress when you successfully Manipulate someone. *You broke your opponent in a debate.*
- **RIGHT WORD AT THE RIGHT TIME:** When you succeed with Leadership, you get an automatic extra success. *You had them in the palm of your hand.*

THE PREACHER'S TALENTS

- **SHEPHERD:** Anyone can use you as an Anchor when they need to relieve stress, even if you are not their Anchor. *You tended to your flock.*
- **GUARDED BY A HIGHER POWER:** When you roll a random die to see if you are hit or bitten, you may reroll once. *You were saved against all odds.*
- **PREACHER:** Gain +2 to Leadership when trying to sway a group of people. *They followed you.*

THE SCIENTIST'S TALENTS

- **INTUITION:** Once per game session, you can ask the GM about how things in the game world work and are related, to get some useful information or suggestions on how to proceed. *You tackled an impossible Challenge.*
- **TECHNO BABBLER:** You can use Tech instead of Manipulation when you discuss complex matters. *You used science to get what you wanted.*
- **HANDY:** With a little time and some tools, you can repair most things – even if you don't have the right parts. You also get +2 to Tech when you repair things as a project. *Someone taught you to repair and build things.*

THE SOLDIER'S TALENTS

- **DISILLUSIONED:** You do not take stress from seeing others commit brutal acts of violence, or when committing them yourself. *You saw great suffering.*
- **EYE ON THE BALL:** Relieve one Stress every time a threat or an enemy is defeated or overcome. *You did what had to be done.*
- **SUPPRESSIVE FIRE:** You can attack up to three enemies with the same attack when you use Ranged Combat, but they all take one less point of damage and you can't add damage from extra successes. *You were trained to be a soldier.*

GENERAL TALENTS

ANIMAL COMPANION: You have a pet that you can rely on once per session to get +1 on a dice roll where it is evident that your pet is of use. *You won the trust of an animal.*

CENTER OF THE STORM: You don't take stress when walkers spot you (the Threat Level reaches 3). *You managed to keep calm in an extremely dangerous situation.*

EAGLE EYES: Gain +2 to Scout when you are trying to spot danger in a new sector. *Your eyesight saved your life.*

HEALTH NUT: When you get a critical injury, you heal in half the normal time. *During a period of your life, you got all the food and supplies you needed.*

HERB COLLECTOR: You can collect herbs and use them as basic medical gear. *Someone taught you about herbs.*

ICE IN THE VEINS: You do not take stress when you are attacked by one or a few walkers (single attack). *You survived an attack from a walker.*

CREATING NEW TALENTS

If a player wants a talent not described in this chapter, the GM may create it. The mechanics should be based on how other talents are constructed. Most talents either give a +2 bonus in a specific situation, or let a PC use one skill instead of another. Talents can also let PCs avoid taking stress under a specific circumstance, or let the player have a more active say in what happens during a particular scene. No talent should let a PC push a roll without taking stress. Be careful with talents that give PCs more health points or armor.

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INTENSE EYES: Gain +2 to Manipulation in a flirty situation. *You had an overwhelming love affair.*

MARKSMAN: Gain +2 to Ranged Combat on the first shot in a fight. *You killed on the first shot.*

MARTIAL ARTS EXPERT: Gain +2 to Close Combat when you fight unarmed. *Someone trained you.*

NINE LIVES: When rolling for a critical injury, you may decide which of the dice represents the tens and which represents the ones. *You should have died, but you didn't.*

OBSESSIVE: Relieve one point of stress when you role-play an Issue in a way that creates a problem for yourself or others in the group. *You got on someone's nerves.*

ON EASY STREET: Once per game session, you may at any point relieve one point of stress. *Something made you believe things will work out.*

PACKMULE: You can carry one extra slot of items. *You trained your body.*

PET KEEPER: You walk with chained living walkers. You get +2 to Stealth when you try to get past walkers this way. Name the two corpses that walk with you now. *You chained two corpses and brought them with you.*

PSYCHOPATH: Never roll to handle fear (page 26). You have the shattered Issue: Psychopath. *At some point you started to enjoy other people's pain – or it has always been that way.*

SENSITIVE: You can use Scout to learn what other people feel and intend to do, and even their Issues. *You saved a life by understanding someone's true intentions.*

SKULL CRACKER: Gain +2 to Close Combat when you fight walkers. *You took on a group of walkers and came out on top.*

SPECIALIST: Gain +2 to a specific skill when you use a specific item. Decide what the item is and for what skill you get a bonus. *You saved the day with the help of your signature item.*

SPRINTER: Gain +2 when you use Mobility to outrun or chase someone. *You ran fast in a crucial situation.*

"You fight it. And fight it. You don't give up. And then one day, you just change. We all change."

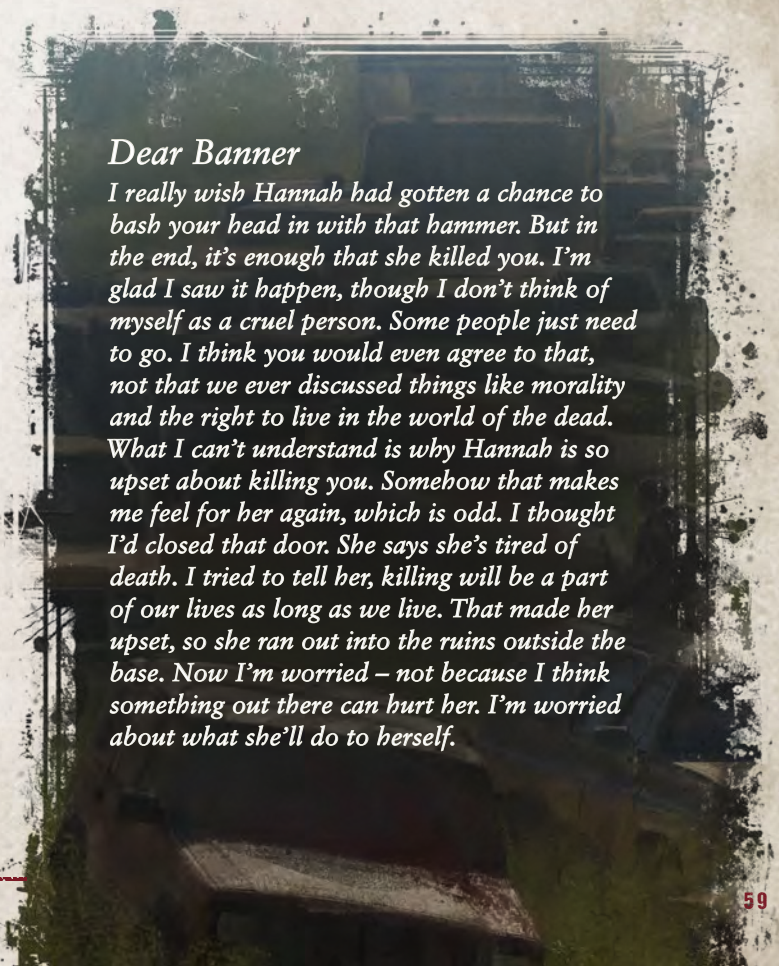
Carol Peletier

SURGEON: Gain +2 to Medicine when you stabilize a critical injury that needs advanced medical gear. *You saved someone's life on the operating table.*

UNBITEABLE: When rolling on the Walker Attack table (page 81), you may decide which of the dice represents the tens and which represents the ones. *You were attacked by the dead and survived.*

UNBREAKABLE: Once per session, when you take the third point of damage and become Broken, you immediately stop being Broken and regain one Health Point, as if someone had given you first aid. You still take a critical injury. *Someone tried to break you and failed.*

WHISPERER: You do not have to make a skill roll to handle the walker swarm by disguising as one of them. *You have walked among the dead many times, dressed in skin and blood.*



Dear Banner

I really wish Hannah had gotten a chance to bash your head in with that hammer. But in the end, it's enough that she killed you. I'm glad I saw it happen, though I don't think of myself as a cruel person. Some people just need to go. I think you would even agree to that, not that we ever discussed things like morality and the right to live in the world of the dead. What I can't understand is why Hannah is so upset about killing you. Somehow that makes me feel for her again, which is odd. I thought I'd closed that door. She says she's tired of death. I tried to tell her, killing will be a part of our lives as long as we live. That made her upset, so she ran out into the ruins outside the base. Now I'm worried – not because I think something out there can hurt her. I'm worried about what she'll do to herself.

Michael Syrett (Order #8348822)

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

CHAPTER 5

COMBAT AND HEALING

As soon as I saw the red paint on the walker's crushed skull, I knew he'd found us. Who other than Banner would brand his kills with his weapon? I never had a chance to find out if his ridiculously large, red hammer was somehow a symbol of his twisted ideology, but I don't think so. He came to hammer, then he took everything and left only corpses behind. We'd outsmarted him in Adairsville and escaped his crew. As the weeks passed by, we started to think we were safe. But we must have gotten sloppy, and the Razzlers were right on our heels all along. The brutalized walker left behind was a clear sign: It was time to fight or die.

Michael Synett (Order #53453222)

The world of the dead is a dangerous place, so the PCs will almost definitely end up in combat situations – by their own volition, or because someone else is out to get them.

This chapter describes two types of combat: *duels* between just two or a few fighters, and *brawls* for larger battles. The core combat rules apply to violent encounters between living creatures – be they PCs, NPCs, or animals. Fights against walkers are handled differently, as described in the final part of the chapter.

This chapter also covers general hazards, injuries, stress, healing, gear, and rules for vehicles.

DUELS

The most basic way of fighting is when you are up against a living opponent, either with guns, knives, or your bare hands. It is handled as a simple opposed roll. The fighter with the most successes wins, and they inflict damage on the other fighter equal to their own weapon's Damage rating (page 74).

Should you and your enemy get an equal amount of successes when you roll, you will hit each other simultaneously, both inflicting damage on the other. If both fail the roll, neither of you deal damage.

If you roll extra successes beyond what's needed to win the roll, each extra success increases the damage done by one point.

WEAPON BONUS: When you use a weapon, you can add a number of dice equal to the weapon's gear bonus to the skill roll.

HELP: If someone helps you attack your opponent, for example by distracting them while you strike, you get an additional die to your roll.

THE FIGHT CONTINUES: If you and your opponent are still standing after the opposed roll, you may attack each other again.

GM: *When you've said your piece, Henderson and several of the others – Brandon, Mike, Tony, and Michelle – stand up. Henderson turns to you. "You can try to fight them, but we won't be wasting our lives. We're joining the group at Free Town." They start leaving the Haven, taking backpacks they must have prepared beforehand.*

Hannah (player 1): *"You aren't leaving." I brandish my knife, walk up to Henderson, and try to stab him.*

GM: *Okay! He looks as if he was expecting you to do something. As he sees you coming, he takes one of the vases Marie brought to the Haven and smashes it in your face, then keeps hitting you to keep you at bay. It's an opposed roll.*

Hannah: *I get two successes.*

GM: *So does he. I guess you slash at his face, dealing one damage. You cut up the right side of his chin. At the same time, he's hit you on the top of the head with the vase, and your hair gets wet with blood. Take one damage.*

Hannah: *I go at him again.*

OPPOSED ROLLS IN DUELS

RESULT	EFFECT
A and B get the same number of successes.	Both deal their own weapon damage.
A or B gets one more success than the opponent.	Only one deals damage.
A or B gets two or more successes more than the opponent.	Only one deals damage; each extra success adds +1 damage.
Neither A or B gets any successes.	No one deals damage.

RANGE

Distance between combatants is managed using an abstract scale.

- Short range is less than 25 meters, close enough for you to run up to your enemy and attack in close combat or fire a revolver at them.
- Long range means that you need to use Ranged Combat to attack your opponent. You could be anywhere between 25 and 100 meters from your enemy.
- Anything beyond 100 meters is considered Extreme range. Only some special weapons can be used at this distance.

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RANGE CATEGORIES

RANGE	DESCRIPTION
Short	You can attack with Close Combat.
Long	You need to use Ranged Combat to attack.
Extreme	Only special weapons can be used.

COVER

If you are behind solid cover, any ranged attack against you needs an additional success to hit you. Remove one success from your enemy's dice roll before comparing the rolls. If both of you are behind cover, remove a success from each of your rolls. Cover does not protect you from close combat attacks.

DEFENSELESS TARGET

Should you attack someone who is unaware of the attack or otherwise unable to defend themselves, it is not an opposed roll. You simply need to succeed with the skill roll to hit, and each success beyond the first increases the damage done by one point.

MOVEMENT

In some situations, you may focus on avoiding getting hit or fleeing the fight instead of counterattacking. In a case where you can't, or won't, shoot or fight back, you can instead try to seek cover or reduce/increase the distance to the enemy by one category (but not both). Both of these actions require a straight Mobility roll to succeed. If you manage to find cover (above), you do so before the attack roll(s) against you is made, while any effects of a range change are applied after the attack(s).

MULTIPLE COMBATANTS

If two fighters gang up on a single enemy, the lone fighter must first decide who to roll an opposed roll against. The lone fighter is then considered a defenseless target (above) against the other opponent. All attacks happen simultaneously.

If there are several fighters on both sides, the GM can split them up into several duels, or decide to use the rules for brawls (page 64).

DESCRIBING THE ACTION

The GM should describe what happens to make the scene come alive. Describe the pouring rain and the mud where the PCs are wrestling; detail the excruciating sound of a spear tearing into someone's stomach; let the street be full of the familiar detritus from the old world, or add strange road signs left by some unknown survivor.

When you make a skill roll to attack someone, this doesn't necessarily mean that you make just a single attack – it can represent a whole series of actions. For example, it can mean you fire multiple shots at an enemy to keep them pinned down, or that you charge toward your opponent and struggle with them until you manage to shoot them at point blank range.

A failed attack does not necessarily mean that you miss your shot. You could, for example, hit your enemy but only inflicts a minor wound that does not cause them to lose hit points.

Hannah (player 1): *Our fight rages all throughout the room, me with my knife and him with his fists. Tables are broken, he picks up a chair and hits me over the head, and I throw him through one of the windows into the old waiting room.*

GM: *Shards of glass rain down over him as he crashes to the floor on the other side of the window. He grabs one of the glass shards and tries to stab you when you come at him. Roll for Close Combat.*

MESSING UP

Messing up (page 50) in combat typically means that you have made noise and attracted walkers. The GM raises the Threat Level by 1 or informs someone that a walker is attacking them (page 80).

Messing up can also mean that you run out of ammunition or do something that helps your opponent. Perhaps you could even accidentally shoot your friend! The GM should decide upon something that is plausible, or they could simply roll on the table Messing up in Combat for inspiration.

"The only thing I've ever known is the fight. There's so much we've done, so much more to do. But I wanna believe there's hope. That together, there is hope. Isn't there?"

Judith Grimes

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Hannah (Player 1): *I get four successes, and one walker.*

GM: *Henderson fails his roll. You succeed but you mess up. And as you got three extra successes, you inflict 4 damage. He is a goner.*

Hannah: *It ends in the waiting room. When the others come rushing in to see what is happening, I'm sitting on top of him. We're both struggling to get ahold of the knife. But his hands are bloody, and he loses his grip on it, and I manage to stab him through the eye. He's dead.*

GM: *The way you mess up is how the others in his group see this. Brandon, Mike, Tony, and Michelle stand around you. They have guns in their hands. "We're leaving now," Michelle says, "and we're taking Henderson's body with us. We'll bury him in Free Town. If I see you again, I'll kill you."*

MESSING UP IN COMBAT

D6	EFFECT
1	Out of ammo/weapon breaks.
2	Hurts oneself – accidentally falls, gets cut, or gets shot (1 damage).
3	Friendly fire. Hits friend with weapon's damage. Use Random dice to decide who.
4	Attracts walkers (raise Threat Level by 1, or suffer a single walker attack).
5	The overall situation gets worse (house collapses, falls out a window, slips etc.).
6	Bad positioning, opponent gets an extra success on the next roll.

BRAWLS

When several people are involved in a fight and the situation is complicated and intense, you use the rules for *brawls*. The rules for range, movement, and defenseless targets in duels (page 62) apply in brawls as well.

COMBAT MAP

The GM starts by drawing a map of the area, marking out places where you can take cover and possible obstacles, such as walls, doors, bodies of water, or cars. Note on the map where everyone is at the start of combat. Decide if anyone starts out in cover and say something about the distance between enemies: Short, Long, or Extreme.

COMBAT ROUNDS

Brawls are divided into *rounds,* and in each round everyone gets one action. Actions normally require a skill roll. Besides this single action, you may also do quick and simple things such as shouting a few words, picking up a gun from the counter next to you, drawing your knife from its sheath, or pressing a button.

The brawl ends whenever the story calls for it. This could be because all the enemies are dead, have given up, or run away. Or because you have been defeated.

The Gamemaster: *The tracks lead you to a school. A fence surrounds the perimeter, and they seem to have climbed over it. What do you do?*

Imani (player 3): *I look at Hannah, this is her thing.*

Hannah (player 1): *We move in closer.*

The Gamemaster: *As you get closer, you see them. You can hear Michelle and Brandon arguing about whether it's safe to enter the school through the front door, or if they should find another way in. Mike and Tony are also there. You try to hide behind the long grass that surrounds the fence on this side, but, because you messed up on the skill roll to track them, they notice you. Brandon turns around with a machine gun and fires at you. Everyone starts screaming. I think we have a brawl here. No talking unless it is in character. I'll sketch a quick map of the area.*

BRAWL PHASES

In a brawl, actions are divided into six categories, resolved in phases numbering from 1 to 6. During each round, the GM calls out each phase, and then all NPCs and PCs that want to perform their action in that phase declare it. NPCs declare first, then PCs.

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Dear James

I saved your life a couple of times before you went away to wherever you are now. The others nagged at me to kill you. Back at the water tower, when we were starving, Hannah tried to break your neck while I was sleeping. But you called for me, and I came to your rescue again. You did little to ingratiate yourself with the others, with your constant pleading for cookies, your littering all over the floor, and your loud screams, always at the wrong moment. But something about the look in your eyes, or perhaps the fact that you chose to land on my shoulder, made me believe we shared something none of the others could understand. I never had a pet before – didn't want one. But now it feels like I lost a loved one. I don't even know if James is your name or your former owner's. You had a way of bouncing your head up and down whenever you said that name, as if you were up to no good. I attached some of your feathers to my hat as a reminder of the finest parrot ever to sail the winds of this sad world.

Choosing an action should be done quickly. If a player can't decide, the GM should tell them that there is no time to ponder. Lingering further means the PC takes one point of stress. If the player's inability to decide is a result of the player not knowing the rules, the game should be paused, and the rules explained. No player should be punished for not knowing the rules.

BRAWL PHASES

1. Taking Cover	4. Movement
2. Ranged Combat	5. First Aid
3. Close Combat	6. Other

BRAWL ACTIONS

The six actions available in a brawl are described below.

1 TAKING COVER: Roll Mobility to take cover. If you succeed, you are in cover immediately. Ranged attacks require one more success to hit you than normal when you are in cover (page 63). If you fail the roll, finding cover takes time, and you are not considered to be in cover until the round has ended.

GM: *Phase 1, Taking Cover. Mike and Tony both run for cover.*

Hannah (player 1): *I also throw myself into cover. Perhaps that tree over there* [points at the map] *is close enough?*

GM: *Let's see. Roll Mobility.*

Hannah: *No successes. But I am really stressed out, so I push the roll. Still no successes!*

GM: *I guess you misjudged the distance to the tree. You will get to cover, but not until this round is over.*

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2 **RANGED COMBAT:** NPCs state targets first, then the PCs select theirs. Then start resolving skill rolls. Start with situations where two people fire at each other. This is handled as an opposed roll, as in a duel (page 62). When done, resolve any situation where someone shoots at a person who does not shoot back (resolved as a straight roll).

GM: *It's time for ranged combat. Michelle fires at Hannah, and Brandon at you, Imani.*

Imani (player 3): *I shoot at Brandon. We got a thing to settle.*

GM: *Alright, let's roll some dice. Imani, you and Brandon fire at each other, so that is an opposed roll. Describe what you do and roll the dice.*

Imani: *For once, it seems like I am completely fearless. I simply walk up to the fence firing my rifle again and again. I get three successes!*

GM: *Brandon is sitting down while shooting in your direction with his Uzi. He seems really scared, and you can see that he is screaming, but it is impossible to hear him because of the noise from the guns. He gets one success. That means you win and deal damage, and you increase weapon damage by 1. He is Broken.*

Imani: *My first shot hits him in one of the legs. Another bullet hits his arm, making him drop his gun. He stops screaming finally and looks a little stunned. The last bullet hits him right between the eyes.*

GM: *Okay. Let's move on to Michelle, who is firing on Hannah.*

OVERWATCH

Overwatch is a Ranged Combat action that may be used to secure a certain area of the map. If anyone moves into this area, you are ready to shoot them. This means that you may fire in the Movement phase in the round; however, if no one moves into the area, you'll end up essentially doing nothing that round.

3 **CLOSE COMBAT:** You can only use Close Combat against enemies within Short range. Close combat is handled in the same way as ranged combat. First, everyone states who they attack. Then the skill rolls are resolved, starting with opposed rolls. Cover does not apply.

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4 **MOVEMENT:** You may move one distance closer or further away from your opponent, for example from Long to Short range or vice versa. Roll Mobility. If someone chases you, make an opposed roll, Mobility versus Mobility. The winner moves one distance closer or further away from the opponent. An equal result means the distance stays the same. When someone gives up or the range goes beyond Extreme, the chase is over.

5 **FIRST AID:** You may give first aid (see below) to anyone within Short range. You cannot give first aid to yourself.

6 **OTHER:** If you want to barricade a door, hotwire a car, set off explosives, get the radio working, or attempt any other action that is not covered above, choose the Other action. The GM decides if your action requires a skill roll.

LEADERSHIP

In a brawl, you may bark orders and roll for Leadership instead of taking another action. You can give orders at any time in the round, but bonus dice from your roll can only be used in the same round.

If the others do as you tell them to, you may hand out bonus dice – one for each success you get. You may split them up amongst several different people, or give them all to a single character, but never more than three dice to a single person.

When you roll Leadership, you cannot get help from others. It is not possible to have two people on the same side rolling Leadership in the same instance of combat.

DAMAGE AND HEALING

All living PCs and NPCs have three Health Points. When you take one point of damage, you lose one Health Point. If you lose all three Health Points, you are Broken.

RECOVERY

A PC or NPC naturally recovers one point of Health each day, as long as they are able to consume one ration of food during that day. A PC that has no food cannot heal.

BROKEN

When you accumulate three or more points of damage, you're Broken. This means that you are down – you cannot do anything meaningful. You may say some words or crawl behind the nearest bit of cover, but you cannot walk.

As soon as a character becomes Broken, they take one stress and must roll on the table for critical injuries (page 69). Also, all skill rolls fail automatically while you are Broken.

Taking more than three damage from a single attack does not have any extra effect. A Broken person who gets injured again dies. Attacking a Broken person requires a normal skill roll.

FIRST AID

When you are Broken, someone else can give you first aid. This requires a Medicine roll. It only takes a couple of seconds of in-game time. If the roll is successful, you get back on your feet. You still suffer from the critical injury, but you're not Broken anymore, and you regain one Health Point. Each extra success on the Medicine roll heals one additional Health Point.

If there is no one to give you first aid, or if they fail their skill roll, you are Broken for D6 minutes. The GM makes the roll in secret. After the allotted time has passed you are no longer Broken and heal one Health point, but you are still critically injured.

ARMOR

Wearing armor may protect you from damage. It also makes you less agile. Armor gives you an Armor Level. When hit by an attack, roll a number of dice equal to the Armor Level. Each success reduces the damage you take by one. On the other hand, the armor's penalty value is the number of dice you need to subtract from any Mobility skill roll while wearing it.

ARMOR

TYPES OF ARMOR	ARMOR LEVEL	PENALTY
Soft vest	4	–1
Body armor	6	–2
Metal-plated armor	8	–3

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CRITICAL INJURIES

When you are Broken, you suffer a critical injury. All critical injuries give you a penalty. As long as the injury remains, a number of dice are subtracted from all skill rolls you make. If you have more than one critical injury, the penalties from each are cumulative.

LETHAL INJURIES: Some critical injuries are lethal, meaning they will kill you after a certain amount of time unless you are stabilized before it runs out. The time limit is decided by rolling a die, indicating the number of minutes, hours, or days you have left, as specified for each injury. The GM makes this roll secretly.

If someone attempts to stabilize you and succeeds at a roll for Medicine before the time limit runs out, you survive. The time limit also states what kind of medical equipment is necessary to help you, either basic (B) or advanced (A); advanced can be used in both cases. Without the right equipment, there is nothing to be done.

Stabilizing a lethal critical injury takes time and demands that you are in a safe place with enough food and water. Only one attempt can be made each day.

RECOVERY TIME: Each critical injury in the table (next page) has a listed recovery time, indicating how long it takes to either heal the damage or adjust to it. You won't, for example, heal a destroyed eye, but you can adjust to the impairment and learn to function with only one.

The GM rolls a die for recovery time secretly – you won't know how long it takes. The table states if recovery time is in hours, days, or weeks. When the recovery time has passed, the penalty is removed.

If you are tended to by someone who uses basic medical gear and makes a Medicine roll, recovery time may be shortened by one hour/day/week for each success. A failed roll means the recovery time is increased by one. Only one Medicine roll can be made to tend to you while you heal unless your group gains access to more advanced medical gear – in this case, a new roll is allowed.

GM: *As the bouncy castle starts losing air, Tony appears from behind it and fires at you with a large revolver.*

MEDICAL EQUIPMENT

Basic medical gear (B) involves things a field medic would carry with them in a bag: scalpels, bandages, basic medication, disinfectants, and other similar objects. If you do not have basic medical gear, you cannot create it by tearing some sheets into bandages or sharpening your bread knife. You need real medical equipment.

Advanced medical gear (A) is more specialized stuff that you find in a hospital. It could be a supply of blood, medicines, surgical equipment, or an operating table. Advanced medical gear is hard to find, and you might need some means of transportation, like a car, to move it around or bring people to it.

Hannah (player 1): *Can I do anything about it?*

GM: *Since you have already fired at Michelle this round, you can only hope he doesn't hit you. But you are in cover, so that is something.*

Hannah: *I don't like the sound of this... go ahead and roll.*

GM: *Four successes. Despite the cover taking away one of those, he still hits you with 3 damage. That means you are Broken. Roll for a critical injury.*

Hannah: *I get a 3 and a 6. That is 36, a punctured lung. Not good.*

GM: *Not good at all.* [The GM secretly rolls for time limit and recovery time. Hannah needs to get medical attention with basic equipment within two days, or she dies. Only one attempt to help her can be made per day. She has a –2 penalty on all skill rolls for four weeks]. *You need medical treatment, or you will die. But as you are Broken, your options are limited. What do you do?*

Hannah: *Can I crawl under the car?*

GM: *Sure! You hear Tony shouting to Michelle, "Did we get her?" As no one can give you first aid, you must wait some minutes before you stop being Broken* [secretly rolls a 1 – Hannah will be Broken for one minute]. *When you can start doing things again, you have a –2 penalty on all rolls.*

BROKEN NPCS

The GM may decide that an NPC who is Broken is killed immediately. This way, you have less bookkeeping to worry about, and the game becomes both faster and deadlier... but you could end up missing out on stories where enemies you thought were eliminated come back to seek revenge.

MESSING UP WHEN STABILIZING

D6	MEDICINE ROLL SUCCESSFUL	MEDICINE ROLL FAILED
1–4	Medical equipment depleted/broken	Medical equipment depleted/broken
5	Recovery time doubled	Time limit halved
6	Apply a further –1 penalty	Penalty permanent (for one skill)

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

CRITICAL INJURIES

D66	CRITICAL INJURY	LETHAL	TIME LIMIT	PENALTY	RECOVERY TIME
11	Winded	No	—	–1	Hours
12	Broken fingers	No	—	–1	Hours
13	Ruptured tendons	No	—	–1	Hours
14	Skin lesion	No	—	–1	Hours
15	Fracture	No	—	–1	Hours
16	Slashed shoulder	No	—	–1	Hours
21	Knee injury	No	—	–1	Days
22	Knocked out teeth	No	—	–1	Days
23	Ripped off ear	No	—	–1	Days
24	Broken nose	No	—	–1	Days
25	Broken ribs	No	—	–1	Days
26	Crushed foot	No	—	–2	Days
31	Damaged throat	Yes	B Days	–2	Days
32	Cut open leg	Yes	B Days	–2	Days
33	Deep flesh wound	Yes	B Days	–2	Days
34	Loose bone splinters	Yes	B Days	–2	Days
35	Cracked head	Yes	B Days	–2	Weeks
36	Punctured lung	Yes	B Days	–2	Weeks
41	Internal bleeding	Yes	B Hours	–2	Days
42	Severe internal bleeding	Yes	B Hours	–2	Weeks
43	Dirty wound	Yes	B Days	–2	Days
44	Crushed leg	Yes	B Hours	–3	Weeks
45	Crushed intestines	Yes	B Hours	–3	Weeks
46	Severe bleeding	Yes	A Hours	–3	Weeks
51	Destroyed eye	Yes	A Days	–3	Weeks
52	Ruptured bowel	Yes	A Hours	–3	Weeks
53	Shattered kidney	Yes	A Days	–3	Weeks
54	Caved–in forehead	Yes	A Days	–4	Weeks
55	Spinal injury	Yes	A Hours	–4	Months
56	Coma	Yes	A Days	Cannot act	Months
61	Severed limb	Yes	A Hours	–4	Weeks
62	Ruptured aorta	Yes	A Minutes	–5	Weeks
63	Crushed body	Yes	—	You die	—
64	Disemboweled	Yes	—	You die	—
65	Pierced head	Yes	—	You die	—
66	Impaled heart	Yes	—	You die	—

PLAYING AN NPC DURING RECOVERY

A player might choose to take over control of an NPC Survivor while their PC rests after a critical injury. The NPC Survivor is re-created as a new PC. When the campaign continues, the player can skip between the two PCs in different scenes or sessions. If the NPC Survivor was the original PC's NPC Anchor, the PC must get a new NPC Anchor.

Michael Syrett (Order #8848822)

RELIEVING STRESS

You relieve stress (page 49) through social interactions, meeting your anchor, and rest. You cannot relieve stress if you are in immediate danger. It is, for example, not possible to relieve stress in the middle of a fight.

Several PCs may relieve stress at the same time. You don't have to announce beforehand that you want to relieve stress. Just play out the scene, and then tell the GM that you were relieving stress.

SOCIAL INTERACTION: When you have a social interaction with another PC or NPC, you relieve one point of stress. The interaction could be short, maybe only a couple of sentences to clear one's head. It could mean, for example, kissing in the backseat of the car, discussing the strange tension in the haven, talking about baseball in the watchtower, or drinking a beer together. After you have relieved stress in this way, you cannot do it again until you have suffered more stress.

GM: *The door slams shut behind you with a loud metallic bang. You are safe down here, but you can hear the walkers clawing at the door trying to get in.*

David (Player 4): *I turn to Hannah with a cigarette pack in my hand. "Want a smoke?"*

Hannah (player 1): *"Why not? It's not like we're getting out of here anytime soon."*

David: *I light her cigarette first and then mine. We sit next to each other with our backs against the door, smoking and listening to the biters. "Have I told you about that time my brother tried to teach me to fly? It was a little like what you attempted back there. But with a lot more bruises and cuts, and a broken jaw."*

Hannah: *I laugh and then start coughing, bursts of smoke coming out of my nose. It's been a long time since I smoked a cigarette.*

GM: *Despite the coughing, you both relieve one point of stress.*

MEETING YOUR ANCHOR: If you spend an hour or more with one of your Anchors, you relieve all stress. This can only be done once per session. Typically, this is played out as one short scene where you get to talk to your Anchor. You might, for example, spend the night together, work together in the field, go on a ride in the car to check something out, or play poker all night. It is not possible to relieve stress with an Anchor who dislikes you – you better keep those Anchors happy!

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

Imani (player 3): *When we get back from the raid, I try to find Rebecca.*

GM: *She is in her bed, even though it's not dark yet. She tells you that she cannot handle the thought that, each time you go out there, you might not come back.*

Imani: *I lay down beside her and just hold her. I think we lay there all night cuddling, whispering in the darkness, sometimes crying.*

GM: *The first rays of the sun awaken you both the next morning. It smells like porridge from the kitchen, a little burnt so it is probably Hannah cooking. Relieve all stress.*

REST: An undisturbed night's sleep in a reasonably safe place relieves a double low number of stress points.

OTHER HAZARDS

In a world where the dead have risen and society has collapsed, it's easy to see why there might be many ways to get hurt.

EXPLOSIONS

When something explodes, it hits everything at Short distance from the impact point. Explosions have a Blast Power (BP). Roll a number of dice equal to the Blast Power; each success means one point of damage to all targets. The Blast Power roll cannot be pushed. A successful Mobility roll negates all damage from explosions.

EXPLOSIVE WEAPONS: Attacks with an explosive weapon are rolled using Ranged Combat. If you hit, all targets within Short range of the impact point suffer blast damage as per above. Extra successes on your attack roll increase the damage on all targets.

A failed skill roll means that you hit the wrong location and your target(s) escape damage. Unless you mess up with your attack roll, you do not take damage from your own attack.

EXPLOSIVE WEAPONS

EXPLOSIVE	BLAST POWER (BP)
Molotov cocktail	6
Hand grenade	8
Rocket launcher	10
Mortar	12
Howitzer	14

FIRE

Fire is measured in Intensity. A typical fire has an Intensity between 4 to 8. When exposed to fire, roll a number of dice equal to the Intensity. For each success, you take one point of damage. The roll cannot be pushed, and Armor does not protect you. If you stay in the flames, or if you keep burning, you keep taking damage. As the fire spreads, Intensity increases. The Survival skill is typically used to stop the fire from spreading. It is handled as an opposed roll against the fire's Intensity.

FIRE

FIRE	INTENSITY
Torch	4
Burning furniture	6
Burning room	8

POISON

Poison has a Toxicity rating, typically between 4 to 8. When you are exposed to poison, roll for your Endure against the poison's Toxicity. If you win, the poison doesn't affect you. If it is a draw, you are still affected by the poison, but you do not take any damage.

For each success the Toxicity gets more than you, you take one point of damage. You must make a new opposed roll against the poison each hour, until you manage to successfully fight off the poison, or it kills you.

If you are Broken by a poison, you take a critical injury. The result on the Critical Injury table might have to be interpreted in a way that fits with damage from poison. If you are already Broken and take one more damage from the poison, it kills you.

A person with the right equipment and medicine might try to treat you. Once every hour, one person may treat you by making a Medicine roll. Each success is added to your Endure roll.

While poisoned, you have a –1 penalty on all dice rolls, including the Endure roll.

Michael Syrett (Order #5468222)

DISEASE

Diseases have a Virulence rating, typically between 4 to 10. When you are exposed to a disease, make an opposed roll for Endure against the Virulence of the disease. This is called a *sickness roll*.

If you get more successes than the disease, your body has fought off the disease and you are well. If it is a draw, you are infected but don't take any damage. For each success the disease gets more than you, it inflicts one point of damage.

If you are Broken by a disease, you take a critical injury. The result might have to be interpreted in a way that fits with damage from sickness. If you are already Broken and take one more damage from the disease, it kills you.

Make an opposed roll against the disease each day. While you are sick, you don't heal damage. A person with the right equipment and medicine (such as an antibiotic if the disease is bacterial) may try to treat you. Once every day, one person may treat you by making a Medicine roll. Each success is added to your Endure roll.

As long as you are sick, you have a –1 penalty on all dice rolls, including the Endure roll.

DISEASE

DISEASE	VIRULENCE
Flu	4
Pneumonia	6
SARS	8
MRSA	10

SICK NPCS

If many people in the haven get sick, the GM can make sickness rolls for all NPCs each day and keep track of their Health. Another way is to simply roll a stress die each day: getting a walker means that one or several NPCs die. If the disease is dangerous, the GM can roll a double low.

FALLING

Falling on a hard surface automatically inflicts damage equal to the height in meters divided by two, rounded down. In a controlled jump, roll Mobility. Each success reduces the damage by one. Armor does not protect you.

TRAPS

Walking into a trap is a common way to get yourself killed when you are near the base of a hostile NPC. If you are in an area that is likely to be trapped and explicitly looking out for them, or other dangers, make a Scout roll to discover them. Most traps that you find can be avoided or destroyed without much effort. Others are more complicated and require a Tech roll to disarm.

If you spring a trap, you get to make a Mobility roll to avoid its effect. Should you succeed, you are safe. But remember that loud noises, for example an explosion, will attract walkers and probably raise the Threat Level.

Should you fail to avoid the trap, you are affected negatively in some way. Some traps simply hurt you. They have an Attack rating and a Damage rating. Roll a number of dice equal to the Attack rating. Each success means one point of damage. Add the Damage value to find out the total amount of damage inflicted. Traps might also mean that you are exposed to poison, disease, an explosion, or a fall.

TRAPS

TRAP	EFFECT
Shotgun behind door	Attack 4, Damage 2
Pit trap	Stuck in the hole, falling damage (4 meters)
Poisoned arrow	Attack 2, Poison with Toxicity 6
Tripwire with grenade	Blast Power 8
Walker trap	Swarm Size 2, Threat Level 4

HUNGRY AND TIRED

When you are traveling outside your Haven, you must consume one ration of food each day, or you will starve. For each day you starve, make an Endure roll. If you fail, you take one point of stress. Your stress cannot be relieved until you consume two rations per day for as many days as you starved, or you reach a haven with reliable access to food and water.

If you have five stress points or more, you instead start taking one damage per day. This damage cannot be healed until you consume the rations you missed.

When you push your body beyond its limitations, for example by walking or working all day and night, make an Endure roll. If you fail, you take one point of stress. If you already have five or more stress, you lose one point of Health instead.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

GEAR

To survive in the land of the dead you need to find useful stuff, such as weapons, gear or rations. Rules for carrying gear and rations are described in chapter 3, on page 28.

GEAR BONUS

Most gear will give you a *gear bonus*. Provided that the GM agrees that the item is useful in the situation, you get to add a positive modifier to your skill roll when using it. When making a skill roll, you may only utilize the bonus from one piece of gear. The gear bonus for a few common items is listed in the table on the right.

ITEMS BREAK

With time, everything will break or wear out. This can happen either as a Challenge that the GM introduces, or as a result of messing up on a skill roll.

Repairing old stuff and finding new resources to survive is a big part of the game. You will either build a thriving society or watch what you have crumble to dust. Repairing broken items is done as a project in your Haven (page 88).

QUALITY OF ITEMS

When the PCs find an item, the GM may roll on the table below to determine its quality. If an item's quality is determined to be bad (which is quite often, due to the decaying of the world in general), it has the Issue *bad quality*. This means that it is likely to break which may lead to a Challenge for the PC. Challenges are described on page 110.

ITEM QUALITY

D6	QUALITY
1	Broken/useless
2–4	Bad
5	Okay
6	Okay and roll again; if another 6, the item is of extremely good quality

GENERAL GEAR

ITEM	SLOTS	BONUS
Advanced medical gear	Varies	Medicine +2
Basic medical gear	1	Medicine +1
Binoculars	½	Scout +2
Book of maps	½	Scout +1
Bottle of liquor	½	Manipulate +2
Camera	½	—
Compass	—	Survival +2
Crowbar	1	Force +2
Dog	—	Close Combat +2
Field kitchen	1	—
Horse	—	—
Guitar	1	Leadership +1
Lockpicks	—	Stealth +2
Pack of gum/ cigarettes	—	Manipulate +1
Ration of food	½	—
Rope (10 meters)	1	Mobility +2
Sleeping bag	1	Survival +1
Tent	2	Survival +2
Toolbox	1	Tech +2
Walkie-talkies	½	Leadership +1

AMMUNITION

The game does not have a granular system for tracking ammunition. If you have a gun, you probably have some ammo. But running out of ammo and going on runs to find more is an important part of the game's world, so there are two thematically resonant ways that ammo scarcity can happen.

First, the GM could introduce it as a Challenge, for example by setting a scene where an NPC, who has counted the bullets in your storage, warns you that you are about to run out. Another way is as a result of messing up on a skill roll, for example when you roll for Ranged Combat.

"Ought to be polite to a man with a gun. Only common sense."

Rick Grimes

Michael Syrett (Order #8848822)

THE WEAPON TABLES

The two weapon tables contain examples of weapons. Use them to get an idea of how different weapons work mechanically. Ranged weapons can be fired at any target that is within their maximum range. For instance, if a weapon has a range of Long, it can be fired at enemies who are at either Short or Long distance.

CLOSE COMBAT WEAPONS

WEAPON	DAMAGE	BONUS	SLOTS
Foot or fist	1	0	—
Improvised weapon	1	+1	½
Knuckle duster	1	+1	½
Rifle butt	1	+1	1
Knife	1	+2	½
Small axe	1	+2	½
Quarterstaff	1	+3	1
Crowbar	2	+1	1
Baseball bat	2	+1	1
Spear	2	+2	1
Sword	2	+2	1
Big axe	2	+2	1
Sledgehammer	3	0	2

RANGED WEAPONS

WEAPON	DAMAGE	BONUS	RANGE	SLOTS
Throwing knife	1	+1	Short	½
Bow	1	+2	Long	1
Crossbow	2	+2	Short	1
Pistol or revolver	2	+2	Short	1
Pipe Gun	2	+1	Short	1
Shotgun	2	+3	Short	1
Rifle	2	+2	Long	1
Sniper rifle	2	+2	Extreme	2
Sub machine gun	2	+3	Short	1
Assault rifle	2	+3	Long	1
Heavy machine gun	3	+3	Extreme	3
Molotov cocktail	BP 6	0	Short	½
Hand grenade	BP 8	+1	Short	½
Rocket launcher	BP 10	+2	Long	2
Tank cannon	BP 12	+3	Extreme	X

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

VEHICLES

All vehicles built before the outbreak are now rusty and dented. Most of them need to be repaired or refueled, if they work at all. When you find a car or other means of transportation, the GM may roll on the table below to determine if it is usable. Roll a die two times, first to determine the state of the vehicle, and then to see if there is fuel in the tank.

If your PC gets a vehicle during character creation it is considered fully functional with a half-filled tank.

VEHICLE CONDITION

D6	CONDITION	FUEL
1	Broken and cannot be fixed	Empty
2	Broken and in need of extensive repairs	Empty
3	Broken and in need of repairs	Empty
4	Functional but breaks down after driving D6 sectors if not repaired	Fumes
5	Functional but breaks down after driving D6 days if not repaired	Half full
6	Functional	Full tank

OUT OF FUEL

The game does not track fuel usage. Instead, running out of gas can happen in two ways. If you have driven the car a lot, the GM might decide to introduce a shortage of fuel as a new Challenge, simply by stating that the meter is running low.

Another way is when you mess up on a skill roll. No matter what skill roll you messed up, the GM may decide that it means that you miscalculated how much fuel you had left, or that there is a hole in the tank. Whatever happened, you are now stuck in the wilderness with a car that won't start.

EXAMPLES OF VEHICLE ISSUES

- Will run out of gas
- In need of repairs
- Easily gets a flat tire
- Loud
- No headlights
- Broken windshield
- Leaks gas
- Constantly in need of maintenance

VEHICLE ATTRIBUTES

All vehicles have four attributes: Maneuverability, Damage, Hull, and Armor. Additionally, vehicles have one or more Issues.

MANEUVERABILITY is the gear bonus of the vehicle, i.e., the number of bonus base dice you add to Mobility when driving it.

DAMAGE is the damage you do if you crash into someone in a fight.

HULL is the vehicle's Health points. When Hull reaches zero, roll on the table Critical Vehicle Damage (page 77).

ARMOR is the number of dice you roll when the vehicle sustains damage. Each success decreases the damage by one.

VEHICLES IN COMBAT

When you drive a vehicle in combat, you can either choose the Movement action or Close Combat, if you want to ram someone. Roll for Mobility to succeed in either case.

Dear Michelle

When we first met you, you told me that you were a hairdresser. I remember that I wanted to add, "and a bad bitch," but I didn't dare say anything. Your parents were bikers, and not the suburban riding club kind. When the outbreak destroyed the world, you were only nineteen, but you already had a mean red scar on your neck that you covered with a tattoo of burning flamingos – a memento from some untold horror in your past. You were alone when we found you, and you never told us what happened to the rest of your gang: your parents, your brothers, or your friends. Taking you in made us harder, more resilient, more eager to fight and win. I used to think we also made you softer, in a good way. So when the offer came from Free Town, to live in safety and to stop starving and sleeping on the ground, you couldn't turn it down. But I couldn't stand for it. I still see you as a sister; I'm sorry I had to kill you.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

VEHICLE TYPES

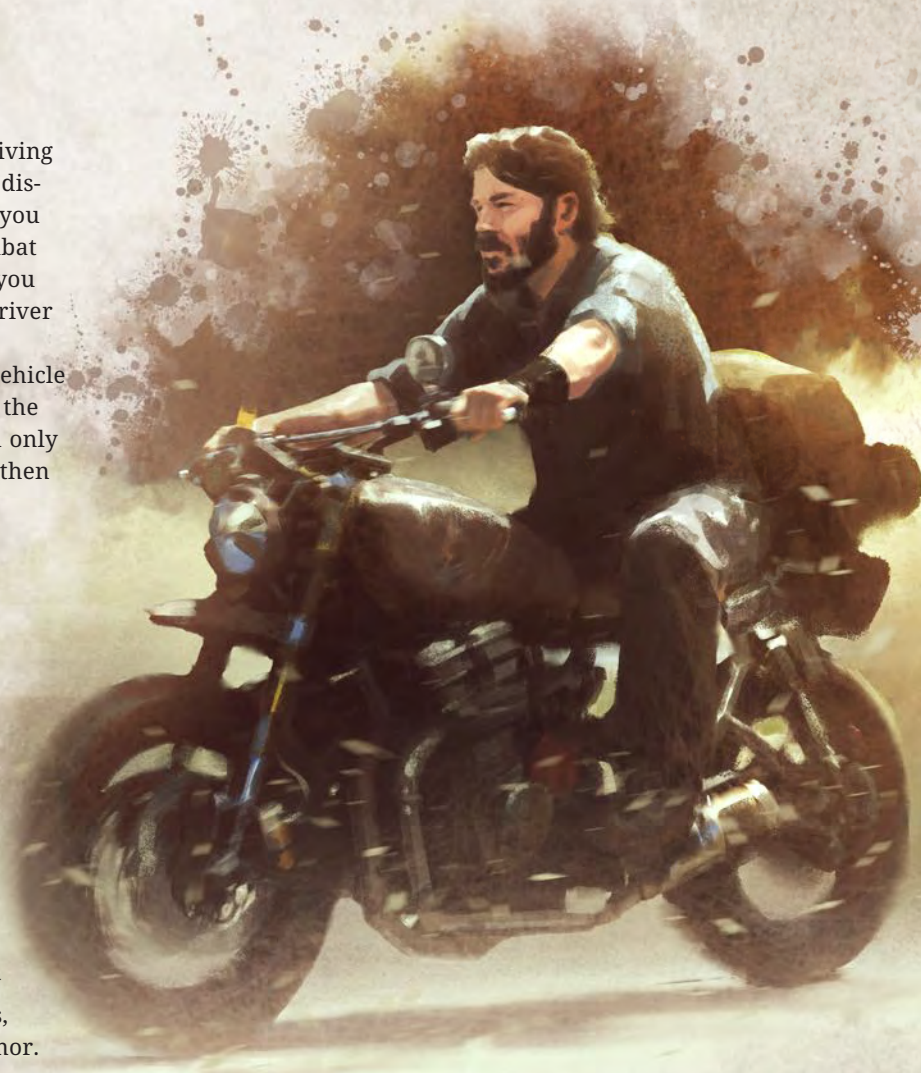
VEHICLE	MANEUVER-ABILITY	DAMAGE	HULL	ARMOR	ISSUE
Car	+2	2	4	4	Will run out of gas
Bicycle	+2	0	2	0	Easily gets a flat tire
Horse	+2	1	4	0	Needs to be fed, easily scared
Motorcycle	+3	2	3	2	Will run out of gas
Battle Tank	+1	4*	10	8	Will run out of gas, loud

* Not including weapons.

VEHICLE MOVEMENT

When you choose movement in combat while driving a vehicle, you can move to anywhere within the distances Short, Long, or Extreme. This means that you can move freely all over the area where the combat takes place. At times there will be places where you can't go with a vehicle, for example if there is a river but no bridge to cross it.

Should both you and your opponent have a vehicle and fight over a large area, you may instead use the normal rules for distances in combat, letting you only move one distance per round. The distances are then considered to be much greater than normal.



RAMMING

You need to be within Short or Long range to ram someone. Roll Mobility. If you hit, you deal damage equal to the vehicle's Damage rating. Each extra success adds one point of damage. If you fail the roll, you don't hit your target. Should you mess up, you have probably crashed into something or alerted walkers.

When you accidentally crash into something, the GM rolls on the table below to see what object you crashed into. Each object indicates a number of Crash Dice. Roll this many dice to see how much damage your vehicle takes, plus one. Don't forget to roll for the vehicle's armor.

CHASES

A vehicular chase is handled using opposed rolls, rolling for Mobility. The winner either gets away or catches up. If the pursuer wins, they get a chance to try to ram the pursued vehicle, or they can position the vehicle so that a firefight is possible. A draw means the distance between the two remains the same.

CRASH OBJECTS

D6	OBJECT HIT	CRASH DICE	DURABILITY
1	Soft material (haystack)	2	1
2	Fragile construction	3	2
3	Another car	4	(Vehicle's hull)
4	Wooden house	6	3
5	Brick wall	8	4
6	Enhanced concrete wall	10	5

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

RAMMING OBJECTS: For how much damage it takes to destroy an object by ramming it, see Durability in the Crash Objects table. Whether you succeed in destroying the object or not, roll the Crash Dice to see how much damage your vehicle takes. Also roll for the vehicle's armor.

Imani (player 3): *As soon as I see Michelle running away, I jump on the motorbike and go after her. I'm out of bullets, so I try to ram her from behind, speeding up as much as I can.*

GM: *She hears you coming, and she is fleeing for her life. Michelle turns left, so you follow her around the corner and into the scrapyard. There are places to hide everywhere among the car wrecks, but you can try to ram her before she gets a chance to dive in between them. Roll Mobility. She also rolls Mobility, but gets no successes.*

Imani: *I get three successes! But I also mess up.*

GM: *Huh... You hit her for two damage, since you drive a motorbike, and you add two more damage for extra successes. That means you kill her. But as you mess up, you also somehow drive straight into...* [rolls a die which turns up 5]*... a brick wall or similar. The bike takes one damage, plus...* [rolls eight dice]*... two. A total of three damage. Roll two dice for armor; you need at least one success, or the motorbike is destroyed!*

TARGETING PASSENGERS

Drivers and passengers inside a vehicle are typically considered to be behind cover (page 63). Bikes, motorcycles, and horses don't provide cover, however.

DAMAGE TO A VEHICLE

Damage to a vehicle decreases its Hull rating. Vehicles take half damage (rounded down) from close combat weapons and can't be damaged at all by unarmed attacks. When Hull reaches zero, it is wrecked and can't be used until it gets extensive repairs. Roll on the table for Critical Vehicle Damage below.

CRITICAL VEHICLE DAMAGE

D6	RESULT
1	A random person in the vehicle gets hit and takes 3 points of damage.
2	The driver gets hit and takes 2 points of damage.
3	The gas tank is damaged, and fuel starts leaking.
4	The windshield and several windows are busted.
5	The driver loses control and the vehicle rams something. Roll on the Crash Objects table, but the Crash damage is dealt to the driver instead of the vehicle.
6	The vehicle starts burning. Everyone inside is hit by Intensity 6 fire. Roll a die to determine how many minutes it takes before the vehicle explodes (Blast Power 8).

REPAIRING A VEHICLE

Repairing a crashed vehicle to restore it to working order requires the right tools, spare parts, and plenty of time. The PC needs to make a Tech roll.

FIGHTING THE DEAD

Wherever you are in the world of the dead, swarms of walkers are a constant threat. You might be temporarily safe, but the walkers are always out there, hungry for your flesh. This section describes this threat in detail, and how you can fight back.

WALKER CHARACTERISTICS

The walkers don't have skills, attributes, Health Points, or any other mechanical characteristics. The GM should describe them in a creatively gory way while also reminding you that they were once human and living. Some help in doing this can be found in the two tables Walker Past and Walker Wounds on page 142.

SWARM SIZE

A group of walkers, typically five or more, is referred to as a *swarm*. The size of a swarm is its Swarm Size.

NUMBER OF WALKERS	SWARM SIZE
5–10	1
11–20	2
21–50	3
51–100	4
100+	5
1000+	6

Michael Syrett (Order #8348322)

HERD AND HORDE

In the game, the word *swarm* refers to a group of walkers; it could be five, it could be over a thousand. In the TV series, the characters use the term *herd* for large groups of walkers that moves in a random direction and kills everything in its way; this would cover swarms of size 4 to 6 in the game. Adding to this, the TV series feature examples of even greater swarms, referred to as *hordes*: a cataclysmic number of walkers, as when Alpha and her Whisperers spent years collecting them in a valley. Such hordes may exist in the game, but only in specific situations that cannot occur at random – for instance in survival mode scenarios where the swarm is integral to the plot.

THREAT LEVEL

As mentioned in chapter 1, the constant threat from walkers is measured by a Threat Level, on a scale from 0 to 6 indicating both how active the dead are in the area and how close they are to you.

THREAT METER: The Starter Set for *The Walking Dead Universe RPG* includes a Threat Meter to track the Threat Level. When there is a threat, the GM places the Threat Meter on the table for everyone to see. If you don't have access to the Threat Meter, the GM just notes the current Threat Level on a piece of paper.

SETTING THE THREAT LEVEL: When a scene starts, the GM sets the Threat Level according to the situation. It measures undead threats in the immediate surroundings and may thus be changed just by moving from one room to the next. If the situation in the game changes, the Threat Level changes accordingly.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

David (player 4): *We walk through the school, very carefully, just to check if we can find anything to use as a rope.*

GM: *The corridors are empty, and the heavy rain beats on the windows which are small and placed high up on the walls. Some of the lockers are open, and there are broken desks everywhere. It smells bad, like blood and intestines, but you see none of the dead here. Right next to what must have been the principal's office, someone has spray painted big red letters on the wall: "Get out. No living." The Threat Level is 1.*

Imani (Player 3): *So, we decide to be even more careful moving forward.*

The Gamemaster: [Quickly draws a map on a piece of paper.] *There is one corridor down here, one down here, and the stairs of course.*

David: *We go... left. Here. Very slowly. Looking for ropes, or anything we can use to pull the car out of the mud hole.*

GM: *You see nothing useful. You come to this door here. A sign says it used to be the gymnasium.*

Imani: *I open the door and peek in.*

GM: *There are about fifty to a hundred dead just standing there, most of them were teenagers, still dressed in their sportswear when the outbreak took hold of the school. One or two slowly turn their heads in your direction. The Threat Level goes up to 2.*

Imani: *We close the door and quietly walk away.*

GM: *As you turn around, you see that a walker has come out from one of the classrooms. It is standing in the corridor, but it has not seen you yet. It must have been a punk rocker in life, as you can still see flecks of green in its faded mohawk haircut. What do you do?*

INCREASING THE THREAT LEVEL

The Threat Level can be increased in four ways:

- Rolling a walker on a stress die and messing up
- Failing a skill roll to avoid walkers
- Facing a group of walkers that has been placed in a location beforehand by the GM
- Doing something in the game that attracts walkers, such as making noise

In situations where increasing the Threat Level seems illogical or not appropriate, the GM may instead do one of the following:

- Let a PC or NPC suffer a single walker attack (page 80)
- Increase the Swarm Size by one step

THE THREAT LEVELS

THREAT LEVEL	SITUATION
0	You are in a cleared area and safe. For now.
1	There are walkers around, but they have not noticed you. You might suffer a single walker attack if you mess up a skill test.
2	There are walkers close by, but they are not aware of you. Yet. The GM can draw a map of the area and point out where the walkers are located exactly.
3	The walkers are aware of you. All nearby walkers will shamble towards you, and you must fight to get out alive. All PCs present take one point of stress.
4	The walkers are closing in on you.
5	They are at arm's length.
6	The dead are in your face, surrounding you.

Imani (player 3): *I raise my shovel and walk up to him. Making a clean swing, I chop off his head from behind, quietly, so that the swarm in the gymnasium won't hear it.*

GM: *Roll Close Combat.*

Imani: *I roll five dice, plus two stress dice. Two successes, but also a walker.*

The Gamemaster: *You succeed, but you also mess up and alert the other walkers. Tell me what happens.*

Imani: *Well, I chop off its head, but with a little too much force because I lose my grip on the shovel. Both its body and the head slam separately – boom, boom – into the lockers along the wall.*

GM: *You immediately hear movement from the gymnasium. Within seconds, the door opens, and walkers start to fill up the corridor and move towards you. The Threat Level is raised to 3, and you both take one point of stress.*

MULTIPLE THREAT LEVELS

If the PCs split up, they will have separate Threat Levels for each group. Typically, if any PCs are out of sight of each other, they should have separate Threat Levels. The GM has final say. If two group of PCs at different Threat Levels meet up, the GM determines which Threat Level is used from then on, based on the situation and the evolving story.

Michael Syrett (Order #8348322)

AVOIDING WALKERS

At Threat Level 1 or 2, you can still try to avoid the walkers, for example by using Stealth to sneak around them or running past them with Mobility. Failing the skill roll means that the GM can have one of two things happen:

- The Threat Level is increased one step
- You suffer a single attack

Should you also mess up on the skill roll, both things happen.

DISGUISING AS THE DEAD: One way to avoid walkers is to make them believe that you are one of them, by smearing yourself with the remains of other walkers. In this way, they won't smell that you are alive. You need to roll Stealth to succeed, and depending on the situation, the GM may rule that you need to pass more than one Stealth roll before you are safe. If you fail a roll, the walkers discover you while you are in their midst, at arm's length (Threat Level 5).

REDUCING THE THREAT LEVEL

There is no easy way to reduce the Threat Level. At Threat Level 2 and below, you can generally just wait for the walkers to leave. You can even attack the walkers first, to clear out the area (page 83).

At Threat Level 3 and above, the walkers know you are there and won't just go away. Even if they can't currently attack you, they might just mill around the area aimlessly. To get rid of them, you'll need to cause some kind of distraction. Describe what you want to do, and the GM will decide what rolls (if any) are needed to lure the walkers away or direct their attention elsewhere.

SINGLE WALKER ATTACKS

A single attack is used when you attack or are attacked by just one or a few walkers (less than a swarm). If you want to determine the exact number, the GM can roll a double low, but it has no mechanical effect. A single attack can result from you messing up on a skill roll. This means that you have not alerted the swarm at large, but one or two of them are definitely coming at you.

ONE ROLL: A single walker attack is resolved with one skill roll by you. You can roll for any skill that makes sense in the situation. The GM has the final word. Others may help you with the roll (page 51).

DURING COMBAT: If you suffer a single attack while already in a brawl or a duel, you still get to make a roll to avoid it. This does not count as an action.

SUCCESS: If you succeed, you have killed the walkers, hidden from them, or in some other way stopped them. This doesn't mean that you are safe, however. You could still be barricaded in a room with walkers waiting outside the only exit.

FAILURE: If you fail the roll, roll on the Walker Attack table on the next page. This might mean that you take damage, or that you die. If you become Broken, you must also roll for a critical injury (page 69). Even if you fail, the single attack is over.

GM: *You walk slowly down the stairs into the school's basement. It is completely dark, and it reeks of decayed flesh. Even though you can't see a thing, you sense movement from somewhere in front of you. What do you do?*

Valeria (player 2): *I take out the flashlight from my backpack, and, while standing halfway down the stairs, I light up the darkness. I am ready with my knife in the other hand.*

GM: *You flick the light on in time to see three walkers coming up the stairs towards you. They all wear school uniforms; teenagers now horribly deformed by bite marks, with pieces missing from their bodies. The first one still wears round glasses, and her red hair is in a ponytail. But half her jaw is missing, along with most of her teeth. You take one stress point.*

Valeria: *I stab her in the head. When the others try to get past her body, I stab them too. That's Close Combat. Oh no, I fail.*

GM: *Well, you stab her alright, but you miss her head, and the knife gets stuck between the bones in her shoulder. She is right on top of you, with the flashlight illuminating her face from below.*

Valeria: *I tear the knife from her shoulder and smash it into the side of her head. That is me pushing the roll and taking one more stress. But I fail again.*

GM: *She forces you down onto your back on the stairs, trying to bite into your neck. Roll on the Walker Attack table.*

Valeria: *I get 23. That means I get away, but I cut myself. I guess I struggle with her and manage to get hold of the knife and pull it out of her shoulder. But as I do so, I cut open my hand. By hitting her with my fists and kicking her, I'm able to get her off me and run back up the stairs. At the last moment I manage to slam the door behind me. But I can hear them on the other side of it, trying to get to me. I am bleeding badly from the palm.*

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

WALKER ATTACK

D66	EFFECT
11	They come after you, but you got away. Take one point of stress.
12	You manage to hold the walker off, but it drools all over your face. You start vomiting heavily. Take one stress point.
13	They have you cornered, and you know it's probably the end. But somehow you survive. Describe what happens. Take one stress point.
14	You kill it, but you break or lose your weapon or something else important.
15	You hold it down and crack its head with a stone. Take one stress point.
16	It pulls the hair from your head as it tries to drag you close enough to bite. You punch it in the face until it dies. Take one point of damage.
21	It headbutts you and throws you to the floor. But then you kill it. Take one point of damage.
22	Its dead weight pushes into you as you kill it, so you hit the back of your head on the ground. Take one point of damage.
23	As you fight it, you accidentally cut yourself on something sharp. Take one point of damage and take one more if you don't succeed with a Medicine roll to stop the blood loss.
24	You jump to get away from them. Make a Mobility roll. If you fail, you fall and take one point of damage.
25	They get on top off you, but you manage to slay them and avoid being bitten. You must make a Force roll to push them off. If you fail, you black out for D6 minutes pinned down by the corpses.
26	It chases after you. You get away, but you must make a Mobility roll to not stumble and fall. If you fail, you hit your head on something sharp and takes two points of damage.
31	It grabs your head to bite you in the face. Make a Close Combat roll to keep it from headbutting you repeatedly in its attempts to take a bite. Take two points of damage if you fail.
32	It bites at your clothes, at your hair, and even at your shoes. But you manage to elbow it in the face, several times, until the skull breaks. Your arm is in bad shape. Take two points of damage.
33	Somehow you kill it and hit yourself at the same time. Take your own weapon's damage.
34	You fight it on the ground for what seems like forever, but finally you kill it. Take one point each of damage and stress.
35	It tears off one of your ears and you bleed heavily. Take two points of damage.
36	You're stuck between two walkers, who are pulling you in opposite directions. You feel skin, muscles, and sinews in your arms and legs being stretched out and snapping. Take two points of damage and make an Endure roll not to pass out for D6 minutes.
41	It repeatedly cuts and stabs you with a rusty, sharp object wedged through one of its hands. Take two points of damage.
42	You lose your balance, and it forces you backwards. You bump into sharp objects; fall over and hit your head; stumble, severely twisting your ankles and wrists. Take two points of damage.
43	It gets on top of you and your head is hammered against the ground before you can kill it. Take three points of damage.
44	It breaks your arm while you wrestle it. Take three points of damage.
45	It tears off your left kneecap with its teeth and starts chewing on it. You need to amputate the whole leg within {D6×10} minutes, or you die. Take three points of damage.
46	You protect your face, but it bites you in both earlobes. Your only chance to survive is to cut the earlobes off within D6 hours. Take two points of damage.
51	It is just a small scratch, but within days the infection will take root, and you will die. Your only chance is to carve off the infected meat within D6 hours. Take two points of damage.
52	You get bitten on a toe. Your only chance to survive is to amputate the foot within D6 hours. Take two points of damage.
53	One of your fingers gets bitten off and the infection from the bite spreads into your body. Your only chance to survive is to amputate the hand within D6 minutes. Take two points of damage.
54	You are bitten in the stomach. The wound is not that deep, but soon you will get a fever, and within D6 days you will be dead.
55	You are bitten in the throat. Blood everywhere. You die.
56	They bite you several times in the back. Within D6 hours you are dead.
61	You manage to fight them off, but somehow you are tagged in the head, either by your own weapon or friendly fire. You die cursing your bad luck.
62	As you grapple with a walker, you failed to notice another walker on the ground reaching for your leg. It takes a huge bite out of your calf. You fall screaming as both walkers overwhelm you. You've lost a fatal amount of blood before you hit the ground.
63	You defeat it, and everything is fine. But you failed to notice that one of them is still coming for you. It bites into your back and you die screaming.
64	They surround you and push you to the ground. For several seconds, you manage to fight them, but then one of them presses its face against your stomach and starts tearing out your intestines with its teeth. You die screaming.
65	A walker bites you in the face and eats one of your eyes and your nose. You try to fight it, but you soon bleed to death.
66	You are overwhelmed by walkers that tear the flesh from your bones. You are dead.

Michael Syrett (Order #8848822)

"The world is dark and broken, but we're not. Not yet. We stare into the face of death every day, until one day, that face is our own. How do you come back from that? My dad wanted mercy to prevail over wrath. If we lose that, we lose everything."

Judith Grimes

AMPUTATION

In some results on the Walker Attack table, you must amputate a body part to survive. The person who is cutting off a piece of you must make a Medicine roll. Both of you take one point of stress. Whether the roll is successful or not, you take the critical injury "severed limb" (#61, page 69). But if the Medicine roll is successful, the injury is not lethal, as indicated in the table. Should the skill roll fail, the injury is lethal and handled as normal.

FIGHTING A SWARM

Once the Threat Level reaches 3, when the walkers are aware of you and move in for their meal, the situation is dealt with in rounds, as in brawls. Basically, they attack while you fight to get to safety.

Each round, up to three chosen PCs and NPCs in the fight roll for skills and add up their number of successes. Which skills can be used depends on the current Threat Level and is indicated by the Swarm Attack table on the next page. Additional PCs and NPCs present can assist with help dice (page 51), but no more than three may roll.

SMALL GROUPS: If just two characters face a swarm of walkers, they still make three skill rolls, with one of them rolling twice. The second of those roll gets a –2 modifier. If a single PC fights a swarm, they roll all three rolls themselves, with a –2 modifier to the second roll and –4 to the third roll.

LEADERSHIP: A PC who is not making one of the three skill rolls during a round may bark orders and roll for Leadership. If the others do as they are told, the PC may hand out one extra die per success on the Leadership skill roll. No more than three dice can be given to the same person. Only one person per round can roll for Leadership in this way.

SWARM THREAT: You win and lose as a group, by comparing your number of successes against the current Swarm Threat. The Swarm Threat is calculated round by round by adding Swarm Size to the current Threat Level.

WINNING THE ROUND: If you get a total number of successes equal to or greater than the Swarm Threat, and the Swarm Size is 3 or lower, you win the fight. The Threat Level goes down to 0, 1, or 2, as decided by the GM depending on the situation and what fits the story.

As long as the Swarm Size is 3 or less, you only need to win one round to end the fight, either because you killed all the walkers, or you managed to run away or hide. If the Swarm Size is 4 or higher, winning a round just means the Swarm Size is reduced one step.

Even if you win the round as a group, any PCs who mess up their skill roll suffer a single attack (page 80). This does not increase the Threat Level.

LOSING TO THE DEAD: If you get fewer successes than the current Swarm Threat, the walkers win the round. The GM chooses one of the following options:

- The Threat Level is increased one step.
- The Swarm Size is increased one step.
- The Swarm attacks.

If one or more PCs messed up in a lost round, the GM chooses two options instead of one.

ALMOST MAKING IT: If you fail the roll but get at least half the successes you need to beat the walkers, you have accomplished something helpful, even if you still lose the round. You get one free extra success the next round.

SWARM ATTACKS: A walker swarm can perform three types of attack. The Swarm Attack table on the next page indicates what options are available for the GM to choose from at which Threat Level.

- **SINGLE ATTACK:** A single walker attacks one PC or NPC with a single attack (page 80). Roll a random die to see who is targeted.
- **BLOCK:** The swarm block off all escape routes. Until the fight is won, all rolls for Mobility or Stealth need one extra success to succeed.
- **MASS ATTACK:** Roll a random die to see who is attacked by the swarm. The target must immediately roll on the Walker Attack table (page 81) – no skill roll can be made to avoid this.

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For every attack the swarm makes, Swarm Threat is calculated with a –1 modifier. If Swarm Threat is reduced to zero this way, the attack is over, and the walkers move on.

SWARM ATTACK

THREAT LEVEL	SKILLS	ATTACK
3	Endure, Force, Mobility, Ranged Combat, Stealth	Single attack, block
4	Force, Mobility, Ranged Combat	Single attack, block
5	Force, Close Combat, Ranged Combat	Single attack, block
6	Force, Close Combat	Mass attack

SACRIFICING ANOTHER: At the start of a round, one or more PC can try to sacrifice someone else to the walkers to get away. Make an opposed roll for Force. If you win, you are out of the fight, while the victim must roll on the Walker Attack table (page 81). If you lose, you must roll on the table. The Force roll counts as one of the three rolls you are allowed as a group.

Hannah (player 1): *I dive under a car or something. Rebecca can handle herself.*

GM: *Actually, there are no cars or any places to hide, and the walkers are just meters from you. Any second, they may surround you. Rebecca has started to scream with fear.*

Hannah: *I push her towards the walkers to save myself. I guess it is Force, right?*

DESPERATE ESCAPE

A lone PC who is surrounded by walkers may try to postpone death by finding a place to hide, like inside an abandoned tank or under a dumpster. The PC is safe for the moment but cannot do anything but hope to be rescued. This requires a Mobility roll. If successful, the PC is saved for the moment, but the walkers are still there, and they won't go anywhere. The fate of the PC is now in the GM's hands.

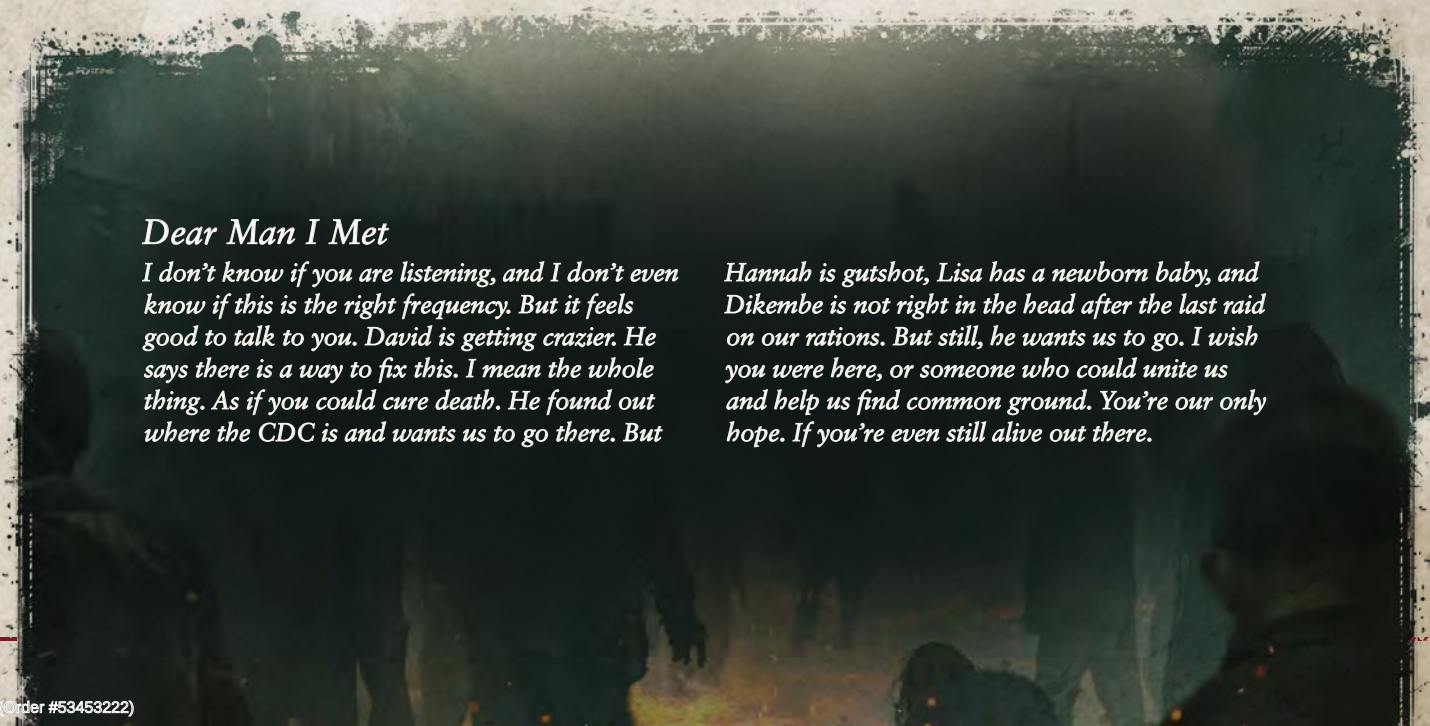
BRAWLS AMONG WALKERS

If you are fighting a living enemy in the middle of a swarm, the rules for brawls and the rules for fighting the walker swarm apply at the same time. Each round, PCs and NPCs choose whether to perform regular actions in the brawl or fight the walkers. Fighting the walkers counts as the Other action.

CLEARING OUT AN AREA

Clearing out an area means that you attack the walker swarm before they spot you, while the Threat Level is still 2. It works exactly like fighting a swarm, but since the Threat Level is low it will be easier. Another positive effect of such a preemptive strike is that the PCs do not take stress when alerting the swarm, as the Threat Level is still only at 2.

Should you fail to clear out the swarm on the first round, the Threat Level goes up, either to 3 if you are shooting at them, or to 5 if you fight them in close combat. At this point, you will take stress for alerting the walkers.



Dear Man I Met

I don't know if you are listening, and I don't even know if this is the right frequency. But it feels good to talk to you. David is getting crazier. He says there is a way to fix this. I mean the whole thing. As if you could cure death. He found out where the CDC is and wants us to go there. But Hannah is gutshot, Lisa has a newborn baby, and Dikembe is not right in the head after the last raid on our rations. But still, he wants us to go. I wish you were here, or someone who could unite us and help us find common ground. You're our only hope. If you're even still alive out there.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

Michael Syrett (Order #53458222)

CHAPTER 6

HOME AND AWAY

It was such a dumb thing to do, to fall in love with my best friend and then treat her like shit. I could say I was stressed out, that I had too much on my plate – especially since we were recruiting new survivors, and the ones we found were even more traumatized than we were. But the truth is, I was on a power trip, and I thought I had the right to take whatever I wanted. It came to a point where she pressed the tip of a knife against my throat. Then she found someone else. I spent almost a year trying to win her back. It wasn't until we found that old lodge in the mountains that she would even speak to me again. But just a few days later those raiders attacked, and they shot her in the head.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

In this chapter, rules and guidelines for two of the most fundamental parts of the game are described: the haven, and going on supply runs in the untamed wilderness.

THE HAVEN

A haven could be anything: a caravan of trailers, an abandoned railway carriage, or a zoo with living animals. When the PCs decide to settle down somewhere and make that place their home, it becomes a haven. At the back of the book you will find a *haven sheet*, for the players to fill out and update when projects are finished or new survivors are welcomed to join the community.

A haven might look like a place where the PCs are safe. While being partly true, a haven is also filled with conflicts. There can be internal struggles, a constant threat from walkers trying to get in, and hostile NPCs wanting to take what the PCs have. There will always be weak spots in the defenses where danger can get through – either in the shape of deadly opponents, or from internal strife among the NPC survivors.

CHARACTERISTICS OF THE HAVEN

The most important part of the haven is its description – what it looks like, how it smells, where people can get some privacy, and where decisions are made. The GM may ask you some of the questions in the boxed text Describing the haven. You should also draw a simple map of the haven and mark important locations, such as where people sleep and eat.

A haven has two attributes: Capacity and Defense. Capacity is a measure of how many people can live in the haven without starving. Defense determines how well the haven is protected by walls, alarm systems, even stationary weapons.

Capacity and Defense range from 0 to 6. The scores may be improved by working on projects at the haven.

CAPACITY

Capacity can represent many things – a stash of canned food, a farm with animals, or an area surrounding the haven where it is easy to scavenge. The Capacity table shows the maximum number of people that can stay at the haven without starving to death. At Capacity 0, PCs and NPCs only have the rations they carry – there is no other food in the haven.

RUNNING OUT OF FOOD: When you run out of food, either because your Capacity has been lowered or you take in too many NPC survivors, people start to starve. They will get angry, desperate, and eager to leave or

DESCRIBING THE HAVEN

- What does it look like?
- How does it smell?
- Where can you post lookouts?
- Where do people go to be alone?
- Where do you get fresh water?
- What food sources are there?
- Where are important decisions made?
- Where do you sleep?
- What characteristics of the haven annoy you or make people irritated?
- What surrounds the haven?
- What are the haven's weak spots?
- How did you find it?
- Who makes the decisions?
- What do people in the haven talk about? What do they long for? What scares them?

CAPACITY

CAPACITY	INHABITANTS	DESCRIPTION
0	0	Constant need to find other food sources
1	10	Rifles to hunt with, some canned food, and fresh water nearby
2	20	Some livestock and good fishing and/or hunting equipment
3	50	Small farm with livestock and crops
4	80	Large farm with livestock and crops
5	200	Well-arranged trade agreement with other communities
6	500	A system of farms and well-established trade-routes, workshops, and rudimentary industry

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STARVATION

Examples of NPC Issues – things an NPC might do if starvation sets in:

- Demand new leadership.
- Plan to steal others' food.
- Go crazy from hunger.
- Be on the verge of death.
- Seek others to blame for the predicament.
- Become desperate and act foolishly.
- Plan to abandon the group.

revolt. The NPCs get temporary Issues representing this. The textbox Starvation gives some examples of such Issues.

Should Capacity suddenly be lowered to zero – as the result of a fire breaking out, for example – each PC and NPC has a double low (see page 13) number of rations left. No more food can be found in the haven.

DEFENSE

The Defense rating is a measure of how safe your haven is. It can represent everything from whether you have guards at the entrance, to trenches, high walls, and booby traps. If your haven is attacked, everyone inside who fights the intruders gets a bonus to their skill roll equal to the haven's Defense value. The Defense table gives some examples.

DEFENSE

DEFENSE	BONUS	EXAMPLE
0	+0	A house with a broken front door
1	+1	Tents surrounded by an alarm system made of ropes and bells
2	+2	A wooden fence around a farm, with a lookout on the roof
3	+3	A house with reinforced sturdy doors, blocked windows, a fence, and a reinforced gate
4	+4	High walls of stone with a metal gate, a scout in a tower, and a system for checking security around the clock
5	+5	A fenced in prison with high walls and a metal gate
6	+6	A military base with electronic surveillance, guard towers, concrete walls, and metal doors with electronic locks

"Come with us. Save the world for that little one. Save it for yourselves. Save it for the people out there who don't got nothing left to do except survive."

Abraham Ford

DEFENSE AGAINST WALKERS: A haven's Defense rating is also used to measure how big a swarm of walkers needs to be to break down your walls and get in. The size of a swarm is measured by a Swarm Size rating from 1 to 6, as described on page 77. If the Swarm Size is equal to or greater than your haven's Defense, the walkers will eventually break in. The time it will take for them to do this is shown in the Overrun table. Roll a die to determine how many seconds, minutes, hours, days, or weeks it will take. During that time, you can try to distract or kill them – or improve your defenses.

GM: *Something wakes you up.*

Hannah (player 1): *But I'm on lookout in the tower. Shouldn't I already be awake?*

GM: *Weird, huh? The stress must have finally gotten to you and made your body collapse into sleep. You rolled a walker, remember? That means you messed up. Anyways, something is moving in the darkness in front of the gate. There are three shadows, and they are not walkers. One of them is carrying a wooden ladder.*

Hannah: *Is there time for me to go and wake up everyone else before they climb in?*

GM: *Not a chance.*

Hannah: *I aim at the person with the ladder, then I roll Ranged Combat. Since I'm in the haven, and it has a Defense of 4, I get to add four extra dice to my roll.*

OVERRUN

DEFENSE	SWARM SIZE	TIME UNTIL OVERRUN
0	Single attacks	0
1	1 (5–10)	Seconds
2	2 (11–20)	Minutes
3	3 (21–50)	Hours
4	4 (51–100)	(Double high) Hours
5	5 (100+)	Days
6	6 (1,000+)	Weeks

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HAVEN ISSUES

D66	ISSUE
11	Reliance on food sources that will be depleted
12	Reliance on bullets and firearms
13	Extreme cold in the winter
14	Some of the food or water might be tainted
15	Can easily be spotted from a distance
16	Difficult to reinforce the defenses
21	Close to large swarm of walkers
22	Another group sees this as their territory
23	Cramped, which creates conflicts in the group
24	Parts of the haven have not been secured
25	Rats everywhere
26	Well-known location to other people
31	A pack of wolves hunting nearby
32	You share it with another group
33	Something regularly draws walkers to this location
34	The entry is insecure
35	An NPC rules this place
36	People living here have become soft and careless
41	Strange belief system among the NPC survivors
42	Several addicts among the NPCs survivors
43	Nobody talks about the dark secret
44	Many entrances to keep an eye on
45	The surroundings have already been scavenged of all resources
46	Several babies that need to be taken care of and protected
51	Not enough clothes, mattresses, and blankets
52	No proper system for human waste – prone to smell and disease
53	No tools to build or repair anything
54	The place is old and in bad shape
55	The building is a fire hazard
56	Some parts are submerged in water
61	No proper way to cook food
62	The entrance is hard to reinforce and guard
63	The land is not arable – crops will not grow easily
64	The ground is riddled with undetonated land mines
65	Need to fetch fresh water from an unsafe place
66	Unresolved conflicts in the group

LOSING CAPACITY OR DEFENSE

When things happen in the game that break your barriers, or when someone burns down your food supply, you will lose points in Capacity or Defense. If all your food is gone, you are down to Capacity 0.

Sometimes it is easy to repair the damage. You may, for example, need to go on a run to find a certain object or tool, and then it is done. At other times you must rebuild everything from scratch. Either way, this is often handled as projects, described on page 88.

GM: *It's been almost a week since the guys who were running the trade route to the Sewer compound went missing. This is when Gary shows up at your house, Hannah. "Sorry to bother you," he says. "But we're almost out of food, and people are starting to notice. The Hadley brothers are really upset – I think they're up to something. I'm afraid they're gonna take what's left of our supplies and leave."*

Hannah (player 1): *"It couldn't be that bad. We still have the animals, right?"*

GM: *"If we eat them now, we'll starve come winter."*

Hannah: *I put my revolver on the table in front of me. "I'll make sure nobody does anything stupid."*

GM: *Your Capacity is lowered to 3.*

ISSUES

All havens have one or more Issues, such as *leaking roof* or *unguarded underground tunnels*. If your haven relies on a stash of canned goods, it has the Issue, "*food will be depleted*." Some Issues may be resolved in-game – for instance, a leaking roof might be repaired.

Most havens have a secret Issue – a weakness you have not yet discovered. Secret Issues may be revealed and resolved by searching your haven and finding security breaches.

The haven Issues table can be used as inspiration or to randomly determine Issues.

PROJECTS

Capacity and Defense can be increased by completing projects. This could mean planting crops or building a wall, or just repairing broken things.

A project always takes time and a workforce to complete. It may also demand special knowledge. This knowledge is represented by the Tech skill. One of the PCs or an NPC must have a high enough Tech skill level for the project to be started.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

PROJECT EXAMPLES

Refer to the Project Examples table for sample endeavors with associated requirements and effects.

- *Effect* is the level of Capacity or Defense that the haven will have after the project is done.
- *Time* is the time it takes to finish it. Roll a die to define the exact time.
- *Workforce* is the number of people it will take to achieve the goal safely.
- *Requirements* account for resources and the Tech value someone working the project needs to have.

Trained NPCs are considered to have a Tech level of 1, Experts have Tech 3, and Masters have Tech 5. Projects may also demand special equipment or resources.

PROJECT SCALE: The GM decides what it will take to complete a project. The amount of work and resources needed should depend on the level to which Capacity or Defense is being increased. At higher levels of Capacity and Defense, minor projects at the haven will not increase the ratings – setting up a simple alarm system at a highly guarded army base, for example, won't raise your Defense rating. Similarly, finding some apple trees close to a functional farm won't increase your overall Capacity.

Valeria (Player 2): *If we are going to stay here, we need to make it work in the long run. I'm thinking we can start growing stuff on the roof.*

Hannah (Player 1): *That's a great idea. People have rooftop gardens in cities all the time.*

GM: *You can definitely initiate that project. It would take your haven from Capacity 1 to 2. It would take a couple of months before the crops can be eaten, maybe three or four people working it, seeds, and you need tools to build something that collects rainwater. It'll take Tech 2 to figure all that out.*

Valeria: *Yeah! I have Tech 3, so not a problem. And we need to start looking for seeds and tools. Let's do it!*

TEACHING SURVIVORS

In addition to upgrading their haven, PCs can also improve NPC survivors. An untrained NPC rolls four dice for all skills. But if they become Trained at a skill, they add a die, rolling five dice. Should they become Expert, they add another three dice, rolling a total eight dice for the skill.

A PC or an NPC can teach one skill to a group of up to five unskilled NPCs. The teacher must have at least level 2 in the skill being taught. Teaching takes one month. Neither the teacher nor the NPCs may work other projects during this time. After the month, all NPCs become Trained in the skill. If lessons are interrupted, they might continue later.

An NPC who is Trained at a skill might become an Expert if she is taught by an NPC or PC who has at least level 4 in the relevant skill. The teacher can have only one student at a time. It takes six months for the NPC to become an Expert. Both the NPC and the teacher can do other things during the teaching period, but they must have lessons regularly.

Some extraordinary NPCs the PCs meet are Masters in a skill, which means that they roll ten dice. An NPC cannot be taught to become a Master.

TEACHING SURVIVORS

LEVEL	SKILL LEVEL	# OF STUDENTS	TIME	TEACHER SKILL
Trained	+1	1–5	One month	2+
Expert	+3	1	Six months	4+

PROJECT EXAMPLES

PROJECT	EFFECT	TIME	WORKFORCE	REQUIREMENTS
Beehives	Capacity 2	Months	3–4	Equipment, wild bees, Tech 3
Potato field	Capacity 3	Months	10	Potatoes, a safe field, Tech 2
Pigsty	Capacity 3	Months	10	Pigs, feed, a pen, Tech 3
Trade route	Capacity 5	Weeks	20–30	Valuables to trade, contact with other havens, Tech 1
Simple alarm system	Defense 1	1 day	2–3	Ropes and tin cans, Tech 1
Defense barriers	Defense 2	2 days	5	Tools, equipment, Tech 1
Reinforcing stone walls	Defense 4	1 month	50	Tools, Tech 4
Bullet production	Defense 4	1 month	5	Tools, workshop, Tech 5

Michael Syrett (Order #53469222)

BUILDING GEAR

PCs might repair or even build equipment. This is handled as projects. Examples of building and repairing equipment can be found in the Gear Projects table. The exact amount of time required to complete the build (weeks, hours, or days) is decided by rolling a die.

GEAR PROJECTS

GEAR	TIME	WORK-FORCE	REQUIREMENTS
Several axes	Weeks	1	Forge, material, Tech 2
Simple body armor	Days	1	Sewing equipment, material, Tech 2
Molotov cocktails	Minutes	1	Bottles, gasoline, Tech 1
Pipe gun	Weeks	5	Scraps, shotgun shells, Tech 3
Repair radio transmitter	Days	1	Tools, electricity, Tech 4
Repair clothes	Hours	1	Sewing equipment, Tech 1
Repair rifle	Days	1	Tools, Tech 3

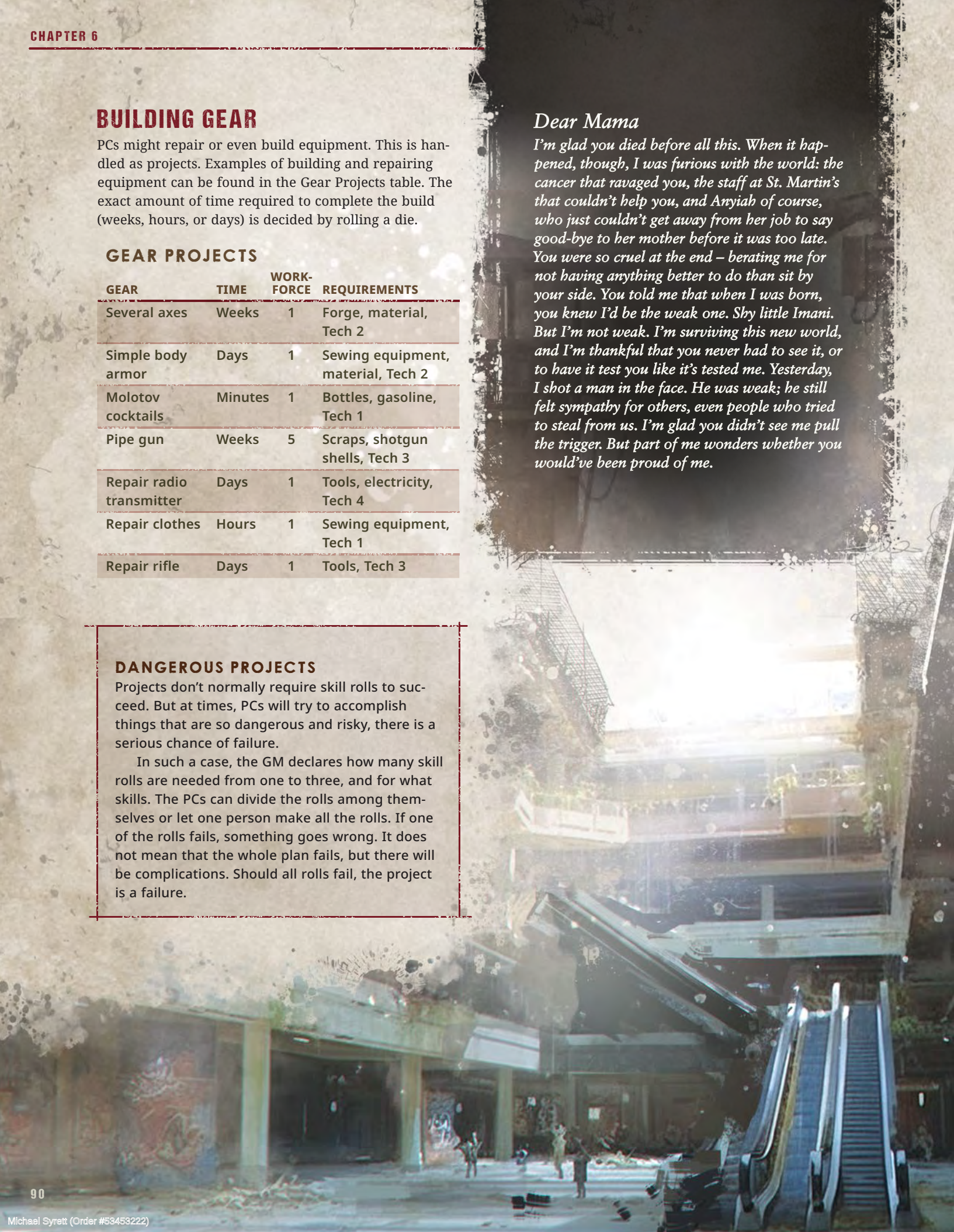
DANGEROUS PROJECTS

Projects don't normally require skill rolls to succeed. But at times, PCs will try to accomplish things that are so dangerous and risky, there is a serious chance of failure.

In such a case, the GM declares how many skill rolls are needed from one to three, and for what skills. The PCs can divide the rolls among themselves or let one person make all the rolls. If one of the rolls fails, something goes wrong. It does not mean that the whole plan fails, but there will be complications. Should all rolls fail, the project is a failure.

Dear Mama

I'm glad you died before all this. When it happened, though, I was furious with the world: the cancer that ravaged you, the staff at St. Martin's that couldn't help you, and Anyiah of course, who just couldn't get away from her job to say good-bye to her mother before it was too late. You were so cruel at the end – berating me for not having anything better to do than sit by your side. You told me that when I was born, you knew I'd be the weak one. Shy little Imani. But I'm not weak. I'm surviving this new world, and I'm thankful that you never had to see it, or to have it test you like it's tested me. Yesterday, I shot a man in the face. He was weak; he still felt sympathy for others, even people who tried to steal from us. I'm glad you didn't see me pull the trigger. But part of me wonders whether you would've been proud of me.



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EXAMPLES OF HAVENS

These are examples of havens you can use in your game.

THE OLD SCHOOLHOUSE

A red wooden schoolhouse on a grassy lane surrounded by a wooden fence. The windows are blocked, and the door is sturdy and has a lock. There's also a lookout platform on the roof. It is easy to spot intruders on the field before they reach the house. A river close by is teeming with fish. Several beehives are well-kept at the back of the house.

CAPACITY 2

DEFENSE 2

ISSUES:

- No running water inside.
- No other food source than what you can scavenge.

THE ROOFTOP APARTMENT

A big apartment at the top of a ten-story building in the middle of the city. All entrances from within the building are blocked. The only possible entrance is by way of a system of ropes connected to other rooftops. A large stash of canned food and survival equipment, left by whoever lived here previously, remains largely untouched.

CAPACITY 1

DEFENSE 3

ISSUES:

- Dependent on the running water in the building.
- Easy to get trapped inside.
- The food resources will eventually be depleted.

THE MALL

A big empty shopping mall filled with abandoned shops, corpses, and signs of fighting. Dark and smelly. Surrounded by walkers. The military made a stand on the bottom floor sometime in the past, and they secured all entrances.

CAPACITY 3

DEFENSE 3

ISSUES:

- Surrounded by walkers.
- Well-known location.
- Many entrances to guard.
- Areas inside that have not been secured.
- Currently ruled by former security guards who are now would-be despots.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

GOING ON RUNS

A big part of the game is leaving the haven to go on runs into the broken world. The reasons for doing this are many and varied – a need to find food, weapons, medical supplies, or spare parts; a search for a new and better haven; a mission to attack another group; a quest to bring new NPC survivors to your haven; perhaps even a scientific expedition to seek a cure for the walker virus.

THE AREA MAP

When you play a campaign, you need an area map with a grid overlay. Each square represents a 10×10-kilometer *sector*. In Chapter 8, you'll find an area map covering a region north of Atlanta. The GM will have their separate version of the area map, where they can mark out locations, events, and factions as yet unknown to you.

At the start of a campaign, there will also be sectors that contain points of interest that are known to you. It could be a hospital, a military base, or a camp site where refugees were hiding right after the outbreak. The GM will mark these locations on your map.

MOVING AROUND

While on foot, you can cover one sector per day. With a vehicle, you can travel faster. The table Vehicle Movement shows the maximum number of sectors a certain vehicle might travel during a day. You cannot move diagonally between sectors.

VEHICLE MOVEMENT

VEHICLE	SECTORS/DAY
Car	5
Motorcycle	5
Scooter	4
Horse	2
Bicycle	2
Horse-drawn carriage	1
On foot	1

ENTERING A NEW SECTOR

When you move into a new sector, a PC can make a Scout roll – provided that person travels at the head of the main group or observes the sector from some vantage point. A successful Scout roll lets you spot dangers in the sector before they find you, and it helps you find ways around roadblocks.

Failing the Scout roll means that people or walkers in the sector will spot you first. If you travel by vehicle, you also must travel one fewer sector that day, as something is blocking your route.

SECTOR FEATURES: When you go into a sector, the GM will tell you what it looks like and describe key features. These could be dangers, but also potentially beneficial attributes, such as NPC survivors who might want to join your group. Sometimes, there is nothing of importance in the sector.

Imani (player 3): *I make the Scout roll.*

The Gamemaster: *Say something about what you do in the game.*

Imani: *I walk ahead of the others, not much, maybe 50 meters or so, and I'm very careful. I roll, but I failed.*

The Gamemaster: *Everything goes fine, even though the forest is much wetter than you anticipated – it's almost like a swamp. You find a small, abandoned cabin up on a hill in the middle of the forest where you can spend the night. Someone has already ransacked the place, and at some point lit a fire in a corner of one of the two rooms. It's almost dark when you get there. Let's set a scene when you're about make some dinner when you start to hear sounds from all around the cabin...*

RATIONS

In your haven, its Capacity decides if you have enough food and water for everyone. Outside the haven, you must carry what you need. Each person in the group consumes one ration each day, or they starve (page 72).

SAFE SECTORS

If you know a sector well – maybe because you just traveled through it or because your haven has a trade route that runs through it – you don't need to make a Scout roll when you enter. Sectors will not stay safe and well-known forever though. Sooner or later, a swarm will move in, or a group of NPCs might show up to scavenge in the area. The GM decides when this happens.

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CAMPING IN THE WILD

If you use Survival to set up a camp in the wilderness, you create a haven with Capacity 0 and Defense 1. Having Capacity 0 means that there is no food supply in the camp – you must use your rations or find food each day that you stay here. If you fail the roll, Defense is also 0.

NPCs who don't get enough rations will gain a temporary Issue, according to the table on page 149. The GM can use that Issue to create further Challenges for the PCs.

RATIONS FROM THE HAVEN: When you go on a run, each PC and NPC can bring a number of rations equal to the haven's Capacity value multiplied by two. More than that cannot be taken from the haven's food storage without depleting it. If you abandon the haven for good, and have the necessary time to pack up everything, you all get the normal number of rations from the haven, *plus* a number of rations to share equal to the Capacity value multiplied by ten. This depletes the haven and reduces its Capacity to zero.

HUNTING ON THE ROAD

If the GM finds it plausible that there is wild game or fish along the way, you may spend a day to hunt for food. Make a Survival roll. Each Success gives you a die roll of rations. If you fail, you find nothing. You can still move one sector that day.

SCAVENGING

In some sectors, like a city, it is possible to scavenge for food. Roll Survival. A successful roll lets you roll on the Scavenging table (page 151). Each extra success adds one ration. You can only scavenge once per day.

Several people may scavenge at the same time. But if there are many of you, the GM may decide that if any of you fail the roll, you have been loud enough to increase the Threat Level one step. If there are living enemies close by, a failed roll also means you have alerted them.

You can scavenge while moving on foot. If you travel with a vehicle, scavenging will halve the distance you cover that day (rounding up to the next full sector).

LOCATING THINGS AND RESOURCES

When you want to figure out where you can find a certain item – spare parts to a hydraulic pump, for example – you make a Survival roll. If you succeed, the GM will point to a sector on the area map and tell you what can be found there. This represents using your knowledge from pre-apocalyptic times to make an educated guess.

If you fail the roll, the GM will still tell you where the item can be found. But something about the place or what you are looking for is problematic. Perhaps a group of NPCs is hiding there, or has already taken what you need. Now, you must track the opposing group to their haven to get it. The problem is not something the GM will tell you about – you must find out in-game by going to the location. If you roll a walker and mess up, you might lead the group into a death trap.

Only one roll is allowed per item you search for. When the GM states where it can be found, that is its only location.

LOCATING NPCS AND SWARMS: If you want to find things that did not exist before the outbreak – such as an NPC haven or a swarm of walkers – you need to either talk to NPCs you encounter, or search sector by sector. It is not possible to make a Survival roll to find these things.

NPC RUNS

If the NPCs in the haven decide to go on a run without the PCs, the GM rolls on the table below to find out what happens.

D6	RESULT
1	None of the NPCs are heard from again.
2	One or a few NPCs make it back alive, but without finding anything useful.
3	Several NPCs return, and they bring back something valuable.
4	All NPCs return tired, wounded, and scared, but carrying something valuable.
5	All NPCs return, and they bring whatever they went out to get.
6	All NPCs return with whatever they went out to get, and they also found something valuable and unexpected.

IS THAT THING HERE?

At times, the PCs will find themselves at a location where they are likely to find certain items. They might, for example, look for a pair of scissors in a barbershop. The GM can handle this in two ways. The PC can simply find it, or the GM rolls a Lucky die, as described on page 13. The GM can roll on the table Quality of Item to see determine the condition of the item (page 73).

Michael Syrett (Order #8948922)

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

CHAPTER 7

RUNNING THE GAME

They're happy to have a pool table at our new place. Everyone's talking about it. They wager cans of conserved fruit and call whoever is winning the most that week "the pool king." But when I tell them that, with a proper laboratory, I would be able to cure this disease, they're not interested. I'm just the "first aid guy." I amputate legs, arms, and hands, like some kind of medieval barber surgeon. My father always warned me that with a great gift (such as my mind) comes pride, but I still can't help feeling like Gulliver among the Lilliputians. If I were braver, I would burn their pool table to ash and force them to help me; I know this world can be saved.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

As discussed in chapter 1, *The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game* can be played in two ways – campaign mode and survival mode. For an example of a short survival mode scenario, see *The Golden Ambulance* starting on page 136, or the one featured in the Starter Set for the game.

This chapter is dedicated to preparing and running a campaign, and it is primarily addressed to the GM. No secrets will be spoiled if other players read the text, but neither is there need for them to read it.

ATLANTA: The next chapter of this book contains the framework for a campaign set in suburban Atlanta. If you use this setting, most of the preparations are already done for you. You can also use the chapter as mere inspiration for a campaign of your creation.

CORE CONCEPTS

ISSUES

All people, places, and things can have an Issue. It is a short sentence or a word that states what is problematic, risky, or wrong about this item or person. The issues of PCs and NPCs have no effect on the game mechanics. They are meant to help you roleplay NPCs and come up with interesting conflicts and problems.

You may decide what Issues a place or a person has beforehand, or you can wing it at the table. But you should always write down Issues, as you otherwise risk forgetting about them and creating inconsistencies in the story.

CHALLENGES

Challenges are arguably your most important tool as GM – use Challenges to make things happen in the game. When running a campaign, you need a list of Challenges, events that would require some kind of reaction from the PCs. You don't need to force all the Challenges on your list to occur; they are just sources of inspiration that you can draw from.

ENDGAMES

When you start playing a campaign, you might have an idea of how it will end if the PCs fail to handle their Challenges and the situation escalates. Write down this idea. It is called an *endgame*. Just like the Challenge list, it is something that *could* potentially happen, but the story might just as well turn out differently depending on what the PCs do.

Having an endgame helps you decide what NPCs strive for and do. You will have something to "aim at" as you GM.

ENDGAME EXAMPLES

- The Juggernauts defeat all other factions and enslave their members. They start building an underground fortress where their own people live well, while the workers on the surface are exposed to all the risks of life in the apocalypse.
- Having been ousted from the haven earlier in the campaign, the NPC Candace gathers enough support to act against the PCs. One night, she and her comrades sneak into the PCs' sleeping quarters and slit their throats.
- The unrequited love triangle among the leaders of the haven comes to a head when Lucie and Dinesh finally become a couple. Jake can't handle it. He steals a gun and tries to shoot them. Unfortunately, Jake fires his weapon into the midst of the NPC survivors, gravely wounding five people. As the season ends, they are about to bleed to death. The other NPC survivors ask the PCs to punish Jake.

"You talk about the weight of what you have to do, how you can handle it. A bad man, someone truly evil? They're light as a feather. They don't feel a thing."

Michonne

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

CAMPAIGN PREPARATIONS

Before you can start playing a campaign, you need to make some preparations. The steps on the list to the right are explained in detail in the following section. Steps #1 through #4 are done jointly with the players, while steps #5 through #12 are done by you alone as GM.

JOINT PREPARATIONS

1. Decide where the campaign takes place. Get a map.
2. Decide if it is a free play or season play campaign.
3. Create the PCs and add five NPC survivors to the group. Discuss their relationships.
4. Create the PCs' haven.

GM PREPARATIONS

5. Create up to three factions. Give them each a haven and place them on the area map.
6. Assign secret Issues to the NPC survivors and the haven.
7. Choose a couple of NPCs, items, factions, or PCs and write a Challenge list for each of them.
8. Go through the Random Events table and see if there are any entries you want to replace.
9. Create a list of encounters related to the factions.
10. Place some other important locations on the map.
11. Place one to three walker swarms on the map.
12. Create a rumor table.

1. AREA MAP

First, decide where the game will take place. You need a map of this area. Ideally, it should be about 200 kilometers across, divided into 10-kilometer square sectors. An example of such a map, of suburban Atlanta, can be found on page 128. The area map should always be accessible to all players.

As GM you should have your own secret version of the map, where you may mark out places and groups that are still unknown to the players. This is called the GM map.

2. CAMPAIGN TYPE

Next, you should decide on what type of campaign you will play – free play or season play.

FREE PLAY: Free play means playing session after session until something happens that makes it evident that the story has come to an end. This way of playing has a freedom that can be liberating, where dramatic finales and build-ups develop naturally. The drawback is that the game might lose momentum when you don't have a clear end goal in sight.

SEASON PLAY: In season play, each campaign consists of a number of sessions that you decide upon before you start to play – often between six and sixteen. In a season, there is a beginning, a middle, and an end.

At the beginning of the season, you should focus on exploring Issues and presenting Challenges. Don't start with the most dramatic options on the Challenge lists.

The middle game means letting the Challenges grow. If there is something important to reveal, such as a secret military underground complex beneath the PCs' haven, this is when they should learn of it.

When the season reaches the end, everything should focus on one or perhaps two Challenges. Keep the scenes focused, dramatic, and tight. If the players are not leaning over the table in suspense, you haven't hit the right note yet.

STARTING DATE

Decide what time of the year it is and set a date for when the game begins. Even if this is not the correct date in the world – as the PCs have hardly counted the days – it makes it easier to keep track of healing time and projects for the haven.

NEXT SEASON?

Each new season brings the chance for a fresh start. Some players might want to quit participating in the game, so this is a good time to bring in new blood. Even players who stick around may want to change their PC. You could let time pass between seasons: days, months, or even years. Perhaps the next season plays out in another part of the country?

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

Dear Sweet Lord

I know that our faith is being tested. We fail you in so many ways. I can only beg you to remember that we are only human, just as you once were. And I know this is part of a bigger plan that is impossible for us to comprehend. It has meaning; it must have meaning. The only one in our group who knows anything about caring for the sick and wounded was shot in the face yesterday. He did not die, but as far as we can tell he's in a coma. Hannah thinks we should spare him his suffering, but, sweet and tender Lord, you know I am pregnant. What if something goes wrong when the baby comes? I'll keep him safe until then, at least. Maybe you'll wake him up.

3. CHARACTERS & RELATIONSHIPS

Now it's time to create the PCs and NPCs as described in chapter 3. Be sure to note the names of all characters, and give them Issues, relationships, and Anchors. Then you can use these questions to further define relationships, together with the players:

- Who is in love, who is related, who knew each other before the outbreak? Who sleeps in the same tent or room? Who goes hunting together? Which people are rivals?
- Who is making the decisions? Is the process complicated? Who is unsatisfied with how this is done? What bad decisions have been made in the past?
- What are the main conflicts? Note down both major spats and smaller, subtler quarrels such as jealousy.
- Who is dead? What important people have been lost or left the group? What kind of "void" did this leave behind?
- What do you talk about? What does the group fear or dream about?
- Are there any secrets in the group? Who is having an affair? Who is planning to take over?

4. THE HAVEN

Next, let the players choose one of the sample havens in chapter 3 (page 33) or create a haven themselves. Decide where on the area map the haven is located. Use the questions on page 86 to describe the haven, and have the players draw a map of it.

This is the final step of the preparations that the players take part in. The remaining steps are done by you alone as GM.

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TRYING OUT THE GAME

When the joint preparations are done (steps #1 through #4), you can try out the game by playing a session or two. Always start the first scene in the haven, and let the players describe it along with their PCs. Roleplay the NPCs and start figuring out who they are and what they want. Go slowly at first, only introducing a few details at a time.

After the first few scenes, introduce a Challenge. Maybe an NPC tells the PCs that there is not much food left, or they see black smoke on the horizon. When the PCs start making plans for leaving the haven to go on a run, you should stop the session for now and fully complete the GM preparations.

5. NPC FACTIONS

As your first preparation step alone as GM, create one to three NPC factions and place them on the map. A faction can range from a few scavengers hanging around in an abandoned mall to a town with hundreds of survivors.

Two complete example factions can be found later in this chapter, and you can also use the random tables on the following pages to roll up factions.

The tables below may be used to design a faction, or you can use them as inspiration when coming up with something on your own. What needs to be defined is the following:

- **NAME:** What do they call themselves? Do other survivors call them something different?
- **NUMBER:** How many of them are there?
- **TYPE:** Who are they and what holds them together?
- **LEADERSHIP:** How do they make decisions?
- **ASSETS:** What resources do they have?
- **NEEDS:** What do they want? What do they lack?
- **ISSUES:** In what ways are they strange, scary, or problematic?
- **HAVEN:** What is their haven and in which sector is it located?
- **IMPORTANT NPCS:** Create one or two key NPCs in the faction. Give them a name, and Issues. Decide if they are Trained or Expert in any skills and give them some gear.
- **ENDGAME:** What will happen if the PCs don't confront or handle the faction?

Michael Syrett (Order #8848822)

FACTION SIZE

D6	MEMBERS
1	1–5
2	6–10
3	11–15
4	16–20
5	21–50
6	50+

FACTION LEADERSHIP

D6	LEADERSHIP
1	A tyrant controls everything.
2	A small group of people in the faction makes all important decisions.
3	The group is divided between rulers and servants. The rulers decide things together, and the servants do as they are told. This division could be, for example, between those who came to the group first and newcomers, between men and women, between young and old, or between those who have proven themselves in combat and those who are considered weak.
4	Everybody has a say. Perhaps they vote about important decisions, perhaps they fight about it.
5	Total anarchy. No one answers to anybody.
6	A doctrine or a code of conduct is interpreted to decide what is wrong or right. It could be rules the group made up themselves, laws from before the outbreak, religious beliefs, or thoughts and ideas from a mad soothsayer.

FACTION NEEDS

D6	NEEDS
1	Other survivors. Either to join the group, to eat, to torment, or to use as forced labor.
2	Control over its territory.
3	Protection. It could be to find a better haven, to defend their haven from intruders, to find more weapons, or to kill an opponent they fear.
4	Hope. The faction is about to fall apart from hopelessness and turmoil. They need to find something that makes them believe in a future again.
5	Food resources or trade routes. It could be a starving faction or people who have plenty and want to grow to become an even bigger group.
6	Gear. It could be cars, gasoline, weapons and ammunition, or anything they could steal or find to defend their haven.

FACTION TYPE

D6	TYPE
1	Chaotic murderers. Only the strong survive.
2	Well-structured and functional society. Things work according to pre-decided rules and routines. Nothing is left to chance.
3	A group that existed before the outbreak, perhaps a family, a group of police officers, or scientists. In many ways, they act like the world is just the same as it was before.
4	A cult following a leader. It could be a religious group or just people devoted to a strange or unique idea.
5	Outcasts forced together because nobody else wanted them, either in the society before the outbreak or in the world after. They could be a group of asylum runaways, prisoners, homeless people, or people who are just plain unlikable.
6	People who are trying to build a new world. They could be scientists who try to cure the walker disease, or a group who wants to make sure as many human babies as possible are born and protected.

FACTION ASSETS

D6	ASSET
1	Cars and gasoline.
2	Weapons and ammunition.
3	Food.
4	Medical equipment.
5	Gear such as a radio transmitter, night vision googles, a helicopter, or a tank.
6	Technology from the pre-outbreak world, for example a generator, hot water, functional hi-tech defense system, radar device, or functional communication with other groups.

FACTION ISSUES

D66	ISSUE
11	Keeps walkers around, either for sentimental reasons or as protection.
12	Sickness among them.
13	Treats other survivors with brutality.
14	Knows how to walk among the dead and control them.
15	Divided by a brutal conflict.
16	Mourns their true leader.

Michael Syrett (Order #53453222)

"The world that we knew is dead. And this new world is ugly. It's harsh. It's survival of the fittest. And that's a world I don't wanna live in."

Dale Horvath

D66	ISSUE
21	A dark secret everyone pretends to not know about.
22	Someone in the group is the victim of the others' aggression, whether it be verbal or physical.
23	The world will be ours.
24	Will do anything to stop the walker disease.
25	Ruled by an increasingly mad leader.
26	Those who find the food get to eat it.
31	Wild parties.
32	Traumatized by a swarm attack that killed half the group.
33	Has left the old world's morals and laws behind.
34	Complicated romantic relationships.
35	Suicidal.
36	Brutality earns respect.
41	Has misunderstood something important in the world of the dead.
42	Several fragile members that must be protected.
43	Masquerades as something they are not.
44	Weak, scared, and desperate.
45	Provide a meeting place for other survivors.
46	The weak ones are treated as cattle.
51	Isolated and obsessed with a cultural expression or phenomena.
52	Wants to destroy the world completely, to be reborn into paradise.
53	Uses fire as a weapon.
54	Stealthy thieves and killers.
55	Claim they own this land.
56	Well-trained and well-armed.
61	Eats their prisoners.
62	Adolescents and children.
63	Addicts.
64	Sworn allegiance to each other and live by a code of honor.
65	Skilled experts among them.
66	Knows about a distant place where they will be safe, but needs help to get there.

FACTION HAVENS

Each faction has a haven, which needs to be described with a couple of sentences and a simple map. If you want, you can give it some Issues.

D6	HAVEN
1	Well-defended bunker.
2	Simple shelter/bus/stranded boat along the road.
3	Barricaded house in an area where there are plenty of walkers.
4	Isolated farm or cabin far away from other buildings.
5	A large ruin, or system of caves.
6	A village or structure built or secured by the faction.

HAVEN CHARACTERISTICS

Roll a D6 twice to set the characteristics of the NPC haven (see Chapter 6, page 86). Capacity starts at the level it takes to sustain the faction size and gets modified by the table result. Defense is set by rolling on this table.

D6	CAPACITY	DEFENSE
1	–1 (starving)	1
2	—	2
3	—	3
4	—	3
5	—	4
6	+1	5

STRANGER FACTIONS

As time goes by, people who survive in the world of the dead change and adjust to their new conditions. They could, for instance, begin to co-exist with the dead or worship creepy gods. But even stranger factions could exist, though they should not be used in the first season you play, but rather one or two seasons into the game. This way, the PCs will meet "normal" factions at the start of the game and, with time, encounter stranger people as the world changes.

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FACTION EXAMPLE: THE BLACK HEARTS

The Black Hearts is a group of 30 people who were freegans and punk rockers before the outbreak. They live together as a family in a condemned brick building. Since the outbreak, many have died. Half of the current inhabitants are survivors they have taken in. They make a clear difference between "the Group," who are the original members, and "the Newcomers."

Newcomers are not welcome in the council where all decisions are made and they get the worst and most dangerous jobs, and seldom enough to eat. There are several among the Group who think this is against everything the collective stands for, but they are a minority so far.

Unfortunately, the Black Hearts have lost all hope. Every day, the injustices against the Newcomers grow worse. There is also a streak of suicidal behavior, which has cost several lives. Some in the Group think they should set the building on fire with everyone in it, but the idea has not been passed in the council. The hopelessness also shows itself as antipathy towards other groups they meet and recklessness when they scavenge for food. There are still a few among them who think it is possible to save the Black Hearts, but they need help from the outside.

ISSUES

- About to implode
- Violent internal conflicts
- Hopelessness
- Knowledge of survival

HAVEN

The haven is a five-story brick building. Just before the outbreak, the Black Hearts prepared themselves and the house for a coming attack from the police, as the building was supposed to be torn down. The doors and windows on the bottom floor are still blocked, and there are many smart traps, getaways, and portholes all throughout the building so they can safely fire on anyone who manages to get in. In the basement there are five cars, an RV, and a lot of gasoline that was meant to be used to burn down the house if they failed to protect it against "government agents."

- **CAPACITY: 3** (lots of canned goods, many places to scavenge nearby, and water collectors and greenhouses on the roof)
- **DEFENSE: 3** (blocked doors and windows, escape routes to other buildings so that one can go around and hit attackers in the back, Molotov cocktails, traps, and portholes)

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KEY NPCS

- **MICHELLE TURNER:** Unofficial leader, brutal and manipulative.
- **JAY GRAFFIN:** Teacher for the kids and one of the few with hope for the future. He is stubborn and brave.

CHALLENGES

- People from the Black Hearts scavenge in the same place as the PCs and try to take whatever the PCs find.
- The PCs find one of the "Newcomers" from the Black Hearts who has escaped. She begs them to save her kid sister who is still living there.
- The PCs watch from a distance when the Black Hearts find another group of survivors. Instead of helping the unnamed group, the Black Hearts execute all of them.

ENDGAME

The Black Hearts start a violent conflict with the PCs, with a heavy advantage on the side of the aggressors. But suddenly they change their minds and ask for a peace treaty. They even invite the PCs into their enclave and put down their guns. But while the PCs are inside, the doors are blocked and one of the council members puts a flame to the gasoline stash in the basement.

FACTION EXAMPLE: SUGAR HILL

Sugar Hill is a large community with over a hundred survivors who gathered around an old city hall to build a new society. This was one of the few places where soldiers managed to raise walls as protection against walkers during the outbreak.

Everything they do is about preserving energy and resources and not taking risks. They live by the pre-outbreak laws they teach the kids in the school, and they prepare themselves to take part in the inevitable rebuilding of the country.

The community includes a doctor's clinic with a lot of equipment, two doctors and three nurses. But the community lacks food. Several people have already starved to death and most who live here look like skeletons. Half of the people can hardly get out of bed. Still, nobody wants to take the risk of leaving Sugar Hill to try to find food, because almost everyone believes they will be saved any day now. What if they die just as the rescue teams arrive?

ISSUES

- Starvation
- Aggressive towards newcomers
- Won't believe the truth

HAVEN

The walls around the community are tall and strong, and there are people with guns watching them. They have a few working flamethrowers that they use if too many walkers accumulate outside, or if intruders are trying to get in. There is a large gate, which is further reinforced by a truck parked inside. The only way to get in or out is to climb the walls. At one point along the wall, there is a rope that some of the guards use to get in and out when they go on runs.

- **CAPACITY: 2** (an emergency supply of canned goods, a few small fields, and water collectors)
- **DEFENSE: 4** (sturdy walls, blocked gate, flamethrowers, lookout towers, trained ex-soldiers)

KEY NPCS

- **SANDY DEBRA GALOVSKI:** Community priest and the leader who is most certain help will come soon.
- **JENNIE HEIGHTS:** Ex-soldier desperate to get the others to understand that there won't be any rescue teams coming.

CHALLENGES

- Jennie Heights runs away and finds the PCs. She tells them that Sugar Hill would be the perfect place to move, if only the food shortage could be solved. But most in Sugar Hill do not want help from small groups; they are only prepared to welcome their mythical saviors.
- A plague hits Sugar Hill and one of its doctors leaves the community to find medicine. The PCs encounter the unarmed doctor cornered by two walkers.
- People at Sugar Hill decide to "help" the supposed rescue teams find them. They set fire to a house, so that the smoke can be seen from afar, which sets off a latent alarm system. This attracts both other NPCs and a walker swarm that starts to move towards Sugar Hill. On its way, it will pass the PCs' haven.

ENDGAME

The people of Sugar Hill keep claiming that a rescue team will come, even if the PCs try to save them from themselves. In the end, the leaders of Sugar Hill were seemingly right. A team of soldiers and tanks arrives, and the blockaded gate is finally opened while community members cheer and wave flags. But the soldiers plunder Sugar Hill, kill everyone, and make it their new base.

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6. SECRET ISSUES

Look through the Issues for the NPC survivors who live with the PCs, and the Issues for the haven. If you can see enough potential Challenges as it is, you don't need to do anything. But if you want, you can add one or two secret Issues. These are Issues the PCs do not know about yet.

Don't give secret Issues to more than one or two NPC survivors. If too many of them have secrets, the PCs could become paranoid and start purging the NPC survivors.

SECRET NPC ISSUE EXAMPLES

- Has a suicide pact with another NPC.
- Is madly obsessed with one of the PCs and believes the love is mutual.
- A charismatic murderer, even before the outbreak.
- Hides their three children in the forest, to protect them.
- Steals food and blames others.
- Gets violent when threatened or ridiculed.
- Lies about their past and what they know about the outbreak.
- Will do anything to become the leader.
- Got separated from their original group and wants to find them again. That group is made up of thirty armed scavengers who will try to plunder the PCs' haven.
- Puts the blame on themselves for something bad that happened.
- Drug addict.
- Thinks it would be easier to survive if the group were smaller, and wants to do something about it.

SECRET HAVEN ISSUE EXAMPLES

- An unforeseen way in, past the defenses.
- Contaminated food.
- The lock on the front door is in bad shape.
- A swarm of walkers in the basement.
- Another group thinks this is their place.
- Floods when it rains.

7. CHALLENGE LISTS

Now, it's time to have a look at the Issues you have established and write lists of Challenges that the Issues can trigger. You can make a Challenges list for almost anything in the game, such as the PCs' haven, a hostile faction, an unreliable car engine, or the PCs themselves.

When you create a Challenge list, write down the ways you can imagine this person, group, or thing becoming problematic for the PCs or the area at large. Mix minor and major things. Start with ideas for events that are likely, then mix in some really unlikely stuff for surprise or if the PCs hit a lucky streak. Scratch out the ones that don't seem to be any fun. Be as concrete as possible. Who will this person attack, what will they steal, and how will they sabotage the generator? Each point shouldn't be longer than a sentence or two; keep it simple.

Some Challenge lists, such as for a car with a bad engine, will only have one bullet point on its list: the engine breaks down. Challenges may be things that seem simple to capitalize on, like when an NPC has found a cellar full of canned goods. Then you should layer on the difficulty – what else is in the cellar?

Don't write Challenge lists for everything that exists in your game. Instead, choose a limited collection of NPCs, items, and PCs to focus on. Choose the ones you think will be the most fun and easy to come up with Challenges for. As the campaign goes on, you will have time to write more Challenge lists if things are going too smoothly.

DON'T PLAN SOLUTIONS: It is your job to come up with Challenges. It is the players' and the PCs' job to try to resolve them. Avoid considering solutions when you come up with or activate a Challenge. If you do, there is a risk that you will force the PCs to try to solve the Challenge the way you planned. That would make the game less fun.

8. RANDOM EVENTS

You can activate a Challenge even if it is not on one of your Challenge lists. One way to do this is to roll on the Random Events table on page 111. This means that something dramatic happens that is not directly caused by the NPC survivors or another faction.

Before play, it's a good idea to look through the table and see if there are any entries you want to replace to make it fit the campaign. If, for example, the campaign is set in Alaska, you might want to include an encounter with a pack of polar bears.

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CHALLENGE LIST EXAMPLES

An NPC named Sarah with the Issue *easily insulted*:

- Sarah feels mistreated and starts an argument with Cecilia or Bill. Maybe about food rationing?
- Sarah spreads rumors about someone being a cannibal. Probably Steven.
- Sarah tries to get the others to change leadership in the group. She says she wants a democracy... but what Sarah really wants is to decide things herself.
- Sarah plans to leave the group with a whole car filled with canned goods and weapons. She asks John to come with her.
- Sarah blames something on Omar, perhaps not protecting Mona enough on the last raid?

Haven with the secret Issue *hidden entrance*:

- A walker lurks in and attacks someone.
- A man named Phil sneaks in and manages to open the weapon locker, stealing two rifles. He has a camp in the woods with a tent, some canned goods, and an injured girlfriend named Marie.
- One of the kids gets angry at his parents, takes a gun, and sneaks out to show them that he too can kill walkers.
- Mark and Danny sneak out to snuggle in the forest but get attacked. Mark is killed while Danny manages to flee, but he gets lost among the trees.

Faction with the Issue *wants to rule the world*:

- Attacks and burns down the scientists' camp.
- Comes with an envoy to the PCs' haven to propose that the two groups should become one... but it is just an attempt to get inside the haven and take it over.
- Kidnaps someone to get information about the PCs' haven. Will propose an exchange where the PCs trade the kidnapped NPC for guns... but the NPC is already dead.
- Sends radio transmissions promising people freedom and safety in their haven.

PC with the Issue *alcoholic*:

- Finds lots of liquor that no one else has seen, yet.
- Has things together at the haven, but feels the thirst, badly, when they're out on a run.
- Someone offers a drink. Surely they have more hidden somewhere they're not telling me...
- Learns about a bar downtown. It is crawling with walkers.

9. FACTION ENCOUNTERS

When the PCs go on runs outside the haven, they may encounter anything from other survivors to wild animals. What they meet is determined by rolling for an encounter, as described on page 114.

If you roll 5 or 6 on the Encounter Type table (page 114), the PCs meet one or several people from one of the local factions. You can wing this in game or create a Faction Encounter table as part of your preparations. Think of interesting interactions that could happen if the PCs and members of one of the factions accidentally bump into each other.

FACTION ENCOUNTERS EXAMPLE

D6	ENCOUNTER
1	The PCs meet D6 of the people from Joey's Farm. They are burying a comrade. Some of them are drunk and angry.
2	The PCs encounter D6 members of the Hell Raiders. They have hidden their motorcycles off the road and are prowling for someone to rob and humiliate.
3	One of the Rat Boys is caught scavenging for food near the haven. He might try to fool the PCs into believing that he is factionless and afraid, to make them take him in. In his left boot he hides a stiletto.
4	A flare lights up the sky, fired by a scientist in trouble. They are standing on the roof of a bus surrounded by walkers. If the PCs save them, they will invite them into a secret compound.
5	Joey is drunk and lost. He is sitting in a bar with his sawed-off in front of him and a drink in his hand. He is angry at the world, but he won't attack unless he needs to. A group of his people are out looking for him.
6	An NPC has managed to escape the Hell Raiders camp. They are in bad shape and must get clothes and food before they're willing to speak about the atrocities they have witnessed.

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10. OTHER LOCATIONS

Next, you should invent a few other locations of interest, not connected to any faction, and place them on the map. Such locations could include walkers or NPC survivors, but they may also be empty. Locations are good for adding goals and possibilities to the game.

Examples include a hospital with functional equipment, a helicopter pad with a helicopter that just needs one spare part to lift off, a supermarket that has somehow not been plundered already, and a hilltop that for some reason is crawling with walkers. Place two or three locations on different sectors on the map. Name them and write a sentence or two about each.

Some locations are bait, places that seem too good to be true. And they are. Place an empty warehouse full of equipment on the map and hide a swarm of walkers in the basement. Let a couple of bandits use a source of fresh water to attract and plunder other survivors.

In the appendix, you will find a Random Locations table (page 144). It can be used to generate locations while planning the campaign, or during a session when the PCs enter a new sector.

LOCATION EXAMPLES

- **HARBOR:** There are many walkers around, but the boats are still functional and several of them are stocked with rations and equipment. An island can be seen in the distance. It could have been the perfect haven, but a large group of survivors died there a couple of months ago; now they mill around inside one of the bigger houses in the middle of the island, and that house cannot be seen from the docks. If the PCs make sounds on the island, the swarm will come streaming towards them.
- **RADIO STATION:** There is a generator and fuel in the basement, enough to keep the lights on for another year at least. It's possible to broadcast messages or get in contact with other enclaves around the world through the radio. But the building's current defenses are terrible, and the generator cannot be moved elsewhere.
- **ORCHARD:** Filled with fruit trees but also walkers. A mother and her daughter hide in a nearby house and sometimes risk going into the orchard to pick apples, pears, nectarines, grapes, and plums. There is a hidden bunker with canned food below the house, which the mother and daughter have not found yet.
- **FOREST:** Inhabited by former farm animals now living in the wild. There are cows, horses, pigs, sheep and even some goats – all in all, about fifty animals. They're in constant danger of being attacked by natural predators. A big fence around the forest keeps walkers out, but it is only a matter of time before they break through.
- **BRIDGE:** Everyone who passes through this area needs to use the bridge. Four young boys with a sniper rifle guard it and demand tribute from anyone who wants to use it.
- **HOSPITAL:** Still holds plenty of medical equipment, but it's full of walkers.
- **RACETRACK:** Plenty of tools and spare parts, and a few fast cars in good working order.

11. SWARMS

Look at the map and decide if there are sectors that ought to be filled with walkers. Place a swarm there and decide how big it is, from Swarm Size 4 to 6. Swarms are often placed in city sectors. In game, a swarm may move around by one sector every other day. Let the dice decide in what direction it heads by using the table below.

D6	SWARM DIRECTION
1	North
2	East
3	South
4	West
5–6	Stays in the sector

12. RUMORS

When the PCs encounter other survivors, they might hear rumors. This is a perfect opportunity to let the PCs know about undiscovered factions and locations. Write a rumor table with six entries. When the PCs meet a new survivor, roll a die to see what rumor the NPC relates.

Rumors could be half-true, but they are never completely false. If an NPC says that there is an abandoned boat at the harbor, the NPC believes there is a boat. But the actual boat may have been destroyed since the NPC last saw it, or it is now occupied by a group of armed teenagers.

RUMOR TABLE EXAMPLE

D6	RUMOR
1	"There is still a group of soldiers at Fort Brooks. I heard they're in contact with Washington, and there are helicopters coming and going weekly. We were on our way there, but the road was blocked with hundreds of walkers."

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D6	RUMOR
2	"There is a guy called Max who rides around with his brother in a red sports car. He has some kind of chemical he can inject to make the walkers think that you are one of them. He sells it for food and guns."
3	"A guy from my old group told me that, when they had a functional radio transmitter, they kept picking up messages from a radio station in Delaware."
4	"I saw it with my own eyes. A man dressed in white was controlling the dead. He made them attack a family who was hiding in a pickup-truck. It was just a mile north of here."
5	"I know where you can find guns, big guns – cannons and heavy machine guns. There's an army truck filled with weapons, just sitting on the side of the road north of here."
6	"Someone was clearly trying to make a home at my old school. The football field had been transformed into a cornfield, and there were things built on the roof to collect water. But there was not a living soul around."

BETWEEN SESSION PREPARATIONS

Between sessions, you should add more content to your preparations, especially in between the first sessions of the campaign. Do not try to prepare for everything that can happen in game, as you risk being swamped by the workload. Prep time should be fun. These are things you might do:

- Erase dead NPCs and obsolete Challenges.
- Write more Challenge lists.
- Draw maps of important locations.
- Create new locations if needed.
- Create new factions if needed.
- Update the rumor table, the event table, and the encounter tables.

CHANGING FACTIONS

When time passes in the campaign, you might want to see if any of the factions have changed – independently of what the PCs do. You can roll on the Faction Change table below once for each faction. Interpret the result in a way that fits the faction and try to come up with ideas on how the factions are interacting with each other. A small gain could, for example, mean that a faction has started a trade route with another faction – or it plundered one of them and took some of their weapons.

FACTIONS CHANGE

D6	FACTION CHANGE
1	Dramatic loss
2	Small setback
3	Nothing changed
4	Nothing changed
5	Small gain
6	Significant gain

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SESSIONS & SCENES

The rest of this chapter provides tools and guidelines for running the game at the table. This section discusses how to handle the basic building blocks of the story: sessions and scenes.

A session is divided into scenes. Most often, the narrative goes on with seamless cuts between one scene and the next. Sessions are typically two to five hours long. If you plan to play longer, you can take a break in the middle, give everyone XP and start a new session.

THE FIRST SESSION

Before the first session, you could look through your preparations and select one or two Challenges that you find interesting.

Start the first session with a scene in the haven. Let the PCs talk to each other and to the NPCs. Ask the players what is going on right now in the group. Set a couple of scenes where the players get to describe their PCs and the haven.

Then set a scene where you introduce the first Challenge. Let the PCs react to it. If there is time, introduce another Challenge or let one of the NPC survivors tell them a rumor. Let them react to that. End the session when you feel done for the evening, especially before the PCs head outside on their first supply run.

GM: *Okay folks, it's time to start playing the first session. We agreed to do a season play campaign with only six sessions, to try out the game. We have already decided that your initial haven is a bus parked on a hill from which you can see most of the surroundings, but it is also possible to see the bus from a distance. I guess it is late August. Perhaps the 26th of August? It is still kind of hot, but it has started to rain a lot and there's mud everywhere. This evening, the sky is clear. You can see the stars above you like a shimmering field of diamonds, with a small crescent moon. What is the group doing on an evening like this?*

Hannah (player 1): *I think we've been lucky today and shot a pig that was unexpectedly well-fed. We're all sitting around a campfire, with pieces of pork on sticks that we grill over the flames. Everyone is talking and laughing a little more than usual; we've been without proper food for some time.*

David (player 4): *I am not sitting with you. I'm on the roof of the bus with my binoculars and my rifle. I've had a bad feeling that something is out there, for a few days now. I've asked the others to keep quiet at night, but nobody listens. Something tells me there are walkers around.*

GM: *The Threat Level is still 0, but that only means you haven't actually seen any of them. It could change quickly.*

Imani (player 3): *I am sitting close to Rebecca, stroking her hair, trying to do it so that Hannah won't see. I do not want to make her jealous and turn this night into an argument session.*

GM: *Rebecca leans in close to you, Imani. She whispers to you. "You know, I was a vegetarian before all this. And I never would've guessed pork tasted so good. Who shot it?"*

Hannah: *I lean forward. "I did." And then I stare at her, and then at Imani. I haven't failed to notice what you two are up to, but I've been hiding my feelings.*

EMBRACE THE INSECURITY

When you start a new campaign, the first scenes will be awkward, slow, and often a little clumsy. It takes time to "find" the PCs and the NPCs and their interactions. The story needs space and time to develop. Don't fear the insecurity; it's not the time to immediately throw Challenges at the PCs to make something happen. If you stand back, the players will start looking for interesting interactions and things to do. Then you can introduce Challenges, one by one. Give them space and time to react in between each Challenge.

ENDING THE SESSION

At the end of each session, you should:

- Ask questions for XP (page 28).
- Check if any of the PCs need to roll for handling their fear (page 26).
- Ask if anyone wants to do a Dearly Departed Monologue at the start of the next session (page 28).

It is also a good idea to spend a few minutes debriefing the session.

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STARTING THE NEXT SESSION

If the players want to hold Dearly Departed Monologues, you start every new session with that. Then you set the first scene. It could be something that happens seconds after the previous session. But it could also be a scene that takes place minutes, hours, or even days after the events of the last session.

If you have had a long break between sessions in real life, it is often good to make a time jump of a couple days or weeks – or even months – pass in the game. This makes it easier to start up again when the memory of what occurred is a little vague.

"If you don't protect what belongs to you, then sooner or later, it belongs to someone else."

Negan

SETTING SCENES

A scene is a specific when and where. It is your job to set scenes. This means stating the when and where and saying something about the environment or the situation that helps the players imagine what it looks and feels like. You can always ask the players for help when setting a scene, and you may let them set scenes as well.

When you are playing a scene, you should talk in character for NPCs, make thick descriptions of important details, and use the mechanics to decide what happens. If you feel that something is not interesting enough to play out, you should summarize it and move on to the next scene.

GM: *Last session we ended play with Malcolm's weird speech among the apple trees. Does anyone have an idea for a good starting scene for today?*

Valeria (player 2): *I want to talk to Hannah, in private.*

GM: *Okay, so it is the next day, early in the morning. It's really cold with a thick fog. Several members of the group have had nightmares, some even screamed in their sleep. Everyone is a little off balance. Where does she find you, Hannah?*

Hannah (player 1): *Uhm... I am probably in the weapons storage counting bullets. And I am not happy about the numbers.*

Valeria: *I open the door slowly. "Hannah, is that you?"*

Valeria (player 2): *If you don't do it, I will. I don't care about the consequences. Malcolm has to go.*

Hannah (player 1): *I snort and turn my back on her, returning to the bullet count. I just wait for her to leave.*

Valeria: *I stand there for a while, not sure if I should laugh at how pathetic she is or yell at her. In the end, I think I'm still too scared of her to do anything. I leave.*

GM (starts a new scene): *Just as you are about to walk away, both of you hear a loud explosion, really close by. The entire house is shaking, and the bullets on the desk in front of you, Hannah, are thrown up in the air and rain down on the floor. Valeria, you fall to your knees. It smells heavily of smoke. What do you do?*

ENDING SCENES

End the scene when it feels finished, when there is nothing else important that needs to be said or done. You could either say, "Can we cut here?" or simply go to the next scene. Or you can change scenes by letting something happen that creates a new situation, without changing the when and where.

FLASHBACK SCENES

Both you and the players may initiate scenes that took place before the campaign began, perhaps even before the outbreak. This is a good way to get to know the PCs. Most flashback scenes try to explain how the PC got a certain Issue or a specific relationship to another person. For example, it could be a scene where we get to see the moment when one of the PCs fell in love with his best friend's wife – who is now one of the other PCs in the group.

One way to handle flashback scenes is, once every session, to let one player set a flashback scene for their PC. As the players take turns, all of them will get a chance to set a scene over time. If you don't use dearly departed monologues, the PCs could get extra XP for this instead.

In flashback scenes, the players whose PCs are not in it may play NPCs. This way, everyone gets to participate. Do not play more than one flashback scene per session. Too many flashback scenes would slow down the tempo of the campaign.

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CHALLENGES

The players have their PCs to push the story along – your main tool as the GM is to activate Challenges. Challenges can come from the following sources:

- Your Challenge lists
- Needs in the haven
- The Random Events table on page 111

Challenges can also arise from the PCs' own actions or as the result of the game mechanics – the points above list what you as GM can actively do to breathe life into the story and create suspense, conflict, or danger.

ACTIVATING A CHALLENGE

When activating a Challenge, you could set a scene where the PCs learn of it. Or simply decide that it happens – but the PCs have not noticed it yet. Now, this Challenge becomes a very real and immediate part of the story; you cannot take it back.

Hannah (player 1): *The first thing I do when we get back is talk to Richard and ask him what he knows about the Faceless.*

GM: *Well, you can't find him.*

Hannah: *I go ask the others.*

The Gamemaster: *They are all sitting in the atrium, on blankets and pillows on the floor, and you get an awkward feeling as soon as you enter. They all stop talking, and they seem to not want to look you in the eyes.*

Hannah: *"Where is Richard? I really need some information from him."*

GM: *Sarah stands up and stares at you while clenching her fists. "He had to go. He isn't one of us."*

EXAMPLES OF ACTIVATING A CHALLENGE

- Smoke on the horizon.
- A stranger bangs at the door and wants you to let him in.
- Michael comes into your room at night when everyone else is sleeping. He tells you that he will cut you up if you ever embarrass him again.
- One of the axes is missing. No one admits to taking it.
- Sandra scratches herself all over while she talks to you, and what she's saying doesn't make any sense.
- When you turn the car key, a bang is heard from the engine, and it smells like something is burning. It won't start.
- Ronda has been talking to herself in the corn field all day, and she refuses to come in when you call her.
- Roy says he can't go hunting, because there are no bullets in the weapon storage.

MULTIPLE CHALLENGES

You should eventually have several Challenges active at the same time. If one Challenge is the PCs' immediate focus, others can grow in the background. When the PCs resolve a Challenge or when the tempo of the game slows down, activate a new Challenge or ramp up one of the Challenges that have been lingering in the background.

Try to activate different kinds of Challenges. You could, for example, have a violent faction threatening the PCs, a dangerous love affair in the haven, and a disease outbreak going on all at the same time.

PLAYERS CREATING CHALLENGES

When the campaign gets going, players will often start activating Challenges of their own. They could, for example, start a fight with an NPC survivor at the haven, try to eradicate a hostile faction, or look for equipment to build a heating system for the winter. When this happens, you don't need to activate your own Challenges. Sit back and see to it that all PCs have something to do.

ANCHORS AS CHALLENGES

Never let an NPC Anchor become problematic for the PC who has set them as their Anchor. An Anchor should be someone to rely on... but you may turn the Anchor into a Challenge for one of the other PCs. That makes for interesting conflicts!

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ESCALATING A CHALLENGE

Challenges escalate. This means that they grow in intensity and scale over time, if the PCs don't prioritize handling them. The fire spreads. The discontent grows. The odd kid who violently experiments on kittens starts looking for something bigger.

Let Challenges grow between sessions. Give some hints about what is happening in the background of scenes. Perhaps the Characters walk past a mutilated animal out on the yard? When the Challenge has grown too big to ignore, let it explode in their faces.

Examples of escalating Challenges:

- A revolting NPC survivor convinces another NPC to help them.
- The sickness in the haven infects another NPC.
- A group of NPCs who know about the haven, and want to plunder it, find a way in.
- The despotic ruler of a hostile faction plans to lead walkers into the PCs' haven, and then bombard it with Molotov cocktails.

NEEDS AS CHALLENGES

A need means that the haven or the PCs lack something they must have to survive. When you use a need as a Challenge, you may roll on the Needs table below or just use what seems most plausible for the story. If the PCs have fired their guns a lot, they have probably run out of bullets.

There is no system for tracking ammunition and gasoline. But in limited contexts, like when the PCs are stuck in one location while out on a run, it could be interesting to decide the exact limits of a resource. Roll a die and let the result be the number of bullets a PC has left or the number of sectors they can drive before they run out of gas.

If a need applies to the whole haven, pick either its Capacity or Defense and reduce it by one step until the need is handled. You may also create Issues about the need.

NEEDS

D6	NEEDS
1	Food
2	Water
3	Medicine
4	Tools and equipment
5	Weapons and bullets
6	Consumables (gasoline, warm clothes, sanitary pads, diapers, building material, spare parts, crops, livestock, etc.).

RANDOM EVENTS

If you want to quickly create a Challenge that is not related to any established Issues or needs, you can simply roll on the table below.

D66	EVENT
11	A disease spreads in the haven, Virulence 7.
12	Someone in the group is pregnant.
13	A child or teenager is lost. Roll a die to see what happened to them. **1–2:** Eaten by a walker. **3–4:** Kidnapped. **5:** Ran off. **6:** Lost but safe.
14	Someone tries to commit suicide.
15	A walker swarm is approaching the haven. Roll a double high to determine its size.
16	A fire that will burn down the haven, if not handled.
21	A walker has somehow found a way into the haven.
22	Someone in the group has a religious awakening – or a delusional obsession.
23	Someone in the group finds a note which urges survivors to gather at a certain place to build a new society.
24	A naked unconscious man is found close to the haven. He is a thief and a notorious liar who was punished by his former group for stealing.
25	Someone in the group comes back from the wilderness bitten by an animal. Or so they claim... but the teeth marks could be human.
26	An earthquake/tornado/snowstorm/wildfire threatens the haven.
31	A pack of wild dogs (or wolves, or other predators) with a taste for human flesh settles down close by.
32	A walker swarm approaches, roll a double-low to determine its size.
33	A helicopter flies by, comes back, then hovers above the haven for a moment before flying away again.
34	The haven's water source is accidentally polluted. Everyone who drinks it gets sick, Toxicity value 6.
35	Someone in the group breaks a leg or an arm in an accident. The person either needs medical aid that cannot be found in the haven or is stuck somewhere out in the wilderness and cannot make it back to the haven.
36	A solar eclipse. An unknown group of survivors surround and move towards the haven in the darkness.

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D66	EVENT
41	A walker swarm approaches, roll a die to determine its size.
42	Someone in the group finds a liquor store that has not been plundered.
43	A hungry dog walks into the haven and tries to make the humans adopt it. It has run off from another group of survivors, who are looking for it.
44	Someone in the group gets addicted to alcohol, drugs, or something else.
45	Someone in the group falls desperately in love with the wrong person.
46	Someone in the group starts hating someone.
51	An important item is missing. Roll D6 to see who has taken it. **1–2:** An NPC Survivor. **3–4:** Someone from another faction. **5–6:** A lone Survivor who is hiding close by.
52	Farm animals, perhaps pigs or sheep, are found close by. If they are taken into the haven, they will start spreading a disease with Virulence 8.
53	An undetonated bomb or landmine is found close by the haven, probably dropped here during the outbreak's start. It can detonate at any time, and, when it does, it will attract a walker swarm. Roll a double-high to determine its size.
54	A dozen fresh graves are found among the trees. The PCs can hear moaning from the ground. Walkers are trying to claw their way to the surface.
55	A walker is spotted wearing a bulletproof vest, an automatic carbine, and a whole bag full of ammunition. Snipers hide on a ridge, watching to see if anyone will take the bait.
56	Someone in the haven is contacted by a person from another faction.
61	A firefight between different groups of strangers starts close to the haven.
62	A Ferris wheel. In one of the top cars are blankets, food, and water, as if someone is using it as a temporary base. Among the blankets there is a pretty accurate drawing of the PCs' haven with weak spots marked out.
63	A crying baby.
64	An old propeller plane towing a banner: "Sommerville is safe."
65	Something vital in the haven breaks without anyone noticing it. It could be the watering system for the crops, something about the security system, one of the guns, or a car. Perhaps it is sabotage?
66	A randomly-decided NPC cuts themselves badly and gets sepsis. Within hours they develop a high fever, and they will get worse if they do not get the right antibiotics. Roll a double low to see how many days they last before they die.

TRAVEL

This section gives you guidelines on how to handle travel and encounters. A key tool for managing runs is your secret GM area map. You should number each sector so that you can note where you place locations, walker swarms, and factions.

DESCRIBING A SECTOR

When the PCs move into a new sector, it is up to you to describe what it looks like. If they just pass through, perhaps driving through it in a car at great speed, your description may be brief. But if they go by foot or search the sector you should set a scene somewhere in the sector. The tables Ruins and Wilderness on pages 113 and 114 can be used as inspiration, the former referring to areas where humans once lived and worked – from rural communities to big cities. If you like, use the Weather table on the next page as well.

SECTORS ARE BIG: Each sector is ten by ten kilometers big. That's a lot of ground to cover. Two groups could live in different parts of a sector and never meet. When you set a scene in a sector, it is just one of many places we get to see in the game. This means you do not have to remember everything about all sectors. The next time the PCs come through, they happen to visit a different part of the sector, or changes to the original exploration site could have occurred due to other forces.

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WEATHER

D6	WEATHER
1	Rain/snow/fog
2	Cloudy
3	Colder than usual
4	Warmer than usual
5	Clear and sunny
6	Windy (roll again, another 6 means that it is a storm or extreme heat or cold).

RUINS

D66	DESCRIPTION
11	An abandoned haven with a flag hanging from the roof. For some reason, most of the walkers inside are wearing pink jumpsuits.
12	A sewage plant. Those who worked here have killed themselves in one of the towers.
13	A school. Soldiers once tried to make a stand here.
14	An overrun caravan of black limousines. Walkers with black sunglasses, earbuds, and hidden shoulder holsters. Someone who used to be famous or rich is hiding close by.
15	Residential area. The swimming pools are like traps for the walkers who fall in but can't get out.
16	An empty church. The inside walls are covered by spray painted words about God abandoning us.
21	A library. Mostly intact. The books about survival and farming are on the second floor.
22	An overgrown park with a huge playground. A pack of wild dogs hunts here.
23	A battle tank. It functions but has no ammunition. A walker is inside.
24	A county fair. Apparently, several of the guests had their faces painted as clowns, kittens, or superheroes on the day of the outbreak.
25	Highrise buildings. The top floors are blackened by fire, like a gigantic matchstick.
26	A movie theater. There are still soda cans in some of the vending machines.
31	Abandoned refugee camp. A flag with a red cross. Emergency blankets in silver are blowing in the wind.
32	Parking garage. On one of the floors, several cars have crashed into each other.
33	An overturned school bus blocks the way.
34	Museum. The exhibition is called "We Will Meet Again." Art about death and resurrection.
35	Bath house. Walkers have contaminated the water, but there are fresh towels and shampoo.
36	A mall. The doors on the bottom floors are blocked from the inside, but walkers have managed to get in through the underground parking garage.
41	An opening into the ground, perhaps a subway station.
42	A bridge. There is an empty tent camp underneath it.
43	A theater. A sign lets you know that a Samuel Beckett show was playing.
44	Old school train station. Massive red brick complex. It's empty now, but a large settlement obviously once lived here. There's an uncanny number of barbeque pits. The faint scent of cooked meat still lingers in the air.
45	Police station. An elk or a deer has found its way in here.
46	Stadium. It was used as a refugee camp, but it got overrun. A crashed helicopter.
51	Industrial area. Warning signs to not come here. An NPC is hiding.
52	Shooting range. Plenty of guns.
53	A zoo. Someone fed the animals for a while, but now they are dead or starving.
54	Research facility. Letter written on the walls, asking someone named Laura to stay put.
55	A water tower or radio tower. Lots of birds inside.
56	Several walkers chained to a pole, like dogs with leads.
61	Elementary school. Small walkers.
62	Auto repair shop. Many tools, spare parts, and cars in various states of usability.
63	The main street of a quaint small town. The entrance is heavily barricaded in spikes and walker traps. "TURN AROUND AND LIVE" is scrawled in red paint across the crosswalk.
64	A stranded monster truck decorated with illustrations of sumo wrestlers.
65	A restaurant with a sign in the window: "Safe Inside." It is not.
66	A home for the elderly, protected by a group of teens.

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WILDERNESS

D66	DESCRIPTION
11	A newly-erected, gigantic cross in the middle of a seemingly empty field.
12	A golf course. A functional golf cart.
13	Swamp, sunken walkers will attack from beneath.
14	Overgrown fields. A wild horse lives here.
15	Thick forest, plenty of surviving wildlife.
16	Military base, abandoned.
21	Steep hills or mountains. Hungry mountain lions, or even a wolverine.
22	A crashed airplane. The door to the cabin is locked, and the dead pilots are trapped in their chairs by the seat belts.
23	Minefield. The warning signs have been removed. A one or two on a Lucky die means the PC in front will miraculously lead the group in between the mines. Mines have Blast Power 8.
24	An abandoned tent camp in a grove. A letter can be found that seems to be addressed to one of the PCs.
25	A hole or a canyon where the walkers fall in but cannot get out.
26	A beautiful meadow. A pig starts screaming as walkers eat it.
31	A stream in the hills, some salmon leaping. A bear's cave is nestled around the bend.
32	Thorn bushes. Someone or something is stuck in them.
33	A beautiful lake, river, or pond. Lots of frogs.
34	A ramshackle mansion with towers and strange statuettes. Monkey dressed in small human clothes. The owner has been eaten.
35	A desolate rest home or asylum. A great horned owl seems to be spying on the PCs.
36	Bomb craters. Maggots in rotting corpses.
41	Very dense vegetation. Fox with cubs.
42	A completely overgrown hunting lodge. Glow worms everywhere.
43	Someone has tried to avoid the walkers by connecting ropes between the treetops.
44	Burnt out cars line the highway.
45	A walker stuck in a bear trap.
46	An embankment used for target practice by survivalists, before the outbreak. They didn't survive.
51	Huge boulders, either collapsed across the PC's path or about to.
52	Withered grove with berries, apples, mushrooms, or other edible plants (one ration).
53	An overrun news team with a van, in the middle of the forest.
54	Quicksand or deep mud.
55	A large pond surrounded by tall fronds. Alligators or eels lurk in cover.
56	A lone campfire, ground nearby swept, the ash still warm.
61	Two fully functional mountain bikes leaned against a fence post.
62	A tree house with a blanket, flare pistol, and one flare.
63	Decapitated heads on sticks along a ridge, still biting at the air.
64	Dry shrubbery.
65	Everything is covered in vines.
66	An animal screaming in pain; it can't be found.

ENCOUNTERS

When the PCs move into a sector where there is no predetermined content – such as a faction haven, a location, or a swarm of walkers – roll for an encounter. Roll a double high if the sector is unknown. If the PCs have recently visited the sector, roll a D6 instead. A six means that the PCs have an encounter.

If the PCs' Scout roll before entering the sector (page 92) was successful, the PCs spot the encounter first. If it was a failure, the other party sees them first, and might even corner or ambush them. Roll on the Encounter Type table below to see what they meet. If you roll a 5 or 6, roll on the faction encounter table you created as part of your preparations.

ENCOUNTER TYPE

D6	TYPE OF ENCOUNTER
1–2	NPC encounter. Roll on the NPC table on the next page to see who it is, and on the Reactions table (page 118) to see how they react.
3–4	Walker swarm. Roll a die to determine Swarm Size.
5–6	Faction encounter. Roll on your faction encounter table.

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NPC ENCOUNTERS

D66	NAME	BACKGROUND	EXPERT	TRAINED	ISSUES	GEAR
11	Jason Brooks	Hunter	Survival, Ranged Combat	Mobility, Close Combat, Stealth	Wounded and alone, cool-headed, **Secret Issue:** The last of a group of cruel killers, manipulative sadist	Hunting rifle, 6 rations, big knife
12	Rita, Danny, and Rosalynn Harvey	Kids	—	Stealth, Mobility	Loyal to each other, saw their parents get murdered, do not trust anyone	Bikes, machetes, 3 rations
13	Santiago Perez	Surgeon	Medicine	Tech	Coward, **Secret Issue:** Pills addict	Basic medical gear, drugs, Vespa scooter, 4 rations
14	Paula Rodriguez	Teacher	—	Tech, Survival	Diabetic	Sports car, insulin shots, gun without bullets, 4 rations
15	Lenny Smith and Ross Brown	Musicians and lovers	—	Ranged Combat	Cannot handle the fear	Violins, machine guns, 6 rations, watch dog named Lennon, small car
16	Joey Chard	Construction worker	Endurance	Force, Close Combat	Shy, out to get revenge for his dead daughter, **Secret Issue:** Easily falls in love with people who treat him well	Sledgehammer, 6 rations, pickup truck low on gasoline
21	Peter Sloan and Patricia Anderson	Teens	—	Stealth, Close Combat, Manipulation	Starving, **Secret Issue:** Thieves and murderers	Hidden knives, pepper spray, and a shovel each
22	Zoe Valdez	Police officer	Ranged Combat	Stealth, Leadership, Close Combat	Likes to take command	Revolver, hat, badge, police car, 6 rations, a shotgun, knife, a newly killed animal, 5 bottles of wine

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D66	NAME	BACKGROUND	EXPERT	TRAINED	ISSUES	GEAR
23	Harry Lee	Elite athlete	Mobility	Close Combat, Scout	Lives by the old world's morals	Motorcycle, revolver, hand axe, 4 rations, 6 ID–cards taken from his dead friends
24	Angelina Banich	Housewife	Ranged Combat	Survival, Stealth, Close Combat	Mentally unstable, loner, **Secret Issue:** Killed her old gang, kills to solve conflicts	Pistol, knife, 2 rations
25	Viviane and James Moore	Husband and wife	—	Close Combat, Survival	Dream of finding a safe place to raise the child that is on the way, Viviane is pregnant, desperate to find food and safety	2 rations, 2 handguns, a car
26	Lucas Resick	Psychologist	Manipulation	Scout	Does whatever it takes to survive	Shotgun, 2 rations, a car, a tent
31	Kai Patel	Car mechanic	Tech	Close Combat	Stays out of conflicts, **Secret Issue:** Loyal to the strongest	Jeep filled with tools, machine gun, axe, 6 rations, several gasoline tanks
32	Roger Hammond and Kit Wilson	Soldiers	Ranged Combat	Close Combat, Survival, Endurance, Mobility	Traumatized, carrying their mortally wounded friend	Assault rifle, pistols, knives, 12 rations, survival gear
33	Melissa Jackson	Ex–drug addict	—	Stealth, Medicine	Thinks the worst of people	Basic medical gear, pick-axe, 2 rations, 1 hand grenade
34	Ellen Kay	Professor	Tech	Manipulation	Good at making others fight for her, cool–headed, **Secret Issue:** Never forgets an injustice	Kitchen knife, riot shield, 4 rations, another survivor (roll again) who fights for her
35	Ming–Na Ho	Firefighter	Endurance	Survival, Close Combat, Force	Depressed, **Secret Issue:** Latent tuberculosis	Fire axe, 10 rations, motorbike, tent
36	Kayd and Scott Pierson	Father and son	—	Scout, Stealth, Mobility	Ready to do anything to survive	Knife, axe, garrote, 2 rations
41	Madeline Rivera	Stockbroker	Manipulation	—	Over–confident, trader, **Secret Issue:** Blames the weakest	Car, 20 rations, shotgun
42	Stu Harrison	Cartoon writer	—	—	Relies on luck, **Secret Issue:** Puts others in harm's way	2 rations, gored up poncho to blend in among the dead, a horn to call on the dead for protection
43	Ezra Faheem	Nurse	—	Medicine, Close Combat	Trust issues	Basic medical gear, small car, 10 rations, speargun
44	Eliot Harper	Engineer	Tech	—	Soft spot for children, **Secret Issue:** Will sacrifice anything to save a child	Shovel, survival gear, 2 rations

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D66	NAME	BACKGROUND	EXPERT	TRAINED	ISSUES	GEAR
45	Wayne Vo	Landlord	—	—	Alcoholic	—
46	Anne Jackson	Actor	—	Stealth, Close Combat	Never sleeps, **Secret Issue:** Voices tell her things	Sword, 2 rations
51	Zane Sparks	Animal handler	—	Ranged Combat, Survival	Never changes his opinion about anything	Animal control pole, protective gloves, nets, shovel, taser, 5 rations
52	Jessica Fryers	Pilot	Mobility	Close Combat, Manipulation	Stubborn, wounded, **Secret Issue:** Member of a secret faction	Carbine rifle, propeller plane with no gas, knife
53	Luke McGowan	Assassin	Ranged Combat, Close Combat	Stealth	Never plays by the rules, **Secret Issue:** Only loyal to himself	Hunting rifle, shovel, knife, Vespa scooter, 4 rations, pet cat named Cindy
54	Mira Bello	Factory worker	—	Endurance	Lonely and afraid	Two–handed axe, 1 ration
55	Selena and Eva Cabello	Sisters, cook (Selena) and journalist (Eva)	—	Survival	Never let anyone in, fight dirty, **Secret Issue:** Selena recently lost her baby twins	Baseball bats, spears, equipment to set up traps, 2 grenades, 8 rations
56	Jacky Hearts	Influencer	—	—	Picks on the weak, **Secret Issue:** A thief and a murderer	Sports bicycle, revolver, hammer, handheld camera with batteries, a boyfriend named Claude who never utters a word, 8 rations
61	Esmerelda Rains	Bus driver	—	Mobility	Knows about a safe place, but can't get there without help, **Secret Issue:** Pathological liar	Sheriff's badge, revolver, fake diamond ring, bandage on her arm that hides an ugly tattoo
62	Oscar Lahm	Waste collector	—	Endurance, Close Combat	Thinks the worst of people	Garbage truck filled with random equipment, rifle, nunchaku, sharpened screwdriver, 20 rations
63	Sheila Barboza	Cleaning lady	—	—	Has been hiding in a prepper's bunker until recently, practically useless around walkers, **Secret Issue:** The prepper wouldn't let her leave	Hunting rifle, survival gear, first aid kits, 10 rations, an axe, a tent, a sun powered battery–charger, a radio transmitter, a car with two flat tires
64	"The Major"	Prison guard	Manipulation, Ranged Combat	Scout, Survival, Close Combat	Over–confident, and fearless, **Secret Issue:** Wants underlings to control, will burn down the world to get revenge on an enemy	Two guns with silencers, body armor, jeep, a hideout, binoculars, 10 rations
65	Adam Stark	Butcher	Close Combat	—	Too kind for his own good	Butcher's cleaver, butcher's knife, revolver, 6 rations, tent, horse
66	Dax Heinz	Car salesman	—	Manipulation, Stealth	Taking care of his mortally wounded brother	Survival gear, 6 rations, 3 Molotov cocktails, axe

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WALKERS IN THE BUILDING

When the PCs enter a building, you decide if there are walkers in it. You can use a Lucky die to decide, or you can use the Random Threat Level table to the right. Make a mental map and decide how many and where they are, for example that there are two walkers in the basement. Once you have made this decision, you should stick to it.

If the PCs make loud noises, such as firing guns, they will attract walkers. But you do not need to have the swarm arrive immediately. Decide how much time it takes for the walkers to get there or roll on the table Walkers Approaching – first to decide the unit of time, then to decide the number of seconds, minutes, and so on.

RANDOM THREAT LEVEL

D6	THREAT LEVEL
1–2	0
3–4	1
5–6	2

WALKERS APPROACHING

D6	TIME
1	Seconds
2	Minutes
3	One hour
4	Hours
5	Days
6	Too far to find the way here

NPCS AND ANIMALS

This section includes rules for running NPCs and animals.

MANAGING NPCS

As described in previous chapters, NPCs do not push skill rolls and they don't take Stress. All NPCs roll four dice when they use a skill. Being Trained lets them add one die, and being Expert lets them add three more dice (for a total of eight). If you need inspiration to create NPCs, there are tables in the appendix (page 149) that will let you roll up an NPC in seconds.

If there is an NPC in the campaign that you think needs special attention, maybe because the NPC is an important part of the endgame, you could give them attributes, skill levels, and even talents.

NPC ISSUES: Do not tell the players what Issues the NPCs have. Let them find out in game. Secret Issues are things the NPCs keep to themselves and try not to let others find out about.

NPC REACTIONS

When the PCs meet an NPC, you can roll on the NPC Reactions table to the right to determine their initial feelings and intentions towards the PCs. What the PCs do will change what the NPC thinks of them. Roll a double low if it seems likely that an NPC is friendly, and a double high if it is likely that they are hostile.

The NPC Reactions table can also be used to decide what an NPCs thinks of another NPC. Roll a die; a low result means that they like the other NPC, and a high result indicates that they dislike or even hate them.

FURTHER REACTIONS: The dice roll will only determine the initial reactions of an NPC. As the encounter develops, the NPC will react to what the PCs do. Let the NPC do what seems plausible and fun. Let them be smart, let them make plans, let them try to achieve their goals. Try to imagine what you would do in the same situation.

When an NPC reacts, it does not always mean they do something aggressive. Some NPCs will plead for their life or try to talk it out. Play the NPC in a way that makes sense for their character and the story.

NPC REACTIONS

D6	REACTION
1	Friendly or in need of help.
2	Cautious but curious.
3	Wants to exchange goods, rumors, or something else.
4	Scared and ready to flee, hide, or defend themselves.
5	Hostile.
6	Plans to take what the PCs have, by force or through cunning.

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GM: *About halfway through the forest, you walk out into a clearing filled with yellow and black flowers. In the middle of it, there is a small white church. The sun is shining on it, birds are singing, and you smell food. The church door has been barricaded, and all the windows are blocked except one. There is smoke coming from it, as if there is a campfire inside the church.*

[The Gamemaster has rolled a 6 meaning there will be an encounter, and then a 2 which means an NPC encounter. The NPC Encounters table determined that it is a police officer. The roll for the reaction is a 5, which means that the officer is hostile and dangerous.]

David (player 4): *I sneak up to the church and peek through the window. I am so hungry now. But I fail my Stealth roll.*

GM: *The first thing you see when you look through the window is the barrel of a shotgun. What do you do?*

David: *I duck and roll Mobility. I fail again!*

GM: *You hear an explosion. As you fall backwards, you realize it was the shotgun discharging so close to your head. You take weapon damage. You will need to roll for a critical injury.*

ANIMALS

Animals don't have skills. The PCs will seldom need to make an opposed roll against an animal. If a PC wants to track an animal, they make a straight Scout roll.

Only roll dice for animals when the PCs fight them. Then the normal rules for NPCs apply. The Animals table below shows how many dice an animal gets to roll in a fight and how much damage it inflicts. If you want to introduce encounters with an animal not included in the list, use the stats of a similar one or come up with your own stats for the creature.

ANIMALS

ANIMAL	ATTACK DICE	DAMAGE	HEALTH
Alligator	6	2	4
Bear	8	2	4
Dog	4	1	3
Eagle	4	1	2
Elk	5	1	4
Venomous snake	5	1 (+poison)	2
Tiger	8	2	4
Trained watchdog	6	1	3
Wolf	6	1	3
Wolverine	5	1	3

MAKE IT COME ALIVE

One of the most important things you need to do is to breathe life into the game by describing how things look, smell, feel, and taste. Do it in a way that will help the players create images in their heads and put them in a mood conducive to taking what is happening seriously.

WATCHING THE CAMPFIRE

Being a Gamemaster is, in a way, like tending a campfire. You sit close to it and marvel at the flames and sparks. After a while, the fire will lose its intensity and heat, and you need to add a log or two, maybe blow some oxygen into the flames. But if you add too much to the fire, the flames will become too hot and difficult to control.

The hardest and most important part of being a GM is to get a feeling for when one should activate more Challenges and complicate the things that are already happening, and when one should sit back and just follow along with whatever the PCs are already doing. If you add too little content, the players will feel confused and lost; they won't know what to do. But if you add too many Challenges, the players will feel cornered and stressed. The world will seem chaotic, and not in a good way.

Watch the players at the table. Is there a spark in their eyes? Are they leaning forward, talking in character? Are they eager to get to another scene so that their PC can do new things? Are there scenes with action and difficult interpersonal conflicts? If this is the case, you should sit back and enjoy the campfire.

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GAMEMASTER TIPS

Here are some tips on how to make the world come alive:

GIVE DETAILS, BUT NOT TOO MANY. Describe the world, but don't lose yourself in long monologues. Instead, give brief bursts of details: the cannibal's discolored teeth, what a newly opened can of beef stew smells like when you haven't eaten in four days, the dust on the teacher's desk in the abandoned classroom, etc.

USE A THEME. Let everything about a house, a location, or an enclave reflect a specific theme or idea: strangely clean, covered with mad writings on the walls, or silent and serene.

ASK QUESTIONS. Ask the PCs what they think, feel, long for, and perceive. Be curious about their experience.

ADD A TWIST. Throw in an odd or contradictory detail. A violent despot who is nice to children, a sad nobody who claims to be the second in command of the U.S. Army.

USE YOUR VOICE AND BODY LANGUAGE. When portraying NPCs at the table, provide them with different voices and gestures.

LET THE PCS NAME THINGS. What do they call the nearby lake? What is the nickname for the NPC Survivor who always wears a baseball cap? What do they call walkers?

USE SOUND AND SILENCE. Play suspenseful music, or calm music. Play sounds of gunfire when you have a battle, or grunts from walkers. Ask the players to whisper when their PCs whisper.

CHANGE THE PACE. Keep the PCs on their toes. Have long social scenes with no clear focus. Then shoot one of the NPCs in the head.

USE CONTRASTS. Frightening things aren't as scary without a contrast. Include NPCs who care for each other and who live by pre-outbreak morals. Let there be a child that the whole haven cares about. Then have a walker take a bite of its arm.

MIND THE TIME. Use the seasons of the year to set scenes that are distinct. Let it snow in winter and have the blazing sun hammer at them in summer. Remind players what time of day it is. Keep notes of the dates and years that pass by in game.

Dear Eli

I guess this is a good time to tell you that you have a horrible singing voice. Listening to you howling every evening at the gathering while banging on your guitar was nothing short of torture. You were self-centered, and you smelled bad even after you'd showered and brushed your teeth. Your way of pronouncing "laboratory" and "potatoes" as if you were from England made me want to punch you in the teeth. You snored in your sleep, and nobody believed your constant attempts to convince us that it was one of the kids who farted. But I still love you. What you did for us, the risks you took, the lives you saved… you kept us going. When you were shot, I knew for sure you'd pull through like you always did. But you didn't. In that moment, in the middle of the night, when you drew your last breath, I lost my best friend.

DRAW MAPS. Show the players what their surroundings look like. Don't try to create art here; make your maps quick and dirty.

LET THE WORLD CHANGE. Always let something in the haven be different when the PCs come back from a run. It could be a small thing, such as an NPC who has shaved their hair.

WHAT DO YOU DO?

There are four words you should say over and over again: What do you do? Say them whenever there is a difficult situation (or some variation of them). That question hands the initiative to the players and invites them to be active co-creators of the story. Then use the mechanics to see if they are successful. Here are some examples:

- Don't say: "The hunter grabs his gun and shoots you in the head." Instead say: "The hunter grabs for something inside his jacket, it could be a gun. What do you do?"
- Don't say: "The walker jumps on top of you and bites you in the throat." Instead say: "The walker jumps on top of you and drools in your face as it attempts to bite you. What do you do?"
- Don't say: "A wildfire starts just outside your haven and burns it all down." Instead say: "A wildfire starts just outside your haven. It quickly grows into an inferno, and it is spreading towards you. What do you do?"

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PCS MESSING UP

When the PCs mess up, the game gives you a kind of authority over the situation: you get to control in what way the PCs create Challenges for themselves. With this comes responsibility. Do not make the players feel that their PC is stupid or acting like a clown. You can ask the player for suggestions: "I think you do something that attracts walkers, what could it be?"

LIVES ARE NOT CHEAP

People will die all the time in this game, both PCs and NPCs. This seems to indicate that lives are cheap and that you as a GM should treat NPCs as pawns in a chess game. But they aren't, and you shouldn't. The PCs' lives, and the lives of all humans, are the only thing left in the world of the dead. Every fallen friend should be a tragedy and a reason to take revenge. Make the NPCs likable, give them backstories, and give the PCs a reason to interact with them.

MAKING IT SCARY

Here are some tips to create horror in the game:

DESCRIBE THE APOCALYPSE. Show the PCs signs of the world's collapse – people who fought to the very end but were overrun, an abandoned car with a bloody seat, the farewell note from a soldier who blew their brains out, empty streets, empty houses, empty roads. Static on the radio.

SHOW THEM DEATH. This is the land of the dead. There are no safe places. Show the PCs walkers; hide even more walkers. Put their friends in situations where they might die. Hit them when they feel safe.

MAKE THEM LOSE HOPE. Surround them with walkers. Tell them they only have one bullet left, and then let the enemies' tank come crashing through the fence. If they deserve to live, they will find a way.

DON'T LET WALKERS BECOME A JOKE. Walkers are never campy or kitsch. Make the effort to describe the walkers with just a few details so that they become unfortunate people, not monsters. This reminds the PCs that it could happen to them. If the players make jokes about the walkers, it is time to hide a walker in a closet.

HUMANS ARE THE REAL MONSTERS. Let the hostile NPCs be as horrible, immoral, and scary as you can make them. Think about people who freak you out in real life and then create an even worse version of that. But always have them behave according to their inner logic. It is scarier with killers who think they are doing the right thing, than chaotic mass-murderers without a purpose or a cause.

HIDE THE THREAT. Whether it is a walker or a human, you should not let the PCs see it immediately. It could simply be that you let the walkers be locked up in the barn, but it could also be an NPC who seems to be friendly at first – they might even welcome survivors into their haven and promise them food and shelter.

ISOLATE THEM. Let the group scatter after an attack. Have someone who is wounded get lost in the forest. Let one of them be alone and without any weapon, and then have something sneak up on them in the darkness. Remember that messing up could mean that you get lost, fall down a well, or simply run in the wrong direction.

FREAK THEM OUT WITH GORE. Use gore to sicken the players. Shoot someone's lower jaw off, catch someone in a grenade blast, set someone on fire, shred someone's leg with a landmine.

SET THE MOOD. Whether you play online or at a table, let the area where you play be dark except for the light you need to read your preparations. Play music that corresponds to the mood, alter your voice and whisper or scream when appropriate, and ask everyone to turn off their mobile phones.

NPCS FROM THE TV FRANCHISE

If you and the players decide that characters from the TV series should be included in the game, recreate those NPCs and factions according to the game's rules. Mix elements from the TV series with your own creations.

NPCs from the TV franchise should be played like any others. Do not simply say, "It is Eugene sitting at the bar," but describe him as if the PCs have never seen him before (which they haven't). It is up to the players to figure out who he really is.

Think about what the characters from the show would do in certain situations and what they believe is important. As the PCs interact with them, the NPCs will face situations that did not happen on TV. You must figure out how they are likely to react.

It is easy to let the characters from the show become the main characters in the game, but they never should. In your game, your PCs are the main characters. Do not focus on TV characters more than on any other NPCs, and do not let them lead the group or make decisions.

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SURVIVAL MODE SCENARIOS

As opposed to a campaign, a survival mode scenario revolves around a pre-written dramatic situation. *The Golden Ambulance* on page 136 is such a scenario, and in the Starter Set you will find another one, called *The Wolves' Den.* Additional scenarios will be published in the future.

What survival mode scenarios have in common is that they are short, typically taking about two to five hours to play. They also come with pre-generated, custom-made PCs, and they often have a clear link to a specific episode, faction, or location from *The Walking Dead* TV franchise – you meet characters from the show, or you get to play them as PCs.

If you want, you can create your own scenarios for survival mode play. Here are some tips and guidelines that may be helpful during the design process.

As a survival mode scenario is limited in time and space – one situation, one location – don't use the rules for traveling, projects, or using attributes for the haven. PCs only have one Anchor – one of the other PCs.

CHALLENGE AND GOAL

Come up with a Challenge that is the main focus of the scenario. It should be dramatic and impossible to ignore. Typically, the main Challenge is represented by a group of hostile NPCs. Here are examples of main Challenges:

- A hostile and powerful faction has surrounded the haven.
- Someone killed one of the NPCs in the haven, but no one admits to it.
- A friend is injured badly and needs medical attention, but the PCs do not have any medical equipment. There is a hospital close by.
- The PCs caught a person spying on them who is part of a faction of plunderers that has targeted their haven.
- There is a quarry nearby filled with thousands of walkers, and they are about to leave it and wander in the direction of the haven.

MINOR CHALLENGES: Come up with one or several additional Challenges – complications that won't be the main focus but will stir things up.

THE PCS' GOAL: Decide what the scenario will appear to be about, from the perspective of the PCs. It may be directly linked to the main challenge, or something completely different – something they need to put on hold while a more acute situation is addressed.

STARTING POINT: Decide when and where the game starts, the first scene. There are two ways to do this in relation to the main Challenge: either the PCs know about the main Challenge when the game begins, or they will find out about it in the one of the first scenes.

LOCATION

Most scenarios focus on one main location: a key building or a specific area. The PCs may start the scenario on their way to the location, or they're already there. Place the location geographically. Define what time of the year it is.

MAPS: Draw a map of the location. Make a copy of it so you have one player map and a map for you. Mark out entrances and important places on your map. Remember that NPCs move around – they will not sit idle in a room and wait for the PCs.

DESIGNING SURVIVAL MODE

When you design a scenario, there are ten steps you should go through. You can do them in any order. Guidelines regarding most of the listed steps are covered by other sections in this book and will not be repeated here.

1. Come up with a main Challenge.
2. Create one or several minor Challenges.
3. Define the PCs' goal.
4. Set a starting point.
5. Define time and place.
6. Draw maps.
7. Create the NPCs.
8. Place walkers.
9. Come up with an endgame.
10. Create PCs.

SENSITIVE SUBJECTS

If you write a scenario that you intend to play with people you do not know well, for example at a game convention, it is extra important to think about the themes and situations you include. Everyone should feel safe while playing the game.

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NPCS: If the location is inhabited, create the NPCs according to the rules. In some scenarios, the PCs have one or more NPC survivors with them. Think about what drives the NPCs, especially the bad guys. It could be anything from jealousy, power-hunger, desperation to survive, love, hatred, or an inner sense of right and wrong.

PLACE WALKERS: Mark out where there are walkers in or close to the location. Remember that more walkers can arrive at any moment – especially if the PCs mess up and make noise.

ENDGAME

Decide what will happen if the PCs do nothing. Come up with a disastrous ending for the situation. Write down who will die, what will be burnt to the ground, and which malevolent leader will win the day. Or simply state that walkers will overrun the entire location. When you play, you should let things happen that drive the story towards the endgame. It is up to the PCs to prevent this.

PLAYER CHARACTERS

Most survival mode scenarios come with pre-generated PCs. Create five PCs and number them from one to five. This is the order the PCs should be used if you have less than five players. If you, for example, only have two players, use the PCs numbered one and two.

When you design the PCs, you should come up with Issues and Drives that are directly related to the scenario. In a way, you could say that PCs number one and two are the main characters of this scenario. Let them have a clear connection to the main Challenge.

SECRETS: In some survival mode scenarios, the PCs have secrets they keep from each other. Instruct the players to not tell the other players about their secret before the scenario begins. Try to write the scenario so that it can be played even if the group chooses not to disclose the secrets.

PLAYING SURVIVAL MODE

Once you start playing, the PCs do what they want. Don't force them to act in a certain way, and don't try to make them come up with specific solutions to Challenges. Follow them around and let the NPCs act and react.

As time passes, let things happen that push events towards the endgame. Make the situation more dramatic and alarming. If the PCs do nothing, or if they fail, play out the endgame.

The scenario should be ended within a handful of hours, either because everyone is dead or because they accomplished what they needed to do. Everything in the scenario does not need to have been solved for you to end it – some threads can be left hanging for you and the players to think about afterwards.

MOOD: Focus on setting the mood right from the start. Use the first scene to describe the heavy rain, strange sounds in the haven, and how stressed the NPCs in the group are. One or two slower scenes in the beginning are perfect for letting PCs talk to each other and to let the players get comfortable.

HORROR: Describe the walkers and the villains in a creepy way. Let the PCs witness the atrocities they have committed.

RULES: Explain the basic rules before you start playing. Take short breaks in scenes when a player does not understand the rules and see to it that everyone has a chance to understand the mechanics.

DIFFICULTY LEVEL: Survival mode scenarios should be hard to survive. Don't be afraid to make them difficult. But do not write them so that PCs die in the first scenes – it is boring to sit on the sideline and wait for the others to finish the scenario.

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CHAPTER 8

ATLANTA

CAMPAIGN **SET-UP**

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This chapter can be used as a quick start, the first time you play a campaign. It can be the starting point of a short or a long campaign, or even several seasons of campaigns. The events take place in the area northeast of Atlanta. Use the map to get an overview; important sectors are marked in the sidebar.

PREPARATIONS

What needs to be done before you start playing a campaign is described in Chapter 7. Gather your players to introduce the setup and go through the joint preparations (page 97).

Regarding the usual Gamemaster preparations, the groundwork has already been laid in this chapter. However, there are a few things you should pay attention to.

"You honor the dead by going on, even when you are scared. You love because they don't get to."

Glenn Rhee

GAMEMASTER PREPARATIONS

Before the game begins you should do the following, without the players looking over your shoulder:

1. **Roll on the Swarm Movement table** (page 106) for each of the three swarms, to see in what direction they move.
2. **Read up on the factions, the secret Issues, and the Challenges.** If you want, you can add, remove, or adjust details to your liking.
3. **Choose one or two Challenges** that you will use in the first session. Try to come up with a scene to introduce the Challenge(s).

CHALLENGE LISTS

There are Challenge lists created for the factions, the PCs' haven, and for some of the NPC survivors. When you play the campaign, activate Challenges from the lists to keep things moving. At the end of this chapter, there are suggestions for which Challenges to introduce during the first session.

Between sessions, you can expand the Challenge lists and write new ones. Don't forget that you may also establish Challenges by rolling on the table for random events (page 111), or by introducing a need (page 111).

INSPIRATION FROM THE TV SERIES

This campaign is designed to take place after Season 11. Rick and his gang moved away from here a long time ago, but they have left behind traces of their presence. There are three ways to come into contact with content from the TV series:

One of the factions is a group calling themselves The Living, members of whom Rick encountered and killed in a bar in Season 2. They are now bloodthirsty plunderers. When the campaign starts, they have settled down in a bombed-out factory.

One of the members of a faction called The Reborn is a police officer named Arnold Grant, who was once a part of the group at Grady Memorial Hospital (where Beth was held captive in Season 5) in Atlanta. On a mission from the hospital, Arnold lost his friends and his car and was saved by The Reborn. He decided to join the faction. Arnold tries, in vain, to convince the others that they should contact his old friends at the hospital and cooperate with them. If the PCs are looking for a place where they can find advanced medical gear, Arnold might tell them about Grady.

On a lake boat settlement, where almost all inhabitants have mysteriously perished, the PCs might encounter and save the only survivor. Her name is Cyndie. Once part of the Oceanside faction that first appeared in season 7 of the TV series, Cyndie revenge-killed a Savior named Arat during the peace time after Negan was deposed. Since she was a leader for Oceanside at this point, her actions caused immense trouble for Rick's efforts to bring all the former war enemies together.

Cyndie eventually left Oceanside on an expedition out to sea. But the boat was caught in a storm that took it south and sunk it. She wandered west and ended up in the Atlanta area, joining the local group of survivors who inhabited the lake's old tour boats. Unfortunately, everyone in the group except Cyndie was killed by a highly virulent disease.

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NPCS AND THE HAVEN

When the game starts, the PCs have a haven and a group of people living with them.

NPC SURVIVORS

These are the NPC survivors who live with the PCs in their haven:

- **LIAM GRAHAM**, Nurse. **Trained:** Medicine, Scout. **Issue:** Coward. **Gear:** Basic medical gear, knife, guitar.
- **ALICIA GONZALEZ**, Pilot. **Trained:** Mobility, Ranged Combat. **Issues:** Lonely, constant arguments with her teenage son Daniel Gonzalez. **Gear:** Shotgun, small dog named Donald, scooter.
- **MILDRED COBB**, Wildlife tourist guide. **Expert:** Survival. **Trained:** Ranged Combat. **Issues:** Taciturn. **Gear:** Tent, wildlife equipment, small revolver.
- **DANIEL GONZALEZ**, Teenager. **Trained:** Manipulation. **Issues:** Smothered by his mother's (Alicia Gonzalez) attempts to keep him safe, overconfident, says the wrong thing at the wrong time. **Gear:** A well–read copy of the book Walden, knife, diary.
- **ANN HILLER**, Social worker. **Trained:** Endurance. **Issues:** Reliable and loyal, trigger happy. **Gear:** Pistol, seeds for planting, cigarette packs, lighter.

SECRET SURVIVOR ISSUE: Mildred Cobb has a secret Issue: She does not believe that the group will survive, and is planning to leave on her own. Mildred thinks that the others in the group, including the PCs, don't have what it takes, and she can see that the food supply in the cabin is rapidly decreasing. For a while now, Mildred has stolen from the storage and stashed it in the forest. She plans to leave the haven at night, when the others are sleeping. When she does, she will steal anything she can get her hands on.

SURVIVOR CHALLENGES

There are two Challenge lists for the NPC survivors when the game starts.

Ann Hiller:

- Ann shoots Alicia Gonzalez by mistake while practicing her shooting skills. To save her life, the PCs need to find advanced medical gear within a double low number of weeks.

Mildred Cobb:

- Liam Graham discovers that Mildred is hiding food in the forest, and he tells the others. Mildred claims that Liam is the one hiding food, and that he is trying to blame her for it.
- Mildred abandons the camp in the middle of the night, taking much of the PCs' equipment along with her.

STARTING HAVEN: A DESOLATE CABIN

The PCs have found an isolated cabin out in the forest. It is surrounded by a tall, heavy-duty fence of wooden stakes forming an enclosed palisade around the perimeter. The road leading to the cabin has almost been swallowed by nature. There is a small creek nearby. When the PCs found this place, the earthen cellar beneath the house was filled with food, but the supplies are now running low.

- **CAPACITY:** 3
- **DEFENSE:** 2

ISSUES

- The palisade has weak spots.
- Reliance on a food source that will become depleted.
- Exposed to dangers while getting water from the creek.
- Isolated in the woods.

SECRET ISSUE: The owner of the cabin wants it back. The person who originally lived in the cabin has returned. This person is now hiding in the forest, spying on the group with binoculars. If most of the people in the cabin leave, or if they seem weak or defenseless for some reason, the owner will climb the palisade at night and try to force them to leave. Roll on the NPC Encounter table (page 115) to determine who the previous owner is.

CHALLENGES

- The owner of the cabin sneaks in and kidnaps one of the NPCs, threatening to kill them unless you relinquish the cabin.
- The food gets depleted (lower Capacity by one).
- An NPC or PC gets surrounded by walkers when fetching water.
- The owner sneaks in when the PCs and NPCs are away, and barricades the cabin from within.

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NORTH EAST GEORGIA

0 5 10 15 20 25

KILOMETERS

- Forest
- Populated Area
- Road
- Lake
- River
- State Border

KEY SECTORS ON THE MAP

1. **The PC's haven:** northwest of Dahlonega, sector F5.
2. **The Living's haven:** In Gainesville, sector H8.
3. **The Reborn's haven:** Close to Lavonia, sector N6.
4. **The School's Haven:** Outside Athens, sector K11.
5. **Swarm 1, Swarm Size 4:** North of Lawrenceville, sector F11.
6. **Swarm 2, Swarm Size 4:** In Walhalla, sector O3.
7. **Swarm 3, Swarm Size 5:** West of Ellijay, sector A3.
8. **The Peach Plantation:** East of Canton, sector B8.
9. **The Lake Boat Settlement:** Lake Lanier, sector F9.

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FACTIONS

There are three factions on the map when the game starts: The Living, The Reborn and The School. Most likely, they won't all be used in the campaign, but that depends on where the PCs go and what they do. The factions are there to be found.

THE LIVING

The Living is a group of about 50 people who used to opportunistically scavenge the area and steal from unsuspecting strangers, but they have now settled down in a bombed-out factory. They are violent and disorganized. Whoever is strongest makes the decisions.

Disputes are settled in The Hole – a fighting pit surrounded by chained walkers. Combatants either fight to the death or until one agrees to surrender to the other. Those who are too weak to fight are forced to do menial labor – they are sent out on scavenging runs, and they take care of the greenhouse on the roof of the factory.

The Living have a radio transmitter, which they use to send out messages claiming that their haven is a thriving sanctuary. When survivors arrive, they are either killed or enslaved. The Living are well-armed, but they are desperately short on ammunition. They mostly fight with spears, baseball bats, and Molotov cocktails.

ISSUES

- Can't be trusted.
- Idealize brute strength.
- Want to conquer and plunder.
- Will do almost anything to get ammunition.
- Badly organized.

HAVEN

The haven of The Living is in the ruins of a large factory, now filled with traps. The faction members live in small groups all over the factory – hiding both from each other and from intruders.

- **CAPACITY:** 3
- **DEFENSE:** 2

KEY NPCS

- **NATE MILLER**, Small-time crook. **Expert:** Close Combat, Mobility, Manipulation. **Trained:** Stealth, Ranged Combat. **Issues:** Leader of the Living, manipulative, unpredictable, loves this new world.
- **ROBERT LEHMAN**, Surgeon. **Expert:** Medicine. **Issues:** Wants to flee but does not know how to do it, cynic.
- **CHLOE BARNES**, DJ. **Expert:** Manipulation. **Trained:** Tech, Leadership. **Issues:** In charge of the radio transmitter, visionary, has people fighting for her.

CHALLENGES

- The PCs find a radio transmitter and hear The Living's broadcast, where they urge people to come to them for security. There are several unknown survivors chatting with The Living, and the PCs may also talk to them.
- The Living find and take one of the NPC survivors, perhaps Daniel Gonzalez.

THE REBORN

The Reborn is a group of 14 people who all survived the first months after the outbreak by seeking refuge in a church. They were kept alive by Father Jack Morgan, a young priest who saw the awakening of the dead as the beginning of the End of Days. He formed a group that took care of each other, and put their faith in God and the Bible.

When Morgan was killed, he was not reborn as a walker – which, according to his followers, proves that he was in fact Jesus' Second Coming. The mark of The Reborn is a cross with an M on it. They paint it wherever they go.

Now, The Reborn are determined to build a New Jerusalem, where Father Morgan will come back to rule humanity and spread his love and understanding. They use the Bible to make decisions, and have no other leader who has taken Father Morgan's place.

When The Reborn go on runs, they do so in pairs – well-equipped, and highly disciplined. They like to contact strangers to spread the word about Father Morgan, but they do not take any risks. Survivors who want to join the congregation are driven to a small, abandoned village close to their bunker, where they are cared for. At the moment, this village is desolate, as the last people who were taken here were attacked and killed by walkers.

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The Reborn are looking for a radio transmitter to spread the holy word, and they know that The Living have one. They are on really bad terms with The Living, and pray that Father Morgan's return will bring upon their banishment to Hell.

ISSUES

- The Holy words will lead us to paradise.
- Well-trained and well-equipped.
- Prepared to sacrifice their own lives for their beliefs.
- Everyone must take a stand, for good or for evil.

HAVEN

The Reborn have a well-defended military bunker with lots of food, gasoline, and ammunition, scavenged from far and wide. They also have several army trucks and jeeps.

Their haven is placed in the forest. Close to it lies the grave where Father Jack Morgan is buried. The group gathers here every day to pray to their Savior. If asked about Morgan, all members of The Reborn will swear that he did not come back as a walker but was buried as a human. If the PCs dig up the grave, Father Morgan is trying to claw his way up from the dirt.

- **CAPACITY:** 3
- **DEFENSE:** 3

KEY NPCS

The last person to join The Reborn was a former police officer named Arnold Grant. Grant was formerly living with a faction of police officers and hospital staff at Grady Memorial Hospital in Atlanta, but he was left behind on a run outside the city. Grant was saved by The Reborn, and since then he has encouraged the faction members to make contact with the hospital group, as he thinks they would make good allies. The others believe his judgment is clouded by sentimentality, and they see the group at the hospital as heretics. These are the key NPCs of The Reborn:

- **LUCY BROWN**, soldier. **Expert:** Ranged Combat. **Trained:** Close Combat, Leadership, Manipulation, Stealth, Scout. **Issues:** Father Morgan's closest disciple, sinners should burn, silver tongue.
- **ARNOLD GRANT**, police officer. **Trained:** Ranged Combat, Close Combat, Scout, Mobility. **Issues:** True believer, longs for his friends and wife at Grady Memorial Hospital.
- **ROY HARRIS**, construction worker. **Expert:** Close Combat, Endurance, Force. **Trained:** Survival, Medicine, Scout. **Issues:** Struggles with his beliefs, as he thinks Father Morgan might have indeed been stirring during his burial.

CHALLENGES

- Lucy Brown and one other member of The Reborn contact the PCs and offer them the chance to join The Reborn, so long as they pledge their faith and agree to get baptized in the church of Father Morgan.
- The PCs watch as The Reborn burn a group of "infidels" and murderers.

THE SCHOOL

The School was a gathering point for pupils and teachers alike after the fall. Soldiers surrounded the building and fought off walkers; they saved the people inside, but were ultimately killed in the battle. The teachers and students took the guns, the rations, and even a battle tank parked on the schoolyard, and in time they have transformed the campus into a haven, complete with a working farm, laws, and courts.

In the settlement, there are fifteen former teachers and staff members who call themselves the Council. They make all the decisions. The forty-seven surviving boys and girls who were pupils at the time of the outbreak are now all adults. Adding to this, almost seventy children have been taken in over the years, most of them left by parents who were not welcomed into the community themselves. These younger kids, between age 7 and 16, must abide to strict rules of conduct and an even stricter work ethic – they attend classes to learn subjects from the old world, but they also work in the fields, construct materials for the community, cook food, and take part in everything else that needs to be done.

A group of previous pupils, called the Security, are responsible for both guarding the haven and going on runs to find food and valuable equipment. When recruiting new Security members, the Council carefully selects students who demonstrate aggressive and/or anti-social tendencies, knowing that they'll be more likely to do what is necessary to protect the collective.

At the moment, the School is a well-functioning society, but the Council knows that they will, in time, run out of vital equipment. They are searching for other settlements to trade with. At the same time, while they are happy to welcome any lost children who wish to join the School, they are highly suspicious of other adults.

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Once every month, there is a ”full moon party” on the School premises. The students are responsible for preparing for the party well in advance, making sure there is an abundance of food, alcohol, even drugs. The students must then leave the haven for the night, fending for themselves in the surrounding wilds, while the Council parties all night long, letting loose in an adults-only ”no kids allowed” night off. Only a few of the oldest students remain on guard duty, and, whenever those students are old enough to stop taking classes, these ”graduates” are welcomed onto the Council and encouraged to start attending the parties as well, as a rite of passage and a perk to embracing the responsibilities of adulthood.

Sadly, one of the younger students got lost in the dark and died in the night during the last party. As the next one is approaching, many of the students are scared and don’t want to go out again... much to the chagrin of the Council.

ISSUES

- The Council recklessly consumes their resources for a monthly party, at the expense of forcing their students to fend for themselves one night a month.
- The Council is paranoid.
- Searches for a trade partner but will feel threatened if it finds a settlement big enough to trade with.
- Individual needs are sacrificed for the common good.
- A stash of heavy weapons that will be used if needed.

HAVEN

A three-story school building in red brick with a black roof. The schoolyard is surrounded by a high wall. Inside, there is farmland, but also guard towers and a battle tank. The tank has a broken engine and limited ammunition.

- **CAPACITY: 4**
- **DEFENSE: 4**

KEY NPCS

- **MARGARET HICKS**, former biology teacher and member of the Council. **Expert:** Manipulation. **Trained:** Leadership, Tech. **Issues:** Cruel and hateful, scared of the Security and will do anything to please them, sees other adults as rivals.
- **ALICE DAY**, leader of the Security. **Expert:** Ranged Combat. **Trained:** Mobility, Close Combat, Leadership. **Issues:** Sociopath.
- **LEO DUNCAN**, recent graduate. **Trained:** Close Combat, Ranged Combat, Stealth, Scout. **Issues:** Recent School graduate. Traumatized from the many nights he’s been forced to defend himself and his fellow students. Fed up with the Council, but his friends and fellow graduates are watching him, worried that he’ll spoil the fun.

CHALLENGES

- A group of kids run away from the School and seek refuge in the PCs’ haven. But the Security is looking for them.

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SWARMS AND LOCATIONS

When the game starts, there are three swarms in the area: one of Swarm Size 5, and two of Swarm Size 4. There are two key locations from the start of the campaign: The Peach Farm and the Lake Boat Settlement.

PEACH FARM

The Beasley family was able to protect parts of their enormous peach farm by keeping the fence in good shape, and getting rid of any walkers who made it in. Unfortunately, just three days ago, they were attacked by a brutal pack of raiders. The fence is broken, and walkers are all over the farm. The main house bears traces of brutal and bloody killings, and almost all the supplies are gone. But a couple of teenage twins in the family survived by jumping into the well. They have water, but nothing to eat, and they can't get up. If they get help, they know how to fix the fence, and get the farm going again. In time, they will try to find whoever killed their family and take revenge.

- **JOEY AND LIZA BEASLEY**, teenagers. **Trained:** Survival, Tech, Scout, Mobility, Stealth. **Issues:** Obsessed with revenge, pretend to trust others, starving and injured.

THE LAKE BOAT SETTLEMENT

Three lake boats, connected by ropes, are floating on Lake Lanier. There are some supplies on board: several guns and lots of fuel for the boats. But there are also walkers in all three boats: the people who were living here.

The boat residents died from a disease that spread quickly. Anyone who touches one of the walkers is exposed to the disease (Virulence value 8). If the PCs search the boats, they can find one survivor, Cyndie. She is hiding inside a locker, and she is sick, but her life can be saved if she gets medical attention. Cyndie was once leader of a group living on the east-coast called Oceanside. When she left on an expedition at sea, the boat sank, and she ended up in the Atlanta region. Now she wants to find a way to get back to Oceanside.

- **CYNDIE**, faction leader. **Expert:** Leadership, Survival. **Trained:** Close combat, Mobility, Ranged Combat, Stealth. **Issues:** Will risk everything to protect the weak. Sick and frail. Natural leader. Stands her ground.

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"For the longest time, we were just fighting to survive, trying to get back what we lost. This family, our family, we would do anything to protect each other. And we're fighting now for something else, something bigger. A new beginning. But that comes with a cost. There's always a cost."

Judith Grimes

FACTION ENCOUNTERS AND RUMORS

When the PCs enter a new sector, roll for an encounter as described in Chapter 7 (page 114). If the result is a faction encounter, roll again on the faction encounter table below. If the PCs encounter an NPC, you can roll on the rumor table and let that NPC tell them something about the world.

FACTION ENCOUNTERS

D6	ENCOUNTER
1	Two people from The Reborn are out scavenging.
2	Five members of The Living have found a stash of liquor. They are drunk and standing on the roof throwing Molotov cocktails on walkers for sport.
3	A scared kid named Lisa has run away from the School. She is hiding somewhere, about to die from starvation. Lisa is scared, but if the PCs gain her trust, she will want to go back to rescue her friends.
4	The Reborn have nailed papers with teachings about Father Morgan on the walls all over an abandoned village. All papers are marked with a cross with a capital M on it.
5	Two members of The Living are teaching one of their servants a lesson.
6	A truck filled with supplies has broken down on its way back to the School. If it does not get there, the Council will send out the Security to uncover what happened to it.

RUMORS

D6	RUMOR
1	"The last hope for humanity is a school, not far from here. The teachers have been taking care of hundreds of kids, but they are in desperate need of food, protection, and help. They embrace any newcomers."
2	"There was a person named Jack Morgan who died and did not turn. I saw it myself. The fanatics in his group thought it was a miracle, proving that Morgan was Jesus' Second Coming. If scientists could only get their hands on that corpse, maybe they could create an antidote to whatever has infected us."
3	"People all over the country have started to contact each other over the radio. Many of them are making plans for how to rebuild civilization. I sure would like to find a radio transmitter."
4	"There's a boat settlement on Lake Lanier. I stayed there for a while when I got sick. They took me in, fed me, helped me, and didn't ask for anything in return. If there are good people left on earth, some of them are floating on those boats."
5	"I'm on my way to the Beasley family's farm – one of the biggest around. My parents work there. Do you want to come with me? They're always looking for good workers this time of year."
6	"There is a group of good-hearted Christians called The Reborn. They help anyone in need, and they can hold their own against raiders. When they found me, I was about to die, but they helped me."

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ENDGAME

When you play the campaign, you will come up with an endgame to drive the group towards – possible outcomes that may come true if the PCs fail to notice and/or stop it. Here are two suggestions on possible endgames.

- The School starts trading with The Living, giving them the ammunition they need. But The Living use their weapons to attack the School, burning it to the ground and taking prisoners. This turns The Living into a powerful faction that starts to control more and more of the area, setting up new settlements all over the area.
- The Reborn grow in size, challenging both The Living and the School. More and more believers are drawn to the faith of Father Morgan. The leader of The Reborn murders The Living's leader. This gives the Reborn power over The Living. They use it to attack and defeat the School. The church of Morgan spreads far and wide, gathering people in a belief that a new and better world is coming.

GAME ON!

When the preparations are done, set a scene in the haven. Ask the players what their PCs are doing and introduce the NPC survivors. Let the players describe their PCs and what the haven looks like. Start slowly. Then introduce one or two Challenges. You can choose something from the Challenge list, or pick one from the suggested starting Challenges described in the next section.

At the end of the session, you should ask the questions for Experience Points (page 28). This is also a good time to have the players talk about the game and what they found fun – or not so fun – and what you should do differently next time. Ask them if anyone wants to do a Dearly Departed Monologue at the start of the next session.

If you want, you can do some more GM preparations between sessions. In the following sessions, you should introduce Challenges to make things happen, but remember that you do not have to introduce new ones if the PCs already have things to do and worry about.

STARTING CHALLENGES

DANIEL GONZALEZ HAS BEEN TAKEN

The NPC survivor Daniel leaves the cabin at night, to prove to his mother Alicia that he can take care of himself. But he strays too far and is taken by The Living. Maybe Alicia discovers that he is gone? The PCs can follow Daniel's trail to The Living's haven. Roll a die to see what has happened to him:

1–2	Daniel has joined The Living and urges the other members of the group to do the same.
3–4	Daniel has been killed.
5–6	Daniel is kept as a servant to Nate Miller and is forced to work for food and shelter.

HUNTERS IN THE FOREST

Two members of The Reborn are hunting deer close to the cabin. They have not yet discovered the PCs' cabin, but the PCs can hear their rifle fire. If the PCs do nothing, the hunters will mark this place as a good hunting ground and come back later. If the PCs speak to them, use the Reaction table on page 118.

FOOD SHORTAGE

Someone in the group discovers that a portion of the supplies in the basement has gone foul and is not edible. If the PCs do not find another food source within a couple of days (roll a die to see how many), Capacity will be reduced to zero. This would mean that each PC and NPC is left with a double low number of rations. No more food can be found in the haven.

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THE GOLDEN AMBULANCE

This short survival mode scenario takes place between season 2 and 3 of *The Walking Dead* in a town called Alford Spring, just outside Atlanta. The PCs are part of a group that is falling to pieces. On top of that, many in the group have come down ill with pneumonia. Several people have already died, and many others are dying in the haven. The only hope is to find medicine.

The PCs are the only people well enough to go searching for what the haven needs. They are desperate, as they know their entire group will be wiped out in a couple of days. Just as the scenario starts, the PCs have spotted the back part of an ambulance parked on the top floor of an open four-story parking garage. The reflective metallic paint of the ambulance shines in the hot midmorning sun like gold in the sky above them.

A TRAP

The shining ambulance is, of course, too good to be true. Sure, there is plenty of medicine inside, and the PCs will be able to save their haven if they fetch it. But an NPC named Rachel Pérez has for some time utilized the ambulance to lure people in, then used walkers to kill them before laying claim to their stuff.

What complicates things even more is that a group of scavengers has already entered the garage, found their way to the ambulance, and sprung Rachel's trap. They are hiding inside the ambulance, surrounded by walkers. This group was sent from a town called Woodbury, controlled by the Governor, who figures in season 3 and 4 of *The Walking Dead*. A scout from Woodbury located the ambulance and the Governor sent a team to loot it.

SETUP

All players choose one of the PCs described at the end of the text. If there are fewer than five players, start by handing out PC number 1 and then 2 and so forth. Let the players read their PCs and tell them to not reveal each character's secret. Read the text below out loud and then ask the questions in the sidebar, and have the players discuss them.

Just half a year ago, everything seemed to be working out fine. You managed to get out of Atlanta, and you kept adding both people and resources to your haven. Brandon, your self-appointed leader, was good at making the hard decisions, while still keeping everybody happy. Then something happened. Was it plain bad luck, or did you somehow anger the powers beyond and above?

During a bad rainstorm, the roof collapsed on the haven. The entire plantation was swept away by the water and many in the group caught pneumonia. This would have been easily treated before the outbreak. But not in the world of the dead, where medicine is a rare commodity.

One of the first of many to die in sickbed was Brandon. Many more are extremely ill, and you are about to lose them all. A few have managed to avoid getting sick, or have had the disease and managed to pull though. Those few – you and your friends – have left the haven in search of a miracle.

But where to start looking? The closest drug stores were all plundered. You tried going to the nearest hospital but were surrounded by the dead and had to run for your life. To complicate matters, you have seen signs of another group of people moving around in the area: car tracks, shells from rifles, and brained walkers.

This morning, you woke up in a small community called Alford Spring. As you stepped out into the hot

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SETUP QUESTIONS

- Where did you spend the night?
- What is your haven like and what do you call it?
- Who are the people left behind in the haven?

SETTING THE MOOD

Describe the hot sun that is cooking the PCs, and how its rays are shimmering over every surface, especially around the ambulance. Stress the time factor – people are dying back home. The parking garage is cool and dark, but it also seems wrong, with its emptiness and music coming from above.

midmorning sun and looked up to the sky, you saw something shining like gold on the top floor of a nearby open-wall parking garage: the reflective metallic paint of an ambulance. It could be your salvation, or it could be nothing. But it is the only chance you've got.

THE FIRST SCENE

The PCs are standing in front of a parking garage with a big sign saying "Heavenly Parking." They can hear the faint sound of music coming from the top floor, 70s glam rock. Ask the players to describe their PCs to each other and ask them what they do.

There are plenty of car wrecks on the street. If the PCs look around outside, they will notice that one car is functional, and has gasoline in the tank. This is the car the people from Woodbury came in. If the PCs search it, roll once on the Scavenging table to see what they find. Also, they find a bayonet that has the letters MD carved into the handle.

HEAVENLY PARKING

The parking garage is a gray concrete building without walls. Above the toll gate there is a painting in strong colors of an angel welcoming customers with open arms.

Should the PCs walk in a circle around the garage, they can see that someone has painted the words "*Sniper, stay away*" on a nearby house, on the opposite side of the building. They can also spot a rope ladder hanging on the outside of the garage between the second and the top floor on the north side.

Inside the garage it is quite dark, even though there are no walls. Cars have been left everywhere, some in the middle of the driving lanes. If the PCs take the time, they can scavenge on each floor.

The Threat Level is at 1 as soon as the PCs enter the building: there are roamers lurking in the shadows.

ENTERING THE BUILDING

There are three entrances to the garage: a closed toll gate where cars enter and exit, and two staircases, one in the south and one in the north. When inside, the PCs can use the parking ramp slopes to walk between floors.

The staircases can be used to reach any of the floors, with doors leading into the garage. The elevators in the staircases do not work. On the top floor on both the staircases, the entrance doors to the garage are blocked from inside with debris. It takes the right tools and a Force roll to smash a door open. Whether this is successful or not, the Threat Level is raised by 1.

THE TOLL GATE: A car wreck blocks the entrance and makes it impossible to enter by car. On the asphalt lie two walkers with their heads bashed in. A Medicine roll reveals they were recently killed.

THE SOUTH STAIRCASE: A successful Scout roll reveals marks in the dust showing that someone recently opened the door, took a few steps in, and then turned around and walked out. There is a trip wire trap with a grenade in the staircase (page 72).

THE NORTH STAIRCASE: The staircase is filled with debris all the way to the top. Clearing it well enough to reach the next floor demands a Force roll. Two walkers have been hidden among the debris. A PC clearing the staircase can make a Scout roll to notice them before they attack.

THE GROUND FLOOR

Music can be heard softly from somewhere above in the building. It is a collection of 70s glam rock.

THE FIRST FLOOR

Several cars have crashed into each other; they are blocking the slope to the next floor, and the PCs must climb over them. One of the cars is a military truck. Its windows are dirty on the inside, but it is possible to notice that there is an assault rifle leaning against the passenger seat, and next to it there is a green bag. The doors to the truck are unlocked.

If the PCs open the truck, they will realize it is a trap. The doors are connected to an alarm mine that will go off with a loud bang if the doors are opened. The noise will alert anyone in the parking garage that the PCs are here, and also attract a group of ten walkers (swarm size 1). The Threat Level is immediately raised to 3.

The assault rifle in the car is damaged beyond repair and the green bag is filled with empty tin cans. If the PC who is opening the door to the truck is careful, they can make a Scout roll to notice the trap in time.

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1. Entrance/Exit
2. North Staircase
3. South Staircase
4. Rope Ladder
5. Rachel Perez's Van
6. Wreck with CD-player
7. The Ambulance

THE SECOND FLOOR

On the second floor, someone has rearranged the cars so that they are all placed against the north side of the building. Now, music can be heard clearly from the top floor.

Rachel Pérez – the woman who uses the parking garage as a trap for other survivors – uses the second floor as her home. She has parked the cars so that she can walk along their roofs to avoid walkers.

Right next to the western wall there is a motor caravan; Pérez uses the sunroof to climb in and out of it. Next to the caravan there is a rope ladder hanging from the top floor, hidden from inside the garage by a concrete pillar. She uses the ladder to move swiftly between the floors.

Inside the caravan, the PCs can find 10 rations, five blood-stained backpacks, 2 knives, a machete, two pistols, a shotgun, an axe, and two walkie-talkies without batteries. There are also two bottles of liquor.

RACHEL PÉREZ

If the PCs have made noise in any way, Rachel Pérez is aware of their presence. She will be lying on the roof of the caravan with her sniper rifle, ready to shoot at the PCs as soon as she has a clear line of sight. Pérez

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RACHEL PÉREZ

High school teacher

Expert: Ranged Combat, Stealth

Trained: Mobility, Scout, Close Combat

Issues: It's me against the world

Gear: Sniper rifle, knife, remote control to CD player

does not want anybody to help the people trapped in the ambulance above; she is mostly interested in chasing the PCs away, but will kill them if she can.

Should the PCs corner Pérez, she will climb the rope ladder to the top floor. When she reaches it, she uses her knife to cut the ladder loose, to avoid being followed.

If the PCs have been real quiet, Pérez is not on this floor, but on the top floor keeping an eye on the group trapped in the ambulance.

THE TOP FLOOR

The ambulance is located on the southeastern side of the parking lot. Next to it is a car wreck containing a hidden CD player, controlled by Peréz with a remote. The CD player is playing a collection of 70s glam rock on repeat. A group of 30 walkers (swarm size 3) surrounds the ambulance, trying to break in. If the current Threat Level is 1, it is immediately raised to 2.

Inside the ambulance, four survivors are hiding. They come from the Woodbury community and are led by a man named Ham Burke. For now, they are biding their time.

On the north side of the parking lot, there is a van. From here, it is possible to reach the rope ladder leading to the second floor. If the PCs have not alarmed Rachel Pérez, she is lying on top of the van with her sniper rifle, prepared to fire at the people in the ambulance when they try to break free. If she spots the PCs, she will instead fire at them, trying to draw the walkers' attention in their direction.

HANDLING THE DEAD

If the PCs take care of Rachel Pérez and avoid disturbing the swarm, they may try to lure the walkers away, or in other ways get access to the ambulance. Even if they manage to switch off the CD player, the walkers will still focus on the ambulance, as they know there are humans inside. The PCs might also notice movement inside the ambulance, if they take the time to study it.

Should the PCs rush in, or be noticed by Pérez or the walkers, they must fight for their lives. Pérez fires once every round. Any PC might attack her instead of fighting the swarm. If the PCs seem to be able to win against the dead, the people in the ambulance will rush out to help them.

THE AMBULANCE

The ambulance is packed with medical supplies, with enough medicine to bring back for the entire haven, and more. There is no gasoline in the ambulance, but it is easy to take some from other cars in the parking garage.

WHEN ALL IS DONE

Should the PCs handle Pérez and the walkers, they will have to face the group from Woodbury. Use the Reaction table (page 118) to determine their initial response to the PCs, and roll a double high or low if any result seems more plausible.

The group from Woodbury will under no circumstances let the PCs drive away with the ambulance. If questioned, they say "*Merle will kill us if we return empty-handed*". They would rather die fighting.

With a successful Manipulation roll, they might be persuaded to hand over medicine for 1D6 people. Should negotiations seem to go south, they will make a surprise attack, trying to catch the PCs off guard.

Ham Burke

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AN OFFER TO JOIN: One of the NPC survivors from Woodbury is the hunter Amira Glover. She has secretly been in contact with the PC Jaxson Price, and they know of each other's situation. Glover will propose that the PCs come along to Woodbury and join their community, as she knows that the situation in the PCs' haven is hopeless. She and the others will guarantee the PCs' safety. At least, that's what they are saying...

THE END

The scenario ends when the ambulance leaves the parking garage, or when all PCs are dead.

THE WOODBURY GROUP

The Woodbury group is led by Ham Burke. They have strict orders to bring back the ambulance at any cost.

NAME		EXPERT	TRAINED	ISSUES	GEAR
Ham Burke	Ex-soldier/ drifter	Ranged Combat, Scout	Mobility, Manipulation, Close Combat	Violent and volatile, loyal to Woodbury and the Governor	Pistol, bayonet
Amira Glover	Hunter	Survival, Scout	Ranged Combat, Mobility	Loner, secretly in love with the PC Jaxson Price	Rifle, knife, binoculars
Michael Peterson	Nurse	Medicine	Close Combat	Distrusts anyone who is not from Woodbury, traumatized	Axe, basic medical equipment
Lana Woods	Construction worker	Close Combat, Force	Endure, Ranged Combat	Peaceful and taciturn, loyal to the group	Pistol, sledgehammer

THE PCS

These are the PCs in the scenario:

1. FIONNA RUIZ

The world of the dead is not that strange compared to being homeschooled by a delusional mother in an isolated cabin in Alaska. You have always been different and embraced that. The first person who made the effort to get to know you was Brandon. When the dead started walking, you were about to get married. Instead, he became the leader of your group and you, his sidekick. When Brandon died of pneumonia you decided to take his place, to lead the others.

Archetype: The Outcast

Issue: Self-doubt

Drive: Prove that I am worthy

Strength 3 • Agility 4 • Wits 3 • Empathy 3

Skills: Close Combat 2, Mobility 2, Ranged Combat 2, Stealth 2, Scout 1, Survival 1, Leadership 2

Talent: Knows all the tricks

Anchor: Jaxson Price

Gear: Backpack with bag of rice (2 rations), field kitchen, flashlight, book about beekeeping

Weapons: Knife, revolver

Secret: Before Brandon died, he made you swear on his memory that you would save the rest of the group – all of them.

2. JAXSON PRICE

Your long-gone dream was to raise alpacas, not for the fur or the meat, but to offer people to come pat them, walk with them, and be healed by the closeness to the wild. Being a vegetarian while growing up on a farm meant constant harassment by your father and your brothers. Now you wish they were here so you could say they were right: life is about eating or being eaten.

Your role in the group has always been about food: growing stuff or hunting in the woods. You prefer going on long runs alone, as it lets you give in to your not-so secret sin: drinking alcohol whenever and wherever you can.

Archetype: The Farmer

Issue: Alcoholic

Drive: Find a way to survive

Strength 4 • Agility 4 • Wits 3 • Empathy 2

Skills: Close Combat 1, Endure 1, Force 2, Mobility 1, Ranged Combat 2, Stealth 1, Scout 2, Survival 1, Tech 1

Talent: Tough as nails

Anchor: Kalani Clark

Gear: Backpack with tent, sleeping bag, dried meat (2 rations), binoculars, gloves, fur hat, plastic bag with assorted seeds, screwdriver, hammer, 2 cans of beer, pack of cigarettes, lighter

Weapons: Hammer, rifle, knife

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Secret: While out on your own you met another survivor named Amira Glover, also a hunter. She claimed to be part of a group living in a community called Woodbury. You secretly met up on several occasions and told each other pretty much everything about your current lives. She thinks you and the others should come join Woodbury and you have started thinking that it may be the only way to survive. Also, she seems to fancy you, but you don't know what to do about it.

3. KALANI CLARK

The day you and your kid sister Kaia decided to forget everything about the old world – your parents, your dog Isaac, and even your older brother Zac – was the day you were born again, and you started to thrive here with the dead. You loathe how the old ones cry in their sleep, longing for things that will never come back. With Jaxson it is different, of course, as he takes care of Kaia when you are not around. And when Kaia started coughing, it was he who comforted you.

Archetype: The Kid

Issue: Makes rash decisions when stressed

Drive: Save my sister

Strength 3 • Agility 5 • Wits 2 • Empathy 3

Skills: Close Combat 1, Mobility 3, Ranged Combat 1, Stealth 1, Scout 2, Manipulation 2, Medicine 2

Talent: A child of this world

Anchor: Jaxson Price

Gear: Backpack with bread (1 ration), flashlight, photo of my family, pack of cigarettes and a lighter

Weapons: Knife, pistol

Secret: You don't give a damn about any of the others – all you want is to save your sister. When she is well enough to travel, you plan to take everything you can from the haven and head out on your own.

4. LUKA WOODS

Early on you grasped that it was easier and more profitable to sell lies than the dictionaries your father hauled from door to door. And you almost made it all the way to work for the mayor of Atlanta, had it not been for those false accusations of corruption. You were one of the last to join this group, after your old traveling companions were eaten. The haven was in a bad state even before the rainstorm and the disease. If the group wants to, you are ready to help them with your leadership skills. But for now, they turn to Fionna for guidance.

Archetype: The Politician

Issue: Bad temper

Drive: Gaining power and influence

Strength 2 • Agility 3 • Wits 4 • Empathy 4

Skills: Close Combat 1, Mobility 1, Stealth 1, Scout 2, Tech 1, Leadership 2, Manipulation 3, Medicine 1

Talent: Right word at the right time

Anchor: Grace Hoffman

Gear: Backpack with bottle of water, grilled hen (2 rations), flare rocket, sleeping bag, bottle of scotch, diary

Weapons: Hammer

Secret: It was you who sabotaged the roof of the haven so that it collapsed in the rainstorm – only to prove what a rotten leader Brandon was. You did not intend for anybody to die. Now you are determined to save all the sick people in the haven and use your eminent leadership skills to make the group strong again. But first you must make Fionna step aside as a leader, willingly or by force.

5. GRACE HOFFMAN

When a knee injury put an end to your Olympic dreams, you for some reason thought that being an athlete would make you a good police officer. It turned out the job was more about talking to people than being physically strong and agile. In the group, you have used the little knowledge you have about medicine to wrap bandages, but when people fell ill with pneumonia, there was nothing you could do. You miss Brandon, who was a great leader, and you are not sure Fionna can take his place. Lately, you and Luka Woods have become close.

Archetype: The Law Enforcer

Issue: Shy

Drive: To feel safe again

Strength 4 • Agility 4 • Wits 3 • Empathy 2

Skills: Close Combat 2, Force 2, Mobility 1, Ranged Combat 2, Stealth 2, Scout 2, Medicine 1

Talent: Steady hands

Anchor: Luka Woods

Gear: Backpack with sleeping bag, jar with potatoes (1 ration), sunglasses, chewing gums, flashlight, handcuffs.

Weapons: Pistol, knife

Secret: With the little you know about medicine you are certain that there is not a chance in the world anyone is still alive back in the haven. But you are afraid that if you tell the others, they will panic. On the other hand, you don't want them to take unnecessary risks. If only you could find a way forward, to save what you have and make the group stay together.

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APPENDIX

WALKERS

The following two tables can be combined to quickly come up with a walker that is both a relatable human being and a grotesque reminder of what might happen to the PCs after they die – in the form of wounds, decay, and missing body parts. Roll once on each table.

WALKER PAST

D66	THE WALKER'S PAST
11	Hippie professor
12	Child with toy
13	Punk rocker
14	Car salesperson
15	Kindergarten teacher
16	Asylum patient
21	Computer nerd
22	UFO enthusiast
23	Granny
24	Politician
25	Police officer
26	Cult member
31	Hunter
32	Carpenter
33	Nanny
34	Goth teenager
35	Sports fanatic
36	Wine snob
41	Homeless person
42	Old rocker
43	Addict
44	Janitor
45	Waiter
46	Priest
51	Pizza delivery person
52	Garbage collector
53	Celebrity
54	Postman
55	Journalist
56	Soldier
61	Child with tiara
62	Gangster
63	Teenager with braces
64	Doomsday preacher
65	Eccentric spinster
66	Truck driver

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WALKER WOUNDS

D66	THE WALKER'S WOUNDS
11	Arm torn from the body
12	Hole in gut, intestines hanging out
13	Eye eaten by birds
14	One foot dangling by a sinewy thread
15	Open skull, with brains showing
16	Parts of abdomen eaten
21	Hanging flesh on throat
22	Gun wounds all over upper body
23	Handcuffs attached to one arm and knife slashes across the face
24	Spear wounds on the legs
25	Shotgun wound in the chest
26	Neck broken
31	Nose and lips bitten off
32	Rotten and almost falling apart
33	Dried up body, skeleton visible through the skin
34	Covered in open sores
35	Bloated and swollen like a balloon
36	No arms
41	No lower jaw
42	Almost torn apart, body about to collapse
43	Arrow through the throat
44	Burnt by electricity
45	Many knife wounds
46	Rotten bandages
51	Skin eaten from the face
52	One hand missing
53	No hair, no teeth, only skin and bone
54	Skin cooked by hot water
55	Moldy and filled with maggots
56	Half-burnt
61	Broken spear sticking out of the body
62	Body crushed
63	Newly drowned
64	Meat missing from the back and the neck (looks alright from the front)
65	Hands tied up, shot through the chest
66	Died in sickbed, infusion drip still attached

EMPTY ROOMS

ROOM FLAVOR

When the PCs enter a room or a hideout where there are no NPCs or walkers, you can roll on the following table to give it some flavor.

D66	CONTENTS
11	A shrine devoted to death and destruction.
12	Several defeated walkers.
13	Valuables stolen from people: wristwatches, necklaces, golden rings, wallets.
14	Friendly kittens.
15	Kettle with boiling water on a fireplace.
16	Writing on the wall: "The sun will burn them all. I am the sun."
21	A baby, starving and sick.
22	Walker hanging from the roof.
23	A hidden room with a collection of walker parts in preservation jars.
24	Survival instructions inscribed in pictures and words all over the walls.
25	Roof and floor damaged by water, dangerous to walk on.
26	Writing on the wall: "Get out or get dead, last warning!"
31	Empty tents and backpacks.
32	Signs of a deadly shootout.
33	Spear traps. A walker stuck in one of them.
34	Cradle with half-filled bottle, its contents green.
35	Furniture stacked to block out walkers.
36	Writing on the wall: "No hope, no hope, no hope."
41	Walker chained to a bed, signs of failed suicide.

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D66	CONTENTS
42	Rats. Roaches. Other crawling things.
43	Bushes growing indoors, getting sun and water from a crack in the roof.
44	Heap of cigarette butts in front of a chair. Smell of cologne in the air.
45	Several maps on the floor, places marked on them with signs in ink.
46	Writing on the wall: "The infection is in your head: the dead you see are living!"
51	Hole in the wall, after an explosion.
52	Empty backpack in the middle of the floor, dried blood on one wall.
53	All entries blocked, chess-game placed on a table, black is winning.
54	Several stuffed animals.
55	Everything burnt, black and gray ash.
56	Writing on the wall: "Meet me at the old place."
61	Dead walkers placed to form a pentagram on the floor.
62	Miniature laboratory, someone's been examining samples of human blood.
63	Diary where a man named Mike wrote about the outbreak and everything that happened up until yesterday.
64	Broken home-made moonshine still.
65	Backpacks nailed to the walls, bloodstained and dirty.
66	Writing on the wall: "Come to the Bird's Nest, safety for all. Let's build a new world!"

RANDOM LOCATIONS

LOCATIONS

When you need a location, use the table below. First roll a D66 to generate a building, and then a D6 for what can be found inside.

D66	LOCATION	D6: 1–2	3–4	5–6
11	Hospital	Filled with walkers, but a group of survivors has a base on the top floor with fully functional medical equipment.	Lots of medical equipment, but also a lot of walkers that are locked in here.	Everything taken, helicopter on the roof. Not much fuel.
12	School	Stash with food in the basement (30 rations). Single walker.	Big gathering of teens, formerly an orchestra, turned into walkers.	Kids hiding in the ventilation shafts, undead teachers in the corridors.
13	Gym	Remnants of a meth lab. Five walkers who were killed when the lab exploded.	Young child hiding on the top floor.	Bodybuilder walkers.
14	Decrepit Building	Former gang with a base on the third floor. They use dead police officers in chains as protection on the first floor.	A grand battle took place here; the living did not win.	A cult devoted to a new god is staying on the top floor. Their symbol, a watching eye, can be seen spray-painted everywhere in the neighborhood.
15	Water Tower	Secret stash with gasoline.	Lone survivor who is about to die from a disease.	Someone has hidden a radio transmitter run by a solar panel, and a book with codes for sending messages.

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D66	LOCATION	D6: 1–2	3–4	5–6
16	Water Park	Cans of food in the old stalls, but walkers everywhere.	Abandoned camp at the top of the water slide.	Walkers trapped in the pools, decomposing.
21	Grocery Store	Pack of wild dogs has made this their home.	Supplies remain, also fresh tire marks from a car that was parked outside.	Owner hides in the loft, kills and eats those who try to plunder the store.
22	Factory	Dead workers everywhere, spray-painted arrows leading to the manager who has barricaded himself in his office. He will hide the fact that he is already bitten.	Quiet and empty, room filled with workers who took their own lives together.	Soldiers made their last stand here. Some guns, grenades, and bottles of liquor. All soldiers are walkers.
23	Bus Station	Someone has hidden a grenade launcher in one of the buses that is surrounded by walkers. The bus is marked with a red X.	A woman and her child have locked themselves in. They climb in and out through a hatch in the roof.	Fully functional bus. Door locked, but the bus driver with the keys is walking among the other dead.
24	Office Building	Part of the building has burned. Remnants of a camp on the fourth floor. Hidden emergency bags.	Death came in the middle of a launch party for a new computer game.	Someone is using a meeting room as a lab to produce napalm. At the moment they are not here, but they will soon arrive in a fully functional jeep.
25	Suburban Family House	A number of families are hiding here, too scared to leave, but with almost no food left.	Rats everywhere, and the dead are chasing them.	Someone has left the stereo on, and the dead are gathering around the house. Electricity comes from a fully functional wind power station on the roof.
26	Hotel	Lots of food in the basement, but the ground floor is swarming with the dead.	Parts of the hotel have been bombed. Animals and plants everywhere.	A wedding party was held here when death came. Some of the guests survived.
31	Prison	Parts of the building have been torn down. Well protected buildings, filled with dead prisoners.	Prisoners run this place, as a new faction in the campaign.	Empty and quiet. The prisoners were put into buses to be transported to some place. But they only made it to the gates. Several buses with dead prisoners, chained to their seats.
32	Farm	Fully functional base. Two teenagers are the only survivors. They hide from strangers.	Someone has attacked this place, killed everything, and destroyed anything useful. Foul words are spray-painted on the walls in all rooms.	Some supplies in the main house, two starving horses in the stable. The door to the house is booby trapped with a grenade.
33	Police Station	Janitor still alive, dressed up as police officer and armed to the teeth.	Everything taken, and someone has locked a starving survivor in one of the cells.	Filled with walkers, but also with supplies – and there is even a working back-up generator with fuel for two months, powering functional showers.
34	Church	Local groups of survivors meet here once a month to trade and discuss.	The dead are dormant on the benches, while the rotting priest walks around aimlessly.	A group of survivors was brutally executed here, not long ago; there may still be supplies in their packs.

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D66	LOCATION	D6: 1–2	3–4	5–6
35	Tattoo Studio	The forced laborers from a nearby enclave are taken here to get their mark.	A lone walker covered in ink.	Hidden supplies (20 rations of food, basic medical gear, five rifles and ammunition).
36	Shopping Mall	Remnants of a large group of survivors who hid here right after the outbreak. Many of them are now corpses.	Gang runs this place, drives around on motorbikes inside the mall (which is filled with the dead). They have secured parts of the second floor.	Young clerk from a clothing store still lives here, sneaking around, scavenging from the stores. Armed with a bow and arrows.
41	Green-house	A walker entwined by vines can't get loose. Lots of potato plants.	Large quantities of pesticides that can be used to create explosives.	Lots of plants and seeds (tomatoes, cucumber, beans, etc.).
42	Karate Club	The club's members hid here, until the dead broke in and overwhelmed them.	This place was locked when the outbreak started and has not been opened since then.	Someone has cut off the limbs of many walkers, without killing them. The dismembered bodies are crawling around on the floor.
43	Train Station	A fully functional diesel locomotive with fuel.	The military tried to protect this place, encircling it with sandbags and cars to block the way. But it was in vain. Guns and grenades can be collected from the walking corpses.	A freight train with lots of gasoline and building materials of all sorts. Walkers everywhere, and someone has marked the train cars with spray-paint: "Property of the Wolf Pack."
44	Stadium	Farmland with plants ready to be harvested, water collectors, beds under roofs, and other proof of people living here. But not a soul can be found.	A satellite has fallen from the sky and devastated half of the stadium. There are still functional electronic components on the satellite, which can be harvested and used.	Athletes turned into walkers. Lots of protein bars, sports drinks, and basic medical gear strewn about.
45	Rock Club	The fans ate the band.	Someone has prepared and placed 40 Molotov cocktails in a line on the bar.	There is a fully functional and custom-made motorcycle hanging from the roof as decoration. Dead band members roam the dance floor.
46	High-rise Building	Survivors have installed a system with ropes and swings on the facade which they use as elevators, lifting and lowering goods and people past the floors filled with walkers.	Hundreds of people were locked into the building, and a massive swarm will burst out if the doors are opened. A rumor (falsely) claims there is a treasure hidden in the building.	Two snipers use the building to kill survivors from a distance while their comrade on the ground takes whatever the survivors were carrying.
51	Kinder-garten	The kids are not alright.	A teacher with a group of kids. They have set up traps for hunting rats and birds, and they grow carrots and potatoes in buckets on the roof.	A group of teenagers are taking care of some younger kids. They have all turned into thieves and murderers to survive. Can they be saved?

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D66	LOCATION	D6: 1–2	3–4	5–6
52	Scientific Installation	Advanced technical equipment, radio station, back-up generator with fuel for (double low dice roll) number of months. Functional showers and lots of canned food. Also, lots of walkers hanging around.	A scientist with an idea on how to stop the dead from reanimating. He only needs some help finding the right tools, electricity, and a functional lab.	Seemingly an ordinary lab working for the local hospital. But there is a hidden entrance to an underground high security lab where scientists have been studying lethal diseases for chemical warfare. One scientist is still alive. She is paranoid and prepared to use diseases as a weapon.
53	Bomb Shelter	Some canned goods, two revolvers, and an undead head with chattering teeth in a fishbowl.	Several walkers and spray--painted instructions on the wall, describing the way to a safe zone.	Someone has installed advanced medical gear here.
54	Graveyard	Dead trying to claw their way out of their graves.	A newly built altar to a death god, with plenty of offerings (canned goods, gasoline, weapons, and water jugs). The Death Angels will become highly displeased if anyone steals from the Corpse Master's altar.	A naked man who is obsessed with killing the walkers and burying them.
55	Radio Station	Transmissions from what claims to be a peaceful haven.	A stereo is playing rock music extremely loud, which has made walkers surround it. But there is no one to be found inside. Lots of technical equipment.	The last radio station in this part of the world is kept going by two stubborn women in need of everything: food, weapons, medicine, hope.
56	Home for the Elderly	No one has searched this place, as it is swarming with the dead, and the food storage has remained full since before the outbreak.	The staff is still taking care of the elderly, but some of them have been chained to their beds, as they are about to die.	Empty, except for a lone survivor hiding in a broom closet. He claims that he started the apocalypse.
61	Movie Theater	Someone installed solar panels on the roof, and the cinema is fully functional. Also filled with fresh walkers.	The cinema was turned into a post-outbreak information center. Here are recordings from scientists and journalists from all over the country, talking about what is happening, and what the government was trying to do. Perfect place to find information on... whatever.	Young boy living in the room with the projector. Everything is broken, but the boy claims that he is waiting for his family, who is out on a run to find food.
62	Storage Facility	Someone let a wild animal in here.	Still some good stuff left, and walkers.	A hostile faction uses this as a storage facility. There is an alarm system, warning them when someone breaks in. Also a trap, using walkers.

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D66	LOCATION	D6: 1–2	3–4	5–6
63	Gas Station	A gigantic explosion destroyed everything.	A gathering of cars, still some gas left, and a young walker girl never far from her teddy bear.	Someone left provisions on the roof. Unfortunately, the roof has been badly damaged by water, and it will not sustain the weight of an adult. And there are walkers in the store underneath.
64	Bridge	Someone closed off both ends by dumping big piles of gravel. In between them there are remnants of a camp and some walkers.	An abandoned outpost for the military, with a functional machine gun.	A helicopter crashed into it, and it is about to fall apart. A single person may walk over, one at a time. If the walkers close by are alerted, they will swarm the bridge and make it fall apart.
65	Library	Someone collected a big pile of useful books for surviving in the land of the dead, and then just left it here for some reason.	Gathering of librarians who stayed here when the world died, and now they are also dead.	White flags from the window, and sprayed peace signs on the outer walls. Inside it is full of booby traps with spears that have been set off, and walkers are stuck in them.
66	Museum	Lots of good stuff for survivors, also a hundred walkers in the basement, and the doors to the staircase are gone on all floors. Any sound, and the dead will come swarming up.	Exhibition about death, mummies, and historical death cults.	Notes about the need for collaboration when building a new world. A specific time when one should be here to be contacted.

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NON-PLAYER CHARACTERS

You can use the following tables to randomly decide the appearance, skills, Issues, secret Issues, and gear of a NPC.

NPC FEATURES

D66	FEATURE
11	Cowboy hat
12	High-pitched voice
13	Scarred face
14	Unicorn tattoo
15	Irritating laughter
16	Thousand-yard stare
21	Amputated body part
22	Clothes in bright colors
23	Braids
24	Piercings all over
25	Suit and tie
26	Big beard or hair
31	Extremely tall
32	Bathing shorts
33	Cute, child-like face
34	Intense eyes
35	Dressed in rags
36	Skin covered by blisters
41	Barefoot
42	Dressed in sheets
43	Uniform
44	Many golden rings and necklaces
45	Sunglasses
46	Dressed in spandex
51	Missing an ear, the nose, or the lips
52	Hair in many colors
53	Burn-marked
54	T-shirt with smiley face
55	Leather jacket
56	Jump-suit
61	Canadian tuxedo
62	Dressed in furs
63	Dressed in black
64	Helmet, wrist guards, elbow and knee pads
65	Barcode tattooed on the neck
66	Vest with wings on the back

NPC ISSUES

D66	ISSUE
11	Coward
12	Never gives up
13	Seeks affirmation
14	Wants to be the leader
15	Always on the lookout for trouble
16	Never stops talking
21	Depressed
22	Angry
23	Easily insulted
24	Alcoholic
25	Always hungry
26	Bully
31	Takes what they want
32	Religious
33	Bountiful
34	Cold-hearted
35	Obsessed with music
36	Sacrifices anything to survive
41	Laughs at the world
42	Weirdo
43	Falls in love easily
44	Trusts no one
45	Hearing impaired
46	Criminal past
51	Pacifist
52	Cares only for their child/friend/sibling
53	Wants to build a new world
54	Expects the worst from all
55	Easily freaks out
56	Loner
61	Wants to do what is right
62	Likes to gossip
63	Terminal illness
64	Show-off
65	Doesn't follow rules
66	Questions the leader

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NPC SECRET ISSUES

D66	SECRET ISSUE
11	Suicidal
12	Murderous
13	Drug addict
14	Keeps their brother/sister/family/friend locked up somewhere
15	Worships the dead
16	Wants to kill someone
21	Madly in love with someone who does not feel the same
22	Psychopath
23	Wants to see the world burn
24	Punishes themself
25	Hears commanding voices
26	Traumatized
31	Loves to fight
32	Traitor
33	Compulsive liar
34	Secret plan
35	Wants someone/something in the group
36	Lies about everything
41	Pretends to be skilled
42	Lies about the atrocities they committed
43	Spreads rumors to gain power
44	Secretly works for another faction
45	Pyromaniac
46	Murders their opponents
51	Does not remember their true identity
52	Lies about what they know
53	Keeps a dead relative as a pet
54	Has trained their kids to kill, steal, and lie
55	Cannibal
56	Believes the dead are a punishment from God
61	Thief
62	Likes to torment opponents
63	Knows about secret tunnels filled with resources
64	Has been bitten
65	Has a contagious disease
66	Drugs people and takes their gear or imprisons them

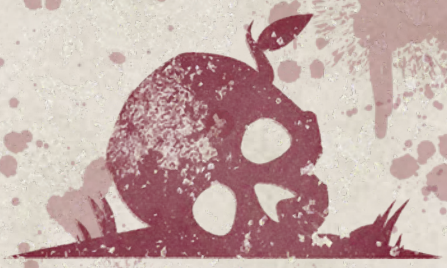
NPC SKILLS

Roll to determine the number of trained and expert skills:

D6	TRAINED	EXPERT
1	0	0
2	1	0
3	2	0
4	1	1
5	2	1
6	3	2

NPC GEAR

D6	GEAR
1	Nothing
2	Knife and one ration
3	Melee weapon, D6 rations and one item (for example: binoculars, tent, or bicycle)
4	Ranged weapon, knife, D6 rations, some survival equipment
5	Ranged weapon, melee weapon, D6 rations, useful equipment
6	Ranged weapon, ten rations, a car/motorcycle, useful equipment



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SCAVENGING

When a PC successfully scavenges (page 54), the player rolls once on the table below to see what they find. Each extra success adds one ration.

SCAVENGING

D666	FIND
111	Toothbrush, barely used
112	Photo album. A former president appears on one photo
113	Celebrity autograph
114	Diary written in Spanish by a girl named Leticia who really craves panocha
115	Toy soldier
116	Several books on the 1944 Warsaw uprising
121	Pack of candles
122	CD, a one-hit wonder's Greatest Hits
123	Amnesty report about the harassment of an ethnic minority, printed on loose papers
124	Bag filled with gold and jewels
125	Funny hat
126	Hand-made replica of a UFO
131	Well-made crucifix
132	Still functional wristwatch
133	Hijabs in many colors
134	Ten potato plants, need watering
135	Bucket with unsorted batteries
136	Accordion
141	Parrot named James (would really like a cracker)
142	Box with fireworks
143	Camera
144	Binoculars
145	Frightened puppy
146	Cutlery bearing the Illuminati eye
151	Great boots
152	Harmonica
153	Sleeping bag
154	Spirit stove
155	Set with twenty different spices
156	Clean towels
161	Shirts and pants
162	Clean and dry socks
163	Umbrella
164	Warm clothes
165	Shovel
166	Flashlight
211	Canned goods, baked beans (one ration)
212	Candy and orange soda (one ration)
213	Grilled hamster (one ration)
214	Canned goods, mild tomatoes and green chilies (one ration)
215	Canned goods, chicken broth (one ration)
216	Canned goods, bell peppers in oil (one ration)
221	Canned goods, spaghetti meatballs (one ration)
222	Can opener
223	Canned goods, pork and beans (one ration)
224	Canned goods, beef and beans (one ration)
225	Canned goods, tuna in water (one ration)
226	Canned goods, tuna in oil (one ration)
231	Canned goods, ravioli (one ration)
232	Knife sharpener
233	Ketchup bottle (one ration)
234	Canned goods, chicken soup (one ration)
235	Canned goods, tomato soup (one ration)
236	Canned goods, chicken noodle soup (one ration)
241	Pickled cucumbers (one ration)
242	Fried green tomatoes (one ration)
243	Cooked beans (one ration)
244	Pickled eggs (one ration)
245	Pickled jalapenos (one ration)
246	Small bag with walnuts (one ration)
251	Water bottle and two rusks (one ration)
252	Dried meat (one ration)
253	Bag of flavored popcorn, sour cream and onion (one ration)
254	Canned goods, kidney beans (one ration)
255	Bag with raisins and a cola bottle (one ration)
256	Jar with baby food, risotto with turkey & vegetables (one ration)

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D666	FIND
261	Dog food, chicken & barley (one ration)
262	Cat food, salmon in jelly (one ration)
263	Moldy sandwiches, peanut butter & raspberry jam (one ration)
264	Bottle of porridge (one ration)
265	Food powder, mashed potatoes (one ration)
266	Dried banana and nuts (one ration)
311	Candy stash (one ration)
312	Kitten on a stick (one ration)
313	Rice bag and water jugs (ten rations)
314	Fake mustache
315	Baby porridge (one ration)
316	Goldfish in a water jar (one ration)
321	Box with twenty bags of chips, sea salt & vinegar (four rations)
322	Dried meat, rat (one ration)
323	Bag with dead birds (one ration)
324	Rice and nuts (two rations)
325	Tomatoes, cucumber, and paprika (one ration)
326	Living worms in a bag filled with dirt (one ration)
331	Smoked snake meat (two rations)
332	Assault rifle
333	Big pack cereals (one ration)
334	Dried fruit and six-pack cider cans (two rations)
335	Whiskey bottle and freeze-dried taco stew (two rations)
336	Freeze-dried beef and pasta in marinara (two rations)
341	Freeze-dried hamburgers, and cola bottles (two rations)
342	Cheese (one ration)
343	Rice and curry (two rations)
344	Potatoes and water (three rations)
345	Pasta and cold coffee (one ration)
346	Assorted root vegetables (two rations)
351	Ten firework rockets
352	Rice and cookies (two rations)
353	Pasta and sparkling water (one ration)
354	Carrots, a goat head, and bottles of beer (two rations)
355	Egg and ham (one ration)

D666	FIND
356	Revolver
361	Bag of rice and water (three rations)
362	Biscuits and gravy (one ration)
363	Mac and cheese in a plastic container, smells funky (one ration)
364	Collard greens and fried bacon (one ration)
365	Corn pudding (one ration)
366	Protein bars and a bottle of wine (one ration)
411	Sports bag filled with potatoes and carrots (three rations)
412	Toolbox
413	Spear
414	Dried meat, pork (two rations)
415	Smoked meat, elk (ten rations)
416	Smoked meat, beaver (three rations)
421	Salted meat, pork (two rations)
422	Salted meat, cow (three rations)
423	Freeze-dried meat and vegetables and a bottle of rum (two rations)
424	Powdered milk (one ration)
425	Powdered eggs (one ration)
426	Big jar of honey (one ration)
431	Lime sauce (one ration)
432	Package of couscous and a smoked ham (two rations)
433	Knife
434	Plastic bags filled with moldy bread (two rations)
435	Packages of instant noodles and water bottles (two rations)
436	Chocolate Santa and a thermos with cold mulled wine (one ration)
441	Ice tea and cornbread (one ration)
442	Bag with pieces of raw meat and a bottle of moonshine (two rations)
443	Two dead doves and a water bottle (one ration)
444	Apple pie and a bottle of milk (one ration)
445	Chili and water bottle (one ration)
446	Tater tots and a bottle of lemonade (one ration)
451	Bag with fruit (two rations)
452	Goat cheese and goat milk (two rations)
453	Gumbo and a water jug (three rations)
454	Plastic bag with grits (two rations)

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D666	FIND
455	Roots vegetables and a bottle of grape juice (two rations)
456	Pistol
461	Salted bird meat (one ration)
462	Newly killed goose (six rations)
463	Slices of smoked meat, tastes funny (one ration)
464	Plastic jar with fox meat (two ration)
465	Assorted frogs, snakes, and lizards (one ration)
466	Half horse, smoked (14 rations)
511	Rifle
512	Shotgun
513	Canned goods, chicken noodle soup (one ration)
514	Basic medical gear
515	Tent
516	Gas can (full)
521	Submachine gun
522	Canned goods (four rations)
523	Baseball bat with barbed wire
524	Bicycle
525	Egg and milk (one ration)
526	Molotov cocktail
531	Smoked snake meat and a beer (one ration)
532	Bow and arrows
533	Walkie-talkies with batteries
534	Hand grenade
535	Throwing knife
536	Squirrel meat and water (one ration)
541	Sword
542	Bag with lighters
543	Five signal flares
544	Basic medical gear
545	Warm clothes
546	Sledgehammer
551	Jug with soup (two rations)
552	Big axe
553	Matchbox
554	Rain clothes
555	Big tarp and rope
556	Soap
561	Bottle of lighter fuel

D666	FIND
562	Boots
563	Friendly dog
564	Compass
565	Bread and water (two rations)
566	Crowbar
611	Small solar panel
612	Camouflage clothes
613	Hockey equipment
614	Hammer
615	Windable pocket lamp
616	Mosquito repellent
621	Sunscreen
622	Fish (two rations)
623	Mosquito net
624	Windable radio
625	Equipment for amateur radio station
626	Air balloon
631	Pills for water purifying
632	Medicine stash
633	Light flares
634	Revolver
635	Video camera with batteries
636	Chainsaw
641	Hang glider
642	Net for fishing
643	Potatoes (three rations)
644	Survivalist books
645	Megaphone
646	Walker-skin dress
651	Spray paint
652	Stiletto
653	Smoke grenades
654	Body-armor
655	Handcuffs
656	Smoked deer meat (ten rations)
661	Crossbow
662	Collection of seeds
663	Metal-plated armor
664	Sniper rifle
665	Advanced medical gear
666	Instructions on where to find a storehouse filled with canned goods (could be a trap...)

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SOLO PLAY

What you'll find in this chapter are a set of guidelines, procedures, tables, and advice to help you play *The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game* without a GM. These rules are written assuming you will be playing alone, but they can also be used with one or more friends where the role of GM is ignored. They can even be used by a GM in a traditional game with a focus on improvisation and "zero-prep" play.

THE CHALLENGE SHEET

Solo play introduces a Challenge Sheet in addition to the Character and Haven Sheets. This has been designed to help the solo player keep track of important plot points such as NPCs, factions, Issues, rumors, Challenges, and the endgame. You can find the Challenge Sheet at the back of the book.

STARTING SITUATION

Just as in a GM-led game, you will be starting in a newly-established Haven. However, to make it more suitable for solo play, it is recommended that you and your Companion (more on this later) have been newly accepted into the Haven – you're safe, but the others don't fully trust you yet. It is also important that both you and the survivors in your Haven are not familiar with your surroundings. This will create a feeling of desperation in the Haven and instill a pressing need to explore, scavenge, and make allies.

CREATING YOUR SOLO SURVIVOR

TWEAKING CHARACTER CREATION

Playing a sole survivor can be very dangerous; much more dangerous than playing with multiple PCs. As such, it is recommended that you create your survivor with the following tweaks:

- **Start with 14 starting skill points** instead of 12.
- **Take a second free talent.** Solo recommendations: Lone Wolf, Nine Lives, and Unbreakable.
- After rolling for your starting gear, **give yourself a knife** if you don't already have a melee weapon.
- Assign your Anchors to the NPCs in your Haven.

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PLAYING YOURSELF

You can up the personal stakes in your game by creating a fictional version of yourself. Use the guidelines in the *No Archetype?* sidebar (page 24) to build yourself as a PC. Imagine how you might have developed in the months or years following the outbreak and build your PC accordingly.

But don't forget that this is an extremely deadly game; the death of your PC is a very real possibility. You might feel that such an event is a "game over" state when playing yourself. However, consider instead your legacy and continue playing with your Companion or one of the other NPCs in your Haven as a new PC.

COMPANION

Have one person in the Haven be someone you have a close tie to, a fellow survivor who arrived to the Haven with you. This Companion will not only help you to survive, but will also give additional vectors into the drama in your Haven. However, playing with two full PCs can hamper the solo experience, so focus on your "Main PC" and give your Companion a supporting role in your story.

In terms of rules for Companions, they should be statted up as an NPC alongside the other NPCs in your Haven, and are considered an NPC when it comes to the rules. If your Main PC dies, you can upgrade your Companion to replace the deceased Main PC. At that point, give them a fresh character sheet and expand their stats into a full PC, using the tweaks in the previous section.

Considering they will have just lost a close friend (your newly-deceased Main PC), they may not have one or both Anchors when you start playing them. That's fine; look for opportunities to create Anchors as you play them in the aftermath of your previous Main PC's death.

ADVANCEMENT

When asking XP questions (page 28) at the end of a "solo session", do not award a point of XP for participating in the session.

SOLO TOOLS

There are three main tools you will be using during solo play – the Luck Oracle, the Theme Oracle, and the Messing Up Oracle. Just as in other solo roleplaying games, these oracles are used to randomly determine answers to questions or to provide further information on a topic.

THE LUCK ORACLE

Questions will arise in your game that may be hard to answer – questions typically asked of a GM. This is where the Luck Oracle comes into play. Phrase it as a yes / no question. If there is an obvious answer or if your gut is telling you something, go with that instead of rolling. Otherwise, determine the odds:

- If you're not sure of the odds or they're 50/50, simply roll one die.
- If the odds of getting a "Yes" are Likely, roll double high.
- If the odds of getting a "Yes" are Unlikely, roll double low.

LUCK ORACLE

D6	ANSWER
1	Extreme no
2–3	No
4–5	Yes
6	Extreme yes

EXPANDING THE LUCKY DIE

The Lucky Die can be used instead of the Luck Oracle, sometimes even in place of skill tests. Here are some examples where the Lucky Die could be used in solo play:

- **Sneaking a group past some walkers.** Instead of rolling group Stealth, make a Lucky Die roll:
  - If you roll equal to or under the number of people in your group, you are seen.
  - For groups of six or more characters, a result of 6 is always a success.
- **Being shot at by an NPC** – roll the Lucky Die based on your distance. You are shot on a result of:
  - Extreme range: 1
  - Long range: 1–3
  - Short range: 1–4
  - Point-Blank: 1–5

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THE THEME ORACLE

Sometimes you may need to make sense of a situation. Perhaps you need more detail about a location, a person, or some other idea. Whenever you are stuck in this way, roll a D666 on the oracle below. Use the hundreds die to determine which column to use and the D66 result to determine the row. If the result is not clear, roll a second time and either use the new result or treat it as a minor theme alongside the first.

THEME ORACLE

D66	THEME 1	THEME 2	THEME 3	THEME 4	THEME 5	THEME 6
11–12	Abandonment	Estrangement	Obsession	Alliance	Equality	Preparation
13–14	Anguish	Exhaustion	Oppression	Altruism	Exploration	Progress
15–16	Attack	Extermination	Paranoia	Assistance	Faith	Protection
21–22	Betrayal	Fear	Raid	Bravery	Forgiveness	Redemption
23–24	Brutality	Grief	Rampage	Celebration	Freedom	Refuge
25–26	Cannibalism	Hostility	Rebellion	Charity	Generosity	Renewal
31–32	Carnage	Hunger	Reckoning	Community	Healing	Renovation
33–34	Catastrophe	Imprisonment	Remorse	Companionship	Hope	Resilience
35–36	Chaos	Infection	Sabotage	Compassion	Hygiene	Scavenging
41–42	Confrontation	Inhumanity	Sacrifice	Cooperation	Independence	Security
43–44	Contamination	Insanity	Schism	Curiosity	Innovation	Spirituality
45–46	Darkness	Intimidation	Sorrow	Defense	Justice	Stealth
51–52	Death	Isolation	Suffering	Determination	Kindness	Survival
53–54	Decay	Menace	Terror	Devotion	Knowledge	Trust
55–56	Desperation	Misery	Tragedy	Discipline	Love	Unity
61–62	Detachment	Mutilation	Trauma	Discovery	Loyalty	Vigilance
63–64	Discord	Neglect	Turmoil	Empowerment	Migration	Wisdom
65–66	Enslavement	Nihilism	Violence	Enlightenment	Order	Wonder

Example D666 rolls on the table above: *446 Defense, 532 Healing, 161 Detachment, 311 Obsession.*

THE MESSING UP ORACLE

When you are prompted to mess up (see page 50), consult the table below. Go with the result that makes the most sense in the moment, or roll D66 to decide randomly. If you mess up during combat or while stabilizing a lethal injury, use the relevant tables instead (page 64 for combat and page 68 for healing).

MESSING UP ORACLE

D66	RESULT
11–13	Alert a nearby swarm by making noise (raise Threat Level one step).
14–16	Fail to notice a couple of walkers who close in on you (single attack).
21–23	Run out of a resource (bullets, gas, spare parts, etc).
24–26	Break or lose something important (gear, a hostage, etc).
31–33	You are lost or someone important is put into danger.
34–36	You or an ally is hurt (1 damage).
41–43	An NPC is offended or you are distressed or afraid (1 stress).
44–46	Immediately roll to Handle Your Fear (see page 26).
51–53	A new faction is revealed or an existing faction suddenly shows up, or the endgame starts.
54–56	The Secret Issue for your Haven or an NPC is revealed (create it), or the endgame starts.
61–63	An Issue from the Challenge Sheet comes into play, or the endgame worsens.
64–66	An existing Challenge (or the endgame) worsens or becomes more complicated.

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PROGRESS CLOCKS

An important tool in solo play is the progress clock. While clock guidelines are given for rumors, factions, and the endgame, clocks can easily be expanded to cover Issues, too. However, this is not the default recommendation as rolling for each Issue can significantly slow down your sessions.

Whenever you create a new rumor or faction, you will use a six-segment clock to mark it's progress, as seen below:

The first segment of a clock is always filled whenever the corresponding entry is added to the Challenge Sheet for the first time.

These clocks are used to progress potential plot points which aren't immediately being interacted with, putting pressure on you to investigate and interact with the world around you.

At the start of every new solo session (covered later on page 160), you are asked to make a roll for each clock on your Challenge Sheet. To do so, roll a D6. If you roll higher than the number of filled in segments, you must fill in a new segment.

RUMOR CLOCKS: When the final segment of a rumor clock is filled in, the rumor is considered to be old news. You might still decide to investigate it, but there is a strong likelihood that the circumstances around it have changed. You can have up to six active rumors on your Challenge Sheet at any one time. Rumors with filled-in clocks can be replaced with new rumors.

FACTION CLOCKS: When the final segment of a faction clock is filled in, the faction does something significant. Look at that faction's needs and Issues and decide which one will complicate life for your Haven. If the faction is an ally, they might be attacked by another faction or a swarm, or they might be torn apart by a festering internal schism. Whatever the case, this should become an immediate Haven Issue and also the focus of that new session's Challenge, unless there is an existing Challenge which is somehow more urgent.

THE ENDGAME CLOCK: This is a special clock which only comes into play when the endgame is active. See page 96 for more details.

PREPARING YOUR GAME

Before you can get started on your solo adventure, you'll need to set up your game first. This differs slightly from the procedure in Chapter 7 and is laid out below.

CHOOSE A MAP

The first thing to do is to decide on where you will be playing and then prepare a gridded map of the area.

FREE OR SEASONAL PLAY?

Chapter 7 lists two different Campaign types (page 97). Solo play results in procedural campaigns that are not decided in advance. That said, solo campaigns are modelled closely to season play. It can help to think of your game in terms of a beginning, middle, and end, but don't set the equivalent of a session limit. The endgame will emerge after you have played for a while. More on this later.

Treat this map as an artifact of the world before and thus relatively unreliable.

NPC SURVIVORS CREATION

1. Use an existing NPC Survivor group on page 30, or come up with your own group by creating five new NPCs randomly using the tables in the Appendix (page 149). Use the Walker's Past table (page 142) to determine their profession before the outbreak and help figure out which skills they have. Don't create Secret Issues for your NPCs yet, though.
2. Choose one NPC to be your Companion and set them as an Anchor.
3. On a piece of paper, write the name of your PC and the other five survivors in a circle. Come up with at least 2 relationships for each, creating a mind map linking the characters together with lines. An example relationship map is shown below. Use the Relationships Table on the next page to determine the nature of each relationship, if needed.

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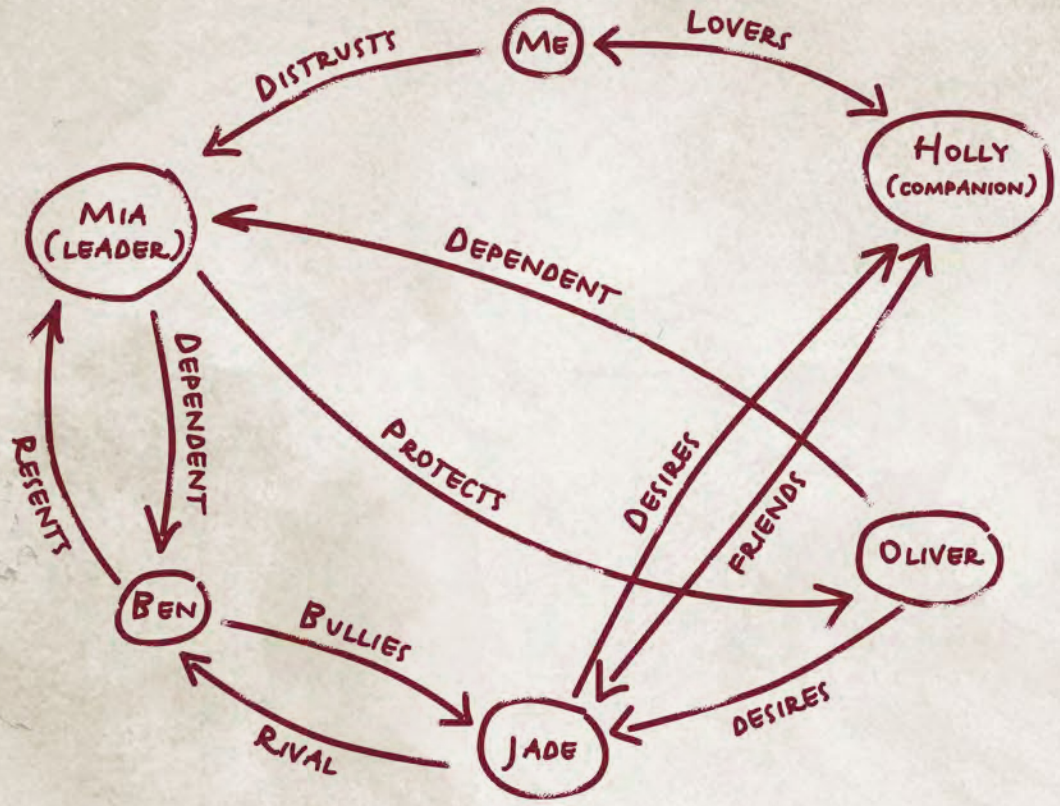

RELATIONSHIPS TABLE

D66	NATURE OF THE RELATIONSHIP
11–13	Enemy/rival
14–16	Dislikes/resents
21–23	Harassed/annoyed by
24–26	Distrusts/jealous of
31–33	Controls/bullies
34–36	Pities/despises
41–43	Trusts/follows
44–46	Protects/sympathizes
51–53	Related/dependent
54–56	Idolizes/admires
61–63	Friend/confidant
64–66	Loves/desires

HAVEN CREATION

Creating your solo Haven is very similar to how it works in a GM-led game, though there are some small changes. Follow the steps below to create your Haven:

1. Use one of the existing starting Havens on page 33 or create your own, assigning 4 attribute points between Capacity and Defense. You can also use the Locations Table on page 144 to determine the nature of your Haven. Go through the questions on page 86 to help describe your Haven.
2. Choose one of the squares on the edge of the map for the location of your Haven.
3. Reveal the sectors immediately adjacent to your Haven, including at a diagonal. None will contain a walker swarm or another faction. You can use the Locations Table on page 144 to determine their features. If a random roll doesn't make sense with the map, choose a more suitable location from the list instead. These sectors have been scouted but not explored.
4. Come up with D3+1 Issues for your Haven using the table on page 88 for guidance, but do not create a Secret Issue yet.
5. Decide on your Haven's first Project. If the pre-requisites have been met, it will have just started when you begin play.

CREATING FACTIONS

There is space to track multiple factions on your Challenge Sheet, but there should only ever be a maximum of three active at any one time during your campaign. Furthermore, at the start of your game only one faction is known – they will have already made contact with your Haven.

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To determine where this first faction is located, drop a die on the map. Where it lands is the location of their Haven. If the result on the dropped die is 1–4, this is only your best guess at where it might be. On a 5 or 6, its location has somehow been confirmed.

Create this faction using the guidelines starting on page 99. If you can only guess the location, do not determine the nature of their Haven. In addition, fill in the first segment of the faction's clock on the Challenge Sheet.

SOLO RUMORS

Generate 3 starting rumors by following the steps below:

1. Drop a die on the map and compare the result to the Rumor Subject Table below to determine the location (where the die landed) and subject of the rumor.
2. Roll again on the Rumor Subject Table to determine the secondary subject of the rumor. This might be the recipient of the first subject, the object of the first subject's attention, or something interacting with the first subject. Roll again if you get the same result.
3. Roll once or twice on the Theme Oracle to flesh out what the rumor is about.
4. Fill in the first segment of its clock on the Challenge Sheet.

RUMOR SUBJECT

D6	SUBJECT OF RUMOR
1	A walker swarm
2	A dangerous NPC or faction
3	A neutral NPC or faction
4	A useful item
5	An important location or site
6	Soldiers or a military camp

You drop a die on the map and it lands on a square in the center, showing a 5. You reroll the die, getting a 1. This tells you that the rumor is about a site in that sector where walkers are also known to be. You roll on the Theme Oracle and get a 464 – Empowerment. Perhaps there is an easily defensible facility at that location that could shift the balance of power in the area. You want a bit more detail and roll a second time on the Theme Oracle and get a 261 – Mutilation. You decide that the rumor is about an empty facility that would make an ideal haven, but is booby trapped with explosive devices designed to maim rather than kill. The reason no-one has yet occupied the facility is that the area is crawling with walkers...

ISSUES & CHALLENGES

Before you can start coming up with Challenges (the foundation of your campaign's plot), make sure you have recorded all the Issues on the Challenge Sheet, including the source of each Issue (name of an NPC, name of a faction, location, item, etc).

Once your Issues have been recorded, it's time to come up with your first Challenge. Go with an obvious choice if possible, or an Issue that seems fun to start with. If you are struggling to come up with a good Challenge, roll on the table below to help. Roll once or twice on the Theme Oracle to see how the result can be expanded. Record this Challenge on the Challenge Sheet.

Start the campaign with only one Challenge. More will emerge as you play.

CHALLENGE SOURCE

D6	SOURCE OF CHALLENGE
1	Your issue
2	An NPC's Issue
3	An Item's Issue
4	Your Haven's Issue
5	A faction's Issue
6	A rumor

STARTING THE GAME

Now that you have all the elements in place to start your campaign, your game begins in your Haven, just like in a standard GM-led game.

First, take some time to figure out what is happening in your Haven as you learn about the source of your first Challenge, probably from one of the NPCs. How do you decide to act on it? Will anyone accompany you? Why or why not? Use the Oracles if needed, but try to go with your gut as much as possible. Play this as a short scene.

Once this first scene is done, its time to set out on your first run or otherwise engage with your Challenge.

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SOLO PROCEDURES

Running an ongoing solo campaign is all about keeping focused and randomizing the world so that it feels like things are happening while you are exploring the map or improving your Haven.

SOLO SESSION STRUCTURE

There are usually no sessions in the traditional sense in solo play, so a procedure specifically for solo play is provided below, focusing on Challenges. Steps 1–8 collectively are referred to as a "solo session."

1. If this is not the first session, decide on how much time has elapsed since the last session.
2. Roll for each clock on your Challenge Sheet and fill in a segment if you roll above the number of filled in segments.
3. Create a new rumor if there are less than six active rumors on your Challenge Sheet (ignore this step in your first session).
4. Update your Haven's projects.
5. Decide on a Challenge and activate it (page 110). If a faction clock was filled in during step 2, this is likely to be your current Challenge.
6. If appropriate, run a scene where the other NPCs interact with this Challenge.
7. Embark on a run or otherwise engage with the Challenge.
8. Return to your Haven (assuming you survived!), earn Experience Points, and take some well-deserved rest.

SOLO TRAVEL

The procedure for solo runs is very similar to what is described for a GM-led game. Look at the Travel section on page 112 to come up with a description of the sector you are entering and then make a roll to determine if there is an encounter.

Use the Theme Oracle to provide more detail about the scene of an encounter. Remember that friendly NPCs or factions are a great source of new rumors.

If you roll for a faction encounter, ask the Luck Oracle if it is an existing faction. If not, generate a new faction using the guidelines in the *Creating Factions* section earlier in this chapter (page 158), though don't drop a die to determine their location. Then roll a D6 to determine how many faction members are present in the scene. Finally, roll on the NPC Reaction Table (page 118) to determine how they react to you and then play out the scene.

WALKER SWARMS

Walker swarms are discovered through encounters as you explore the map (or revealed via rumors). After a swarm has been discovered and you leave their sector, they will move between sessions. Mark or place a token on the sector where they were discovered.

In future runs, when you return within two sectors of the marked sector, make a roll on the Luck Oracle asking "is the swarm in this sector?" Use **50/50** odds when you are two sectors from the original, marked sector and **likely** odds for each adjacent sector (see the diagram below). Consult the Luck Oracle in this way before rolling for an encounter – if the answer is "yes", do not roll for an extra encounter – the swarm has moved to that sector has become the encounter.

N	N	N	N	N
N	L	L	L	N
N	L	O	L	N
N	L	L	L	N
N	N	N	N	N

KEY
O: Original sector
L: Likely odds
N: Normal (50/50) odds

KEEPING FOCUSED

In a solo campaign your Challenge Sheet will quickly become filled with plot elements, but it is important in each session that you focus on only one Challenge at a time so as not to become overwhelmed. Keeping a journal of your campaign is not necessary, but can help immensely with this. Start a new page for each solo session and write the Challenge that you're focusing on at the top. As you play, reference the Challenge Sheet only to record new NPCs or if prompted by the Messing Up Oracle.

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EXPLORING BUILDINGS IN SOLO

In solo play, using battle maps for buildings will significantly slow down your game. Instead of reaching for or creating a battlemap for a building you've encountered, think of a building instead as being small, normal, or large for what is normal for the area you're playing in. You can randomize this by rolling on the table below.

RELATIVE BUILDING SIZE

D6	BUILDING SIZE
1–2	Smaller than normal
3–5	Normal-sized
6	Larger than normal

Thinking in this "Theater of the Mind" manner not only speeds up gameplay, but encourages you to think of the building in abstract terms of size, not in terms of its layout or the exact number of rooms it has.

When exploring a building, roll for a random threat level each time you enter a new section or floor. However, instead of using the Random Threat Level table from page 118, use the modified table below.

RANDOM THREAT LEVEL: SOLO

D6	THREAT LEVEL
1–3	0
4–5	1
6+	2

In buildings with multiple sections or floors, add a 1 to subsequent rolls on this table if you have already encountered walkers in another part of the building.

If you are scavenging in the building, use the Luck Oracle to see if you find anything. An "extreme yes" result means you can roll twice on the Scavenging Table. The Luck Oracle can only be consulted in this way once per section or floor of the building, not once per room.

NPC RUNS

When NPCs go on runs and return, there is a chance they will come back with a rumor in addition to something of value. Ask the Luck Oracle if they have a new rumor to share. Set the odds based on the NPC Run result:

NPC RUN RESULT	LUCK ORACLE ODDS
1	(No rumor)
2	Likely
3–4	50/50
5–6	Unlikely

After consulting the table on page 93 to see if the NPCs return with any loot, roll a D6 to determine how much they found:

D6	RESULT
1	Roll twice on the Scavenging Table but only keep the less useful result.
2–3	Roll once on the Scavenging Table.
4–5	Roll twice on the Scavenging Table.
6	Roll three times on the Scavenging Table.

NEW FACTIONS

There are several ways for a new faction to be introduced: via the Messing Up Oracle, the Encounter Table, or the Rumor Subject Table. However, it is possible that only one faction is active, and for this faction to then be destroyed or overcome during play. If this happens and there are no more active factions in your campaign, play two more full solo sessions. Whenever the Messing Up Oracle is used, think about how a new faction could be introduced on a result of 54–66.

If a new faction still does not appear after two full solo sessions, introduce one as a rumor in phase 3 of the next solo session.

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PLAYER-FACING OPPOSED ROLLS

To make for a smoother solo experience, it is recommended to change how opposed rolls work so that the game becomes "player-facing"; all rolling is done from the perspective of the Main PC – NPCs don't roll.

This is easy to implement, since NPCs are already heavily abstracted and there is a tiered difficulty system which prompts how many dice are required for success. So to make opposed rolls player-facing, simply look at the skill that the NPC would normally be using and then use the table below to convert that skill's level to a difficulty level.

NPC DIFFICULTY

NPC SKILL LEVEL	SUCCESSES REQUIRED
Standard or Trained	1 (Difficult)
Expert	2 (Highly unlikely)
Master	3 (Almost impossible)

Guidelines for making combat player-facing is covered in the *Solo Combat* section below.

TOXICITY & VIRULENCE

Toxicity and Virulence can similarly be made player-facing. Use the table below to convert toxicity and virulence levels into a difficulty level to test Endure against.

TOXICITY & VIRULENCE DIFFICULTY

TOXICITY/ VIRULENCE LEVEL	SUCCESSES REQUIRED
1–5	1 (Difficult)
6–7	2 (Highly unlikely)
8+	3 (Almost impossible)

SOLO COMBAT

In solo play, the recommended way to play out combat scenes is to only use the rules for duels.

PLAYER-FACING DUELS

Solo duels run almost as described in chapter 5. The only thing that needs changing is converting opposed rolls to player-facing rolls, as discussed in the previous section. To do so, simply replace the Opposed Rolls in Duels table on page 62 with the table below:

In solo play, every attack will cause damage to one side. This is a side-effect of the player-facing conversion and will make duels faster and more deadly. Running away will often be the best course of action!

PLAYER-FACING ROLLS IN DUELS

RESULT	EFFECT
You fail and get no successes	Only your opponent deals damage
You get at least one success, but fewer than required	Both deal their own weapon damage
You get the required number of successes	Only you deal damage
You get more successes than required	Only you deal damage; each extra success adds +1 damage

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OUTNUMBERED

When you are ganged up on by two or more opponents, each extra combatant beyond the first increases the difficulty of your combat tests by 1, to a maximum of 3. Likewise, the amount of damage your opponents can inflict is equal to their highest weapon damage plus 1 extra damage per extra opponent. Whenever an attack is made when you are outnumbered, use the table below to determine the result:

OUTNUMBERED ATTACKS

RESULT	EFFECT
You fail and get no successes	Only your opponents deal damage
You get at least one success, but fewer than required	You deal your own weapon damage and the opponents deal theirs, with each of your successes cancelling out one of theirs
You get the required number of successes	Only you deal damage to a single opponent
You get more successes than required	Only you deal damage to a single opponent; each extra success adds +1 damage. This extra damage can be spread to other opponents, if desired

LEFT FOR DEAD

A standard trope in *The Walking Dead* is that characters turn up alive who were previously left behind and assumed to either be dead or turned. To replicate this in *The Walking Dead Universe Role-playing Game*, if you leave an NPC behind to die but don't witness their death, record that NPC's Fate as "Unknown" on the Challenge Sheet. At a future date in your campaign, they might just turn up via an "extreme yes" or "extreme no" result on the Luck Oracle.

However, as with any trope, it is most effective when used sparingly. Try to limit an NPC returning from the dead like this to only once per campaign, if at all.

PLAYER-FACING CHASES

Chases can be made player-facing as well. Look at your opponent's Mobility skill level and assign a difficulty. Then roll your own Mobility on each Mobility turn and use the table below to determine the result:

SOLO CHASES

RESULT	EFFECT
You don't roll any successes	Your opponent moves one distance closer (if you're escaping) or one distance further away (if you're pursuing)
You get at least one success, but fewer than required	Neither of you close the gap
You get at least the required number of successes	You move one distance closer (if you're pursuing) or one distance further away (if you're escaping)

SOLOING THE SWARM

The best advice for encountering a swarm in solo play is to run like hell! Otherwise, the rules about fighting the dead on page 77 work as written with the following changes, replacing GM decisions with random tables.

LOSING TO THE SWARM

When you are fighting a swarm and you lose to the dead (as covered on page 82), roll a D6 and compare to the table on the right.

LOSING TO A SWARM TABLE

D6	RESULT
1–3	The Threat Level is increased one step.
4–5	The Swarm Size is increased one step.
6	The Swarm attacks.

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RANDOM SWARM ATTACKS

When the swarm makes an attack (as covered on page 82), roll a D6 and compare to the table below.

RANDOM SWARM ATTACKS

D6	RESULT
1–3	**SINGLE ATTACK:** A single walker attacks your PC or an NPC with a single attack (page 80). Roll a random die to see who is targeted.
4–5	**BLOCK:** The swarm block off all escape routes. All rolls for Mobility or Stealth need one extra success to succeed.
6	**MASS ATTACK:** Roll a random die to see who is attacked by the swarm. The target must immediately roll on the Walker Attack table (page 81) – no skill roll can be made to avoid this.

THE END OF THE ROAD

Assuming you haven't ended the campaign earlier following many PC and NPC deaths, the endgame will eventually start and your campaign will head for its natural conclusion.

THE BEGINNING OF THE END

After you have dealt with at least a few Challenges and you feel the timing is appropriate for your campaign, give your endgame a chance to emerge. From that point on, keep in mind that you are now in the final phase of your campaign and look for ways to increase the drama and stakes in each scene.

The endgame will then emerge the next time you roll a 51–66 on the Messing Up Oracle. To determine the nature of your endgame, use the following simple procedure:

1. **Roll twice on the Theme Oracle**, but modify your roll to a D366, using a D3 to determine which of columns 1–3 to use. The two results give you the themes of your endgame.
2. **Ask the Luck Oracle "has the endgame evolved from an existing Challenge Sheet element?"**
   - **If "yes"**, examine your Challenge Sheet for the best endgame candidate, within the context of the two endgame themes you just rolled.
   - **If "no"**, determine the source of the endgame challenge using the table below.

D6	ENDGAME SOURCE
1	A walker swarm (size d3+3)
2	A new, hostile faction*
3	A friend or ally
4	A vital resource
5	An important location or site
6	Your haven

* If you have 3 active factions, roll a D3 to decide which faction is destroyed as the new one emerges.

SAMPLE ENDGAMES

Themes: Abandonment & Nihilism. **Source:** A new, hostile faction. **Endgame:** A group of elite soldiers who have abandoned all hope after their haven was destroyed by a ruthless faction move into the area. Their nihilistic mission is to wipe out every haven they come across. Can your haven survive?

Themes: Catastrophe & Terror. **Source:** A vital resource. **Endgame:** An essential resource has disappeared from your haven and two NPCs have been brutally murdered. No-one could have entered from outside and no-one is missing. The haven is terrified and things are turning bloody as everyone suspects each other. If the missing resource can be found, maybe it can provide a vital clue. Can the murderer be found before the haven implodes?

This new endgame Challenge should infuse everything that happens from this point on. Roll on the endgame clock at the start of each solo session, as with all other clocks. In addition, one segment of the endgame clock is now filled whenever you roll a 61–66 on the Messing Up Oracle. Each time a segment of its clock is filled, think about how the situation worsens.

As the endgame becomes an all-encompassing Challenge, you can deal with it more easily by breaking it up into smaller Challenges. While this makes the endgame easier to engage with, don't neglect to fill its clock as described above.

Your solo campaign ends when the endgame is either dealt with, or its clock is filled and it comes to fruition. Regardless of the outcome, your campaign is over – congratulations on making it to the end!

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THE WALKING DEAD UNIVERSE

AMC

ROLEPLAYING GAME

Name:

Archetype:

Description:

PC Anchor:

Drive:

NPC Anchor:

Issues:

Notes:

ATTRIBUTES & SKILLS

STRENGTH	AGILITY	WITS	EMPATHY
Close Combat	Mobility	Scout	Leadership
Endure	Ranged Combat	Survival	Manipulation
Force	Stealth	Tech	Medicine

TALENTS

HEALTH

3. UNHARMED

2. BRUISED

1. BATTERED

0. BROKEN

Critical Injuries:

STRESS

EXPERIENCE

ENCUMBRANCE SLOTS

GEAR

BONUS

WEAPONS

	DAMAGE	BONUS	RANGE

ARMOR

	PROTECTION	PENALTY

TINY ITEMS

STORED GEAR

	LOCATION		LOCATION

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THE WALKING DEAD UNIVERSE
AMC
ROLEPLAYING GAME

Name:

CAPACITY

DEFENSE

Issues:

DESCRIPTION

Overall:

Structures:

Surroundings:

Food Sources:

Stored Gear:

CURRENT PROJECTS

Project:	Project:
Effect:	Effect:
Workforce / Finish Date	Workforce / Finish Date
Project:	Project:
Effect:	Effect:
Workforce / Finish Date	Workforce / Finish Date

NPC SURVIVORS

Name:	Name:	Name:	Name:
Description:	Description:	Description:	Description:
Skills:	Skills:	Skills:	Skills:
Issue:	Issue:	Issue:	Issue:
Gear:	Gear:	Gear:	Gear:
Name:	Name:	Name:	Name:
Description:	Description:	Description:	Description:
Skills:	Skills:	Skills:	Skills:
Issue:	Issue:	Issue:	Issue:
Gear:	Gear:	Gear:	Gear:

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CHALLENGE SHEET

THE WALKING DEAD UNIVERSE

AMC

ROLEPLAYING GAME

ISSUES	SOURCE

NPCs	FATE

RUMORS	CLOCK

CHALLENGES

ENDGAME	CLOCK

FACTIONS	NOTES	CLOCK

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THE WALKING DEAD UNIVERSE

AMC

ROLEPLAYING GAME

Notes:

	TERRAIN	THREAT	COMMENTS
Coordinates:			
Date:			
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NORTH EAST GEORGIA

0 5 10 15 20 25

KILOMETERS

- Forest
- Populated Area
- Road
- Lake
- River
- State Border

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This is *The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game*. *The Walking Dead* has always been about characters facing impossible choices in an unforgiving world. With this game, you enter into the world of the dead and must face these choices head on. You can do this at any point in the timeline – encountering familiar faces and locations, or new ones – but the hardest choice will always be the same: Who are you going to be?

We have seen many stories set in *The Walking Dead Universe* – now it's time to see yours.

In the official *The Walking Dead Universe Roleplaying Game*, you will play as people struggling to survive in a hostile world. Exceptional challenges can appear from anywhere – from the lack of essential supplies, from conflicts brewing within the group, from hidden construction flaws in your safe haven, or from approaching walkers hungering for your flesh.

In the game, the player characters must not only hone their physical skills, but deeply explore who they truly are – what drives them to go on, what they consider worth fighting for, and what they're capable of doing, in the best and worst of times. Expect the stress and stakes to be high. The rules are based on the acclaimed Year Zero Engine, pushing the boundaries of the survival genre and making sure that every group can tailor the gaming experience to suit their own interests and play style.

CONTENT WARNING
The Walking Dead Universe deals with dark and existential themes, and this roleplaying game is no different. The stories told in this game can be violent, distressing, and raise issues relating to personal morals. This is not a game for children.

AMC NETWORKS PUBLISHING

FREE LEAGUE

freeleaguepublishing.com

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ISBN 978-91-89765-20-7

9 789189 765207 >

FLFTWD001

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